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LEADERS DISCUSS FALLOUT OF WEST ASIA WAR, SAFETY OF INDIAN SEAFARERS IN BLACK SEA

Modi, Putin set BRICS stage: ‘Deep shifts’, new engines of growth, energy security



PM Narendra Modi with Russian President Vladimir Putin, Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian, South African President Cyril Ramaphosa and Brazil's Foreign Minister Mauro Vieira in New Delhi, Friday. ANI

PM flags secure sea lanes, Russian President for ‘reliable’ logistics routes

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, September 11

IN REMARKS directed both at the West, opposed to his war in Ukraine, and countries with which Russia continues to do business despite crippling Western sanctions, Russian President Vladimir Putin said Friday that “the world is undergoing structural, deep, profound shifts” in which “new engines of growth” are replacing “the so-called old leaders”.

Addressing the BRICS business forum in New Delhi ahead of the summit Saturday, Putin said Russia and its “partners” are “ready to contribute to world energy and food security” and “building reliable logistics routes such as the Arctic Transport Corridor and the North-South Transport Corridor”.

His remarks on energy and food security and “reliable logistics routes” are a reminder that the crisis in West Asia, where the US continues to exchange strikes with Iran, a BRICS member country, has not been resolved. The partial

Business as Usual

By EP UNNY



EDITORIAL PAGE P 10

AT BRICS, KEEP THE DIFFICULT CONVERSATIONS ALIVE

closure of the strategic Strait of Hormuz has disrupted supply chains, impacted economies and sent fuel prices soaring.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi, who held a bilateral meeting with the Russian leader, told the BRICS business

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Range of national aims: Accommodation with West, autonomy from it, parity within it, or direct confrontation

C Raja Mohan
Kutaisi (Georgia), September 11

AS IT presides over the BRICS summit in Delhi Saturday, India's challenge is two-fold: to

convey the forum's shared objective of democratizing the international system and to dispel the widespread impression that it seeks to overthrow the US-led order.

E.

The forum's champions and detractors alike view it through an anti-Western lens. Its supporters celebrate BRICS as a vehicle for resisting Western dominance; its critics warn that it is becoming a counter-bloc led by China and Russia. Both

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Grouping looks at pragmatic cross-border payment mechanism, local currency trade

Goyal calls for linking payment systems

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, September 11

AHEAD OF THE BRICS Leaders' Summit, member countries have called for “pragmatic” and “efficient” cross-border pay-



Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal at the opening ceremony of the BRICS Business Forum in New Delhi, Friday. PTI



• TODAY AT BRICS

PM MODI to meet President Xi
MEMBERS TO hold closed session on 'Inclusive Global Governance and Strengthening Multilateralism'

BHARAT INNOVATES exhibition to showcase India's Deep-Tech innovations

GALA DINNER hosted by PM

MORE REPORTS, P 4, 8, 16

India and EU close to sealing trade deal, await nod from top Council in Brussels

Ravi Dutta Mishra
New Delhi, September 11

E. EXPLAINED

Why it is a win-win deal

While European companies will get access to the Indian market and compete on a more level playing field, the pact will unlock high-value commitments in services and enable movement of skilled Indian professionals.

India,” the European Union said in a statement.

“With its proposals, the Commission is seeking the Council's approval to sign the agreements, which will then require the European Parliament's consent, before conclusion and entry into force. Authorities in India are in parallel going through their own internal ratification procedures,” the statement said.

“The EU and India already trade over Euro 180 billion (1 Euro equals US \$1.16) worth of goods and services per year, supporting close to 800,000 EU jobs. This deal will eliminate or reduce tariffs on 96% of

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



UP trader's killing: Minister on dharna, demands ‘encounter’ if accused roam free

Maulshree Seth
Lucknow, September 11

A DAY after a trader from Uttar Pradesh's Gonda district died of injuries sustained during a dispute over social media posts, the matter snowballed into a political controversy on Friday as BJP ally and state minister Sanjay Nishad led a protest against his own government, with the Opposition joining in and backing his calls for justice.

The incident, which comes months before Assembly elections in UP, has taken on a caste colour as the trader is from the Nishad community and three of the accused who have been arrested are from the “upper caste”, according to the police. Nishad on Friday reiterated that if the accused who remain

absconding do not surrender, then “encounter becomes necessary” and any unauthorised property they own must be bulldozed.

“A criminal does not have any caste. So, if one does not surrender, then encounter becomes necessary. Otherwise, he will kill more people. It is similarly necessary that unauthorised property of the accused faces bulldozer action like in other cases,” Nishad told *The Indian Express*.

“One must understand that in the districts there are hardly any officers from the most backward or the Scheduled Castes in prominent posts. Thus, there is always the pressure of caste and it is necessary for us to stand and raise our

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Happening today

• **THE ELECTION** Commission has invited former West Bengal CM Mamata Banerjee and TMC rebel leader Ritabrata Banerjee for separate meetings regarding their dispute over control of the party.

• **A HIGH-LEVEL TASK FORCE** set up by the Maharashtra government to undertake a comprehensive review of recruitment examinations will begin its division-wise consultation.

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EXPRESS special

As India probes origin of 5 baby orangutans, Indonesia prepares ground for repatriation



One of the five baby orangutans at the Nandankanan Zoological Park near Bhubaneswar. VIDEO GRAB

Nikhil Ghanekar
New Delhi, September 11

DAYS AFTER five baby orangutans were rescued from a forest in Balasore district of Odisha, Indonesia's Ministry of Forestry has reached out to Indian authorities and is learnt to be “preparing the technical requirements” for their repatriation if investigations confirm they are from Indonesia.

Based on preliminary assessment, the orangutans are

suspected to be from Sumatra, an Indonesian government official told *The Indian Express*, saying that the possibility of an “organised transnational wildlife trafficking network” is being taken seriously.

“We fully respect the judicial and statutory procedures applicable in India. Indonesia will therefore continue its government-to-government and CITES coordination while awaiting the completion of the

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

NATION PAGE 9



GOR MEETS MANIPUR CM AND GOVERNOR, DISCUSSES TOURISM, ECONOMIC TIES

BEHIND ARMS HEIST, EX-ARMY HAVILDAR WHO HELD GRUDGE AGAINST HIS CO

• **RICHIE MEHTA'S 'PHOOLAN'** HAD ITS WORLD PREMIERE AT TORONTO INTERNATIONAL FILM FESTIVAL

New film zooms into 48 hours of Phoolan Devi that made her ‘bandit queen’

Alaka Sahani
Toronto, September 11

IN 2019, soon after Canadian filmmaker Richie Mehta finished working on the acclaimed series ‘*Delhi Crime*’, he was approached by Namah Pictures, which had acquired the rights to the brigand Phoolan Devi's autobiography, ‘*I, Phoolan: The Autobiography of India's Bandit Queen*’. The producers wanted to retell her story in a modern context, and although the writer-director was initially hesitant be-

cause he is “a non-resident Indian, Punjabi and a male filmmaker”, he changed his mind after reading the book.

“Phoolan Devi's story goes on to show how she empowered herself from nothing. I thought maybe it was time for the world to see this crucial story,” Mehta, who made his feature debut with the 2007 movie ‘*Amal*’, says.

Instead of telling her entire life story, he chose to focus on a specific moment in her life — the chapter that recounts how 2,000-armed men were de-

ployed to capture the then 17-year-old Phoolan in a siege that lasted 48 hours. That siege, the murder of her partner, and the subsequent gangrape forged her identity as the bandit queen.

Directed by Mehta, ‘*Phoolan*’, which tells the story of the siege, had its world premiere in the Special Presentation category of the Toronto International Film Festival (TIFF) Friday.

“It's [the incident] described matter-of-factly in her book, just one of the many adversities she faced. This became a way (for him) to effectively convey to the world the odds against



Filmmaker Richie Mehta; (right) a still from his film

her,” he says.

Phoolan Devi was born in 1963 in Ghura Ka Purwa, a small village in Uttar Pradesh.



She would eventually go on to become a bandit in the Chambal Valley — and one of India's most compelling figures.

In 1983, she surrendered to authorities and served 11 years in prison. Following her release in 1994, she entered public life and

was elected twice as a Member of Parliament from Mirzapur, Uttar Pradesh. She was assassinated on July 25, 2001, outside her residence in New Delhi.

While retelling Phoolan Devi's story on screen, Mehta was careful about the protagonist's agency. “It's important that we didn't present Phoolan as a victim. She was an empowered agent of change. The fact remains that she was able to become that in the face of adversity,” says Mehta.

The book gave him a clear understanding of how Phoolan Devi viewed her own life and in-

terpreted the events she lived through. “I used her words as my foundation— nothing more, nothing less,” says Mehta. “There are themes she returned to repeatedly in her writing, and those became my focus. The crucial one being the intersection of poverty and gender, and how that shaped the circumstances of her life. I tried to frame the film through that lens, staying faithful to what she herself identified as the central reality of her experience.”

For the filmmaker, this was critical, especially since

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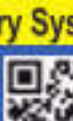
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2. इ-निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय - 16.10.2026 अपराह्न 02:00 बजे

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ASSAULTED FOR OBJECTING TO NOISE

Manipur musician died due to injuries to abdomen, chest: Autopsy report



Chongtham Vikram Singh with his family members.

Pragynesh
New Delhi, September 11

MORE THAN 10 fractured ribs, severe internal bleeding, and bruises around the head, face, and chest: this is what the autopsy report has revealed days after Manipur musician Chongtham Vikram Singh was beaten to death outside his South Delhi home on Sunday night for allegedly objecting to a group of men making loud noises.

The main cause of the 55-year-old musician's death has been cited as hemorrhagic shock due to injuries caused by 'blunt force' on his chest and abdomen, as per the report.

According to the family, the incident had occurred around 11.30 pm on Sunday when Singh stepped out of his home in the Kilokari village allegedly to confront the group of men. Following the assault, Singh's son, Yaiphaba, took him to Holy Family Hospital for treatment where he died early Monday morning, said police.

Vineet Kumar, DCP South-East, had said at the time that seven people, most of them working as delivery executives in the nearby area, were ar-

Singh played a significant role in popularising rock in Manipur

rested and a minor was apprehended. The seven arrested accused were identified as Bharat Kumar, 19; Pramod, 26; Ramzan Khan, 22; Deepanshu, 21; Mohan Vishwakarma, 32; Vijay, 36, and Mannu, 26.

Singh was the lead guitarist of Manipur's legendary rock band Phoenix in the early 1980s and was regarded as one of the pioneers of the Western music in the state. He also played a significant role in popularising rock in Manipur. He started his music career as a lead guitarist of the Ultra Vires band.

The musician had been living in Kilokari village in South Delhi for several years.

His death shook the North-east community, which described the incident as an instance of racial violence and raised concerns over the safety of people from the region living in the Capital.

Several protest marches were held following the incident to condemn the violence.

CM suggests giving autorickshaws, e-ricks to children leaving care units

New Delhi: Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Friday suggested providing autorickshaws to girls and e-rickshaws to boys leaving child-care institutions to help them start a livelihood, while directing the Delhi Commission for Protection of Child Rights (DCPCR) to connect such children with education, skills and employment opportunities. PTI



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Security personnel near Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi on Friday, as the Capital gears up to host the BRICS Summit on September 12 and 13. AMIT MEHRA



Summit today, security blanket over Delhi

No shutdown, but more than 35 roads could be affected, say traffic police

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 11

DELHI HAS been placed under a massive security cover ahead of the two-day 18th BRICS Summit beginning Saturday, with around 30,000 security personnel and 700 CCTV cameras deployed, as well as more than 35 roads facing restrictions due to VVIP movements.

Bharat Mandapam, the venue for the summit, has been taken over by the Special Protection Group (SPG) and National Security Guard (NSG), with anti-aircraft guns, anti-drone systems and snipers deployed as part of the multi-layered security arrangement.

Around 15,000 Delhi Police personnel and 200 companies of paramilitary forces have been deployed for the summit. There are around 700 CCTV cameras installed across Lutyens Delhi, particularly along the 35 routes through which the guests will be escorted to the venue and back to their hotels.

Around 100 Delhi Police K9 dogs are conducting anti-sabotage checks at Bharat Mandapam and hotels where foreign delegates are staying. Thirty sniffer dogs and their handlers have been deployed round-the-clock at the main venue.

The remaining dogs have been deployed at hotels and kept on standby to check markets and other strategic locations before the movement of foreign guests and their family members. The NSG, Army and other paramilitary forces have also provided dogs for security checks.



Water mist sprayer at work to reduce dust. PRAVEEN KHANNA

The dogs are being used to check venues and their surroundings, including hidden spaces, seats, staircases, gardens and parking areas, for suspicious objects.

Delhi Traffic Police said there would be no shutdown of the city, but commuters should expect temporary stoppages, diversions and restrictions during the movement of VVIP convoys. The stoppages will not have a fixed duration and traffic will be released in phases depending on the security situation and ground conditions, they added.

More than 35 roads could be affected, including Mathura Road, Sardar Patel Marg, Shanti Path, Janpath, Ashoka Road, Barakhamba Road, Tolstoy Marg, Africa Avenue Road, Niti Marg, Panchsheel Marg and APJ Abdul Kalam Road.

The impact is expected to be significant for commuters travelling between Noida and Central Delhi, East Delhi and Central areas, and from Dwarka and West Delhi towards Dhaura Kuan, the airport and South Delhi.

Delhi and Central government offices will remain shut on Saturday. Schools will also

remain closed.

The two hotels where Russian President Vladimir Putin and Chinese President Xi Jinping are staying have been taken over by security officials from their respective countries.

Meanwhile, major buildings, including the old and new Parliament buildings, structures around the Central Vista, ministry buildings and embassies of participating countries have been decorated and illuminated for the summit.

Markets, including Chandni Chowk, Connaught Place, Sarojini Nagar and Lajpat Nagar, have also been decorated and will remain open on Saturday and Sunday. Security agencies expect some dignitaries and their family members to visit them during their stay.

Two command rooms, at Bharat Mandapam and Tuglak Road, have been set up to oversee the operation and monitor the movement of cavalcades.

The security alert on Saturday will remain in place until around 9 pm, when guests are expected to return to their hotels after the 7.30 pm gala dinner hosted by Prime Minister Narendra Modi.

● CYBER ATTACKS: GOVT OFFICIALS WARNED

Delhi Police issues guidelines for government officials and contractual staff to guard against potential cyber attacks and the spread of misinformation. It includes warnings on phishing links and unauthorised software.

Dos ✓

- Use passwords of at least eight characters with upper and lower-case letters, numbers and special characters. Enable multi-factor authentication wherever available.

- Keep backups of important data on secondary or offline drives, regularly update operating systems, and install anti-virus software.

- Log out even when stepping away from computer systems, even for a short period.

- Keep GPS, Bluetooth, NFC and other sensors disabled on computers and mobile phones unless required.

- Download applications only from official app stores.

- Encrypt important data and documents before sharing it.

- Exercise caution while opening shortened URLs.

- Be careful while opening links received through SMS and social media platforms.



Don'ts ✕

- Don't use third-party cloud services, remote administration tools

- Don't reuse the same password across multiple services, websites or applications, or store passwords in browsers.

- Sensitive information such as passwords, IP addresses and network diagrams should not be written on sticky notes or papers posted on desks.

- Government data and files should not be stored on system drives or uploaded to non-government cloud services such as Google Drive and Dropbox.

- Don't use outdated or unsupported operating systems.

Warm welcome at Delhi airport

- At Delhi's Indira Gandhi International Airport, elaborate arrangements have been made to welcome world leaders and foreign delegations as the Capital hosts BRICS Summit.

- Dedicated immigration counters have been set up at the terminal and ceremonial lounge to provide a seamless immigration experience for participants.

- Cultural programmes,



which include traditional dance performance and folk music, are being organised to give a warm welcome to BRICS attendees.

- Other arrangements too have been made for event branding.

At BRICS Bazaar, heritage and global artisans' work on display

Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, September 11

THEY CLAIM to keep centuries-old traditions alive in a modern world. At BRICS Bazaar, being held at the National Crafts Museum & Hastkala Academy in New Delhi, master artisans from across member nations say they are proud to exhibit their cultural heritage and life's work.

On display at the fair, which kicked off on September 10 and concludes on September 15, are authentic handlooms, textiles, and traditional artwork. Among the artisans who have traveled to the Capital are a South African beadwork artist, Nkosinathi Zondi, and Anastasia Kareeva, a practitioner of a 200-year-old Russian lacquer technique.

Zondi, 49, is a Durban-based artisan, entrepreneur, and founder of Nela Kahle Art & Crafts. Specialising in intricate African beadwork, he creates handmade jewellery and accessories that blend traditional cultural craft with contemporary design.

"I have travelled from South Africa to India to represent our craft. I see the exhibition as more than simply a marketplace. It is a platform for cultural exchange. As we showcase South African beadwork and contemporary products rooted in traditional African craftsmanship, we explain to the visitors the techniques involved and demonstrate how traditional knowledge can be preserved while still creating opportunities for today's generation," he shares.

His journey into beadwork began when he was a child. "For me, beadwork is deeply personal



Anastasia Kareeva, the Russian lacquer artist. EXPRESS

because it connects directly to my mother and to the knowledge that was passed down to me...", he says and adds, "When my mother became ill while I was in Class 10, I took on the responsibility for making and selling the work."

To him, every piece carries a connection to his heritage and identity. The process behind the artwork can sometimes run into hours, he highlights. "Depending on the design, beads may be individually threaded by hand, woven using a loom, or constructed using techniques such as Ndebele/herringbone, netting, lace, brick stitch and peyote. Some pieces can take many hours to complete because every bead has to be positioned carefully to achieve the required pattern, strength and finish," he adds.

On the other hand, Kareeva, 42, represents the historic Fedoskino Factory of Miniature Painting, one of Russia's oldest

centers for traditional lacquer miniature art in Moscow. She works tirelessly to preserve Fedoskino lacquer art — a meticulous, multi-layered painting technique on papier-mâché.

"We are presenting Fedoskino pieces created using the technique of lacquer miniature painting. Traditional pieces are made with a base of papier-mâché. The main stages of this technology have remained unchanged since the late 18th century," she explains.

Creating a box such as those on display can take up to six months, according to Kareeva. "Masters of various specialties work on a single piece: a filer, a varnisher, a miniature artist, and a polisher. A significant part of the operations is done by hand. Before the painting begins, the body of the box goes through several stages: shaping the papier-mâché, drying, priming, varnishing, and manual surface treatment. Then, the miniature artist works on the design," she explains.

To create depth and a glow in the painting, mother-of-pearl, gold leaf, and silver can be used, Kareeva points out. "The multi-layered lacquer coating and manual polishing create the depth of the image and the shine of the surface," she adds.

Kareeva says that it is important to preserve the artistic tradition of Fedoskino and to create conditions for its enhancement. "Behind every work are several months of labor and the involvement of masters of various specialties. These boxes and decorative panels can become part of a family collection and be passed down to future generations," she says.

Drive against unauthorised constructions in Gurgaon extends to Sushant Lok, South City

Abhimanyu Hazarika
Gurugram, September 11

A RESIDENTIAL home with rooms carved into its parking area, a guest house spread across two plots, four-storey houses operating as commercial lodgings: Several properties in two of Gurgaon's well-known colonies were sealed by the Department of Town and Country Planning (DTCP) on Thursday.

The enforcement wing of the DTCP continued its crackdown on illegal constructions in residential areas, this time in Sushant Lok-1 Block A and South City-1. The drive targeted PG accommodations, unauthorised guest houses, commercial establishments and rooms built illegally in stilt parking areas.

Among the properties sealed in Sushant Lok was a PG functioning out of A-589. By Thursday, only rubble and the remains of desks and walls were left on its ground floor. A poster outside warned that an FIR would be registered if the seals and locks were tampered with.

The building had been cleared after residents were



Stilt office at A Block PG in Sushant Lok that was sealed. EXPRESS

informed and given notices last month.

An official of the property, said: "We knew what would happen and that we had no other choice. All the videos going viral online of the drive showed the authorities do not listen to us." He said they catered to students and young people who start earning. "We were given a notice but can we find a new livelihood for all those we employed so fast?"

The ongoing drive follows recent directions from the Punjab and Haryana High Court and the Supreme Court against illegal commercial activities and

unauthorised constructions in private licensed colonies. Officials said a recent survey found widespread violations across nearly 90% of surveyed properties in these sectors.

In Blocks A and C, enforcement teams targeted illegal constructions in stilt parking areas, using earthmovers and manual labour to tear down brick partitions and UPVC door-window assemblies used to divide the spaces into rental quarters, as well as offices built there.

"Stilt parking is strictly sanctioned for vehicle parking. Constructing rooms, offices, or toilets in these spaces is a direct

violation of approved building plans," said District Town Planner (Enforcement) Amit Madholia, who led the operations. A 36-room guest house created by combining two residential plots was also sealed.

"Owners were served prior show-cause notices and restoration orders. As they failed to restore the properties to their sanctioned state, enforcement action was initiated," Madholia added.

In South City 1, the enforcement team led by Assistant Town Planner (ATP) Divya Dahiya sealed several residential buildings operating as commercial hubs: a 20-room hotel; three separate guest houses; PG accommodations comprising 32, 39, and 27 rooms; and ground-floor brokerage and corporate offices in Block B.

"After the way monsoons hit the sector this time, residents were unsparing in terms of wanting properties like ours to shut," said a guesthouse operator in South City whose stilt office was demolished and certain rooms were sealed. "We have accommodated tenants in hotels as of now...", the operator said.

Int'l tennis player, Asian Games handballer, Ladakhi student in DUSU election fray

Sophiya Mathew
New Delhi, September 11

AN INTERNATIONAL-LEVEL tennis player, a handball player who represented the country in the Asian Games, a visually-challenged student and in a first, a Ladakhi student — these are among the 20 candidates who will contest the Delhi University Students' Union (DUSU) elections on September 18.

The provisional list released on Friday has the candidates contesting four posts — seven for president, five for vice-president and four each for secretary and joint secretary.

Student safety and accommodation have emerged as key issues in this year's DUSU elections. Protests under the CJP banner and the deaths of five DU students in the hostel building collapse at Satya Niketan earlier this week have brought housing, infrastructure, safety, student welfare and representation into the campaign.

The NSUI has put affordable accommodation, better infrastructure and student safety on its agenda.



(From left) Ananya Raturi of AISA-SFI; ABVP's Yash Dabas; NSUI's Vijay Shankar Meena. EXPRESS

The unique thing about its candidates — all four are pursuing MA Buddhist Studies. President candidate Vijay Shankar Meena and joint secretary candidate Gopal Choudhary, both from Rajasthan, as well as vice-president candidate Vir Chatrath, from Delhi, are first-year students. Secretary candidate Namrata Choudhary is in her second year.

The ABVP panel brings two sporting profiles to the contest. Its presidential candidate Yash Dabas, from Delhi, is an international-level tennis player who has competed in ITF events in Spain, Australia and Serbia. He has also represented DU in university-level competitions and taken part in Khelo India and

the All India University Games.

Joint secretary candidate Lakshay Raj Singh has represented India in handball at the Asian Games and World Championship. He has also represented Rajasthan at the National Games. Singh is pursuing law at Campus Law Centre.

Vice-president candidate Ishu Maurya has been associated with ABVP since 2021. He has served as president of the Satyawati College (Morning) unit and co-convenor of Students for Seva. Secretary candidate Riya Chhawdi comes from a farming family and has played basketball at the inter-college level.

The AISA-SFI alliance is pitching a "new, student-led DUSU", drawing on what it calls

the "GenZ movements". It is campaigning against "money and muscle politics" and for an "accessible and affordable DU".

Its presidential candidate Ananya Raturi has been involved in campaigns around sexual harassment and caste discrimination. Vice-president candidate Akshat Shikhar participated in protests over NEET-UG 2026 paper leak and later joined AISA's 23-day hunger strike in solidarity with climate activist Sonam Wangchuk.

Secretary candidate Stanzin Deskyong, a first-year MSc Mathematics student at Hindu College, is from Leh. As per the alliance, she is the first Ladakhi student to contest DUSU polls. She was vice-president of the Ramjas College Students' Union during her undergraduate years and has led a campaign over allegations of harassment by a professor.

The race for the secretary's post has three women — Namrata Choudhary, Riya Chhawdi and Stanzin Deskyong. Pankaj Kumar of ASAP, who is visually-challenged, is the fourth candidate.



TRAFFIC ADVISORY



Welcome

International Heads of State, Dignitaries and Global Delegates

BRICS Summit-2026

11 - 13 Sept., 2026 Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi



Diversion Points: 22 **Controlled Roads: 35+** **Elaborate vehicular regulations in force**

To ensure seamless movement for VIP convoys and minimize public inconvenience, dedicated traffic regulations and diversions will be in effect, primarily across the New Delhi District and surrounding corridors



01 ROADS TO AVOID CONTROLLED AREA

Motorists should not plan routes through the following roads for the duration of the Summit. A detailed map is issued alongside the official notice.

Mathura Road (Subramaniam Bharti Marg T-Pt - Lodhi Rd Flyover)	Brig. Hoshiyar Singh Marg
Tees January Marg	Shanti Path
Janpath	Sher Shah Suri Marg
Satya Marg	Dr. Zakir Hussain Marg
Prithvi Raj Road	Tilak Marg
Firoze Shah Road	San Martin Marg
Ashoka Road	Rajesh Pilot Marg
Tughlak Road	Akbar Road
Neela Gumbad	Sardar Patel Marg
Panchsheel Marg	APJ Abdul Kalam Road
Subramaniam Bharti Marg	Kautilya Marg
Mother Teresa Crescent	Bhagwan Das Road
Teen Murti Marg	Kemal Ataturk Marg
Africa Avenue (Bhikaji Cama Place - Yashwant Place)	Kartavya Path
'C' Hexagon	Purana Quila Road
	Safdarjung Road
	Nyaya Marg



02 SUGGESTED ROUTES RAILWAY STATIONS

NEW DELHI RAILWAY STATION

Route A: ISBT Kashmiri Gate → Boulevard Road → Rani Jhansi Marg → DBG Road → Panchkuian Road → Outer Circle, Connaught Place
Route B: Ashram Chowk → Ring Road → Raj Ghat → JLN Marg
Route C: Vande Matram Marg → Dr. Ambedkar Marg → Panchkuian Road → Outer Circle, Connaught Place



OLD DELHI RAILWAY STATION

Route A: ISBT Kashmiri Gate → Ring Road → Hanuman Mandir → S.P. Mukherjee Marg
Route B: Ashram Chowk → Ring Road → Raj Ghat → Ring Road → Hanuman Mandir → S.P. Mukherjee Marg
Route C: Vande Matram Marg → Dr. Ambedkar Marg

→ Rani Jhansi Marg → Rani Jhansi Flyover → Boulevard Road → Lothian Marg

HAZRAT NIZAMUDDIN RAILWAY STATION

Route A: AIIMS → Ring Road → Ashram Chowk → Mathura Road
Route B: ISBT Kashmiri Gate → Ring Road → Raj Ghat → Ring Road → Ashram Chowk → Mathura Road



03 SUGGESTED ROUTES AIRPORT

METRO STRONGLY RECOMMENDED: Motorists are advised to travel to Airport Terminals via Metro services in view of traffic regulations.

FROM GURUGRAM

• **T3 / T4 / T2:** NH-48 → Rao Gajraj Singh Marg → Old Delhi Gurugram Road → UER II → Service Road → T3 Terminal Road
• **T1:** NH-48 → under Mahipalpur Flyover → T-3 Road
• **T1:** NH-48 → Mahipalpur Flyover → NH-48 → Ulaanbaatar Marg → T-1 Road

FROM DWARKA

• **T3/T4/T2/T1:** Sector-22, Dwarka Road → UER II (New Tunnel to T3)

FROM NEW DELHI & SOUTH DELHI

• **T3:** Ring Road → AIIMS Chowk → Moti Bagh Chowk → RTR Marg → Under Shankar Vihar Flyover → Sanjay T-Point → Service Road → NH-48 → Under Mahipalpur Flyover Rangpuri → T-3 Road.
• **T3 / T4 / T2 / T1:** AIIMS Chowk → Ring Road → Moti Bagh Chowk → RTR Marg → Shankar Vihar Flyover → Ulaanbaatar Marg

FROM WEST DELHI

• **T3 / T4 / T2 / T1:** Punjabi Bagh Chowk → Ring Road → Raja Garden Chowk → Najafgarh Road → Pankha Road → Dabri → Dwarka Road → Road No. 224, Dabri-Gurugram Road → Sector-22, Dwarka Road → UER-II → Service Road NH-48 → T3 Terminal Road.

FROM NORTH & EAST DELHI

• **T3 / T4 / T2 / T1:** ISBT Kashmiri Gate → Rani Jhansi Flyover → Rohtak Road → Punjabi Bagh Chowk → Raja Garden Chowk → Najafgarh Road → Pankha Road → Dabri → Dwarka Road → Road No. 224, Dabri-Gurugram Road → Sector-22, Dwarka Road → UER-II → Service Road NH-48 → T3 Terminal Road



04 TRANSPORT SERVICES

• **BUS:** Necessary diversions may be given during VVIP movements.
• **METRO:** Available for commuters at all stations without disruption.
• **TSRs / TAXIS:** No roadside parking except designated areas; diversions possible during VVIP movement.



06 IMPORTANT INSTRUCTIONS & PUBLIC ADVISORY

Priority Corridors & Exemptions

• **Emergency & Medical Vehicles:** Priority, obstruction-free passage maintained 24/7 across Delhi.
• **Essential Services & Utilities:** Uninterrupted access granted for essential supplies and utility operations in all zones.

Travel Planning & Public Mobility

• **Transit Hubs:** Allow extra travel time when heading to Airports, Railway Stations and ISBTs.
• **Public Transport & Routes:** Opt for public transport and follow designated alternative routes and diversion points.
• **Commercial Traffic:** Non-destined commercial vehicles are prohibited from entering Delhi.

Traffic Rules & Parking

• **Designated Parking:** Park only in authorized areas; roadside parking within 200 meters of Controlled Roads is strictly prohibited.
• **Road Discipline:** Follow the instructions of deployed traffic personnel and obey all traffic rules patiently.

Public Safety & Updates

• **Security Vigilance:** Report any unidentified objects or suspicious activity to the nearest police officer immediately.
• **Real-Time Information:** Stay updated via official Delhi Police social media channels and traffic portals.



Public cooperation is solicited to ensure smooth transit and safety for all.



SCAN QR CODE for TRAFFIC ADVISORY BRICS Summit-2026

EXPRESS special

Man kills sister, frames her husband to claim Rs 50-lakh insurance

Pragynesh
New Delhi, September 11

ON AUGUST 21, 2017, Anita (45) was at her house in a slum cluster in North Delhi's Burari. Her sister-in-law, Anjani (44), was massaging her feet.

Anjani was married to Anita's brother Kamal Kumar (51) — a second marriage for both.

The women never liked each other and Kamal would normally avoid visiting his sister with his wife. But that night, he had asked Anjani to come along.

Anita's husband Girdhari Lal was also home.

"Kamal asked his wife to massage Anita's feet. After some time, I went to our room upstairs and slept. They were still talking," Girdhari told police.

Around 5 am the next day, police said, Girdhari came downstairs to find the main gate open. When he went to tell Anita off, he allegedly found her dead, her throat slit. He ran outside for help. Girdhari, however, later found himself in police custody. A PCR call had been made informing police that a man had killed his wife.

Police said they found no murder weapon on him or around the house. During questioning, Girdhari told them that the last person he had seen Anita with was her brother.

Police picked Kamal and he subsequently confessed to killing his sister for money and trying to frame her husband. Kamal was arrested, but two of his relatives, who allegedly helped him, had fled. Last month, nearly nine years later, police caught one of them in Bihar.

A second marriage

Police said Anita worked as a house help. Girdhari was a mason. They had no children. But she was deeply attached to Kamal's sons with his first wife, who died in 2015.



Accused Kamal

"When Kamal's first wife fell sick, it was Anita who cared for them. The children treated her no less than their own mother," said an officer.

Anita even willed her savings and assets on Kamal and his eldest son, police said.

Kamal was also the nominee on insurance policies taken by Anita and Girdhari, each worth Rs 50 lakh, said police.

However, things started to sour when Kamal married Anjani. "Anjani worked as a house help when she met Kamal," said a senior officer. Her arrival led to fights. Anita kept asking Kamal to leave Anjani, but he did not.

Kamal told police: "My sister didn't like my wife. I had to shift to a different house with Anjani and the children." Her brothers had also come from their hometown in Bihar's Lakhisarai to stay with them. The women visited each other occasionally.

Chandan became a chief mason, while Kundan worked at construction sites. Police said Anjani's father, who worked as a guard in South Delhi, also visited the family.

Money problems piled up

Kamal had been running his 'clinic' near Azadpur Mandi for nearly two decades. Police described him as a "jhola chhap (fake)" doctor and said he had only studied till Class 10.

By 2017, the 'clinic' was not doing well. According to Kamal, he had around Rs 12 lakh in

debt. "I was taking more loans, and it was all just piling up," Kamal told police.

Then he remembered his sister's insurance policy and hatched a plan. He roped in Chandan and Kundan, promising them Rs 2 lakh each.

On August 20, Kamal set his plan in motion. He went to Azadpur Mandi and bought an iron knife for Rs 100, police said.

The next evening, Kamal went to Anita's house with his wife. After a while, he asked Anjani to leave. Later that night, Chandan and Kundan arrived. "The three then held Anita down and slit her throat," a police officer said.

The catch

"It was revealed that Kamal, in conspiracy with his two brothers-in-law, murdered his sister Anita," said DCP Sanjeev Yadav.

In August this year, a Crime Branch team led by Inspector Robin and HC Mintu received a tip-off. They were told that a man had almost been caught in Bihar last year but escaped while being brought to Delhi. Police found that it was Chandan. They traced him to Lakhisarai, Bihar. "We reached his house," an officer said. The house had a nearly 20-foot-high boundary wall, topped with four-foot slanting slopes. Chandan, wary after his earlier escape, had made the house difficult to enter.

"We had to stand on top of each other. One of us reached the top and entered the compound," said an officer. Chandan was arrested. "Chandan hid in different places to evade arrest. He claimed Kundan was found dead in 2018 near the railway station in their village," said DCP Yadav. Police are probing his claim.

"No one saw his body apart from Chandan. He couldn't even tell us where he performed Kundan's last rites," said an officer.

SATYA NIKETAN BUILDING COLLAPSE

PG operator, on the run since crash that killed 7, surrenders

Pragynesh
New Delhi, September 11

DAYS AFTER a five-storey building came crashing down in South West Delhi's Satya Niketan, killing seven people, an absconding accused, who was operating the paying guest (PG) accommodation at the building, surrendered at the Patiala House Court on Friday, said police.

Identified as Shubham Tyagi, the accused had been operating the PG accommodation, called Hostel Daze, at the five-storey building along with other co-accused Sudhanshu Lovneesh, who was arrested from Rajasthan on Wednesday.

Tyagi had been on the run since Sunday after he learnt about the building collapse, said officers. On Friday, Tyagi reached the police station, where he offered to surrender. He was then taken to the court. He has been sent to two-day police custody.

Even as the accused had



Delhi Police escorts accused in the Satya Niketan building collapse case to produce them before Patiala House Court Friday. ANI

earlier reportedly claimed that he only contributed financially to the PG operation, investigators have found that the building was leased out last year to both Tyagi and his partner, said sources.

The upper ground and first floors of the building were leased out to Lovneesh while the second and third floors were leased out to Tyagi,

sources added.

Tyagi is the seventh person to be arrested in the case. Apart from Lovneesh, building owner Hariram, wife Urmila, their son Mahesh and labour contractor Saroj were arrested earlier this week.

As per the investigators, the building owner had permission to build only the first and second floor. Three additional

Illegally run from basements, says MCD, seals 54 jewellery stores in Chandni Chowk

Mishal Mussaddique
New Delhi, September 11

AS PART of its ongoing drive against unauthorised commercial activities, the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) sealed 54 jewellery shops operating from basements across four buildings in the Kucha Mahajani area of Chandni Chowk on Thursday, leaving many traders' gold and silver jewellery locked inside their shops.

The shopkeepers claim that MCD authorities arrived in the area around 11:30 am on Thursday without prior notice and asked them to step outside and shut their shops. The officials then stuck sealing order notices on the shutters, locked the shops, and sealed them, they added.

According to the sealing order, commercial trade was being run in the basements of these shops, which violates the permitted usage under the Master Plan of Delhi (MPD) 2021.

The order states that a show-cause notice was first issued on November 19, 2019, under Section 345-A of the Delhi Municipal Corporation (DMC) Act, 1957, directing the owners/occupiers to stop the commercial misuse of the basements within 48 hours. Subsequently, multiple opportunities for personal hearings were given to the owners in 2025, following which the traders were directed to pay a penalty amounting to 12 times the annual conversion charges — a directive they did not comply with. Following this, a

sealing order was issued against the shops on February 17 this year.

MCD's official statement read: "Acting on the directions of the Monitoring Committee/Supreme Court, MCD on 10.09.2026 carried out sealing action against 54 illegal shops operating from basements at properties...Kucha Mahajani, Chandni Chowk. The action was taken against illegal commercial activities being carried out in violation of Unified Building Bye-Laws (UBBL) for Delhi 2016 and MPD-2021, including non-compliance with mandatory Fire Department and other statutory clearances... Sealing orders were issued under Section 345-A read with Section 347 of the DMC Act, pursuant to which all 54 illegal

floors were later added. Moreover, the ongoing construction work in the basement — which was allegedly started to address seepage issues, according to the owner — had weakened the structure.

The Indian Express reported on Friday that Lovneesh was warned by a labourer that the building may collapse hours before the incident. During the police questioning, Lovneesh had also claimed that he had warned Mahesh not to go ahead with the renovation work.

Lovneesh and Tyagi were in charge of installing the 16-bed facility with amenities, looking after maintenance, and overseeing the repair and construction work needed at the decades-old building. They ran similar units in other parts of the area too.

Lovneesh was the main person prospective tenants met when they came looking for rooms, sources in the police had earlier said.

After meeting CM, Haryana sanitation workers call off strike

Express News Service
Chandigarh, September 11

SANITATION WORKERS in Haryana on Friday announced the withdrawal of their 37-day-long agitation after reaching an agreement with the state government, providing much-needed relief to urban residents across the state.

The breakthrough came during a meeting in Chandigarh on Friday between Nagarpalika Karamchari Sangh leaders and Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini. "The government agreed to several demands," Nagarpalika Karamchari Sangh leaders said.

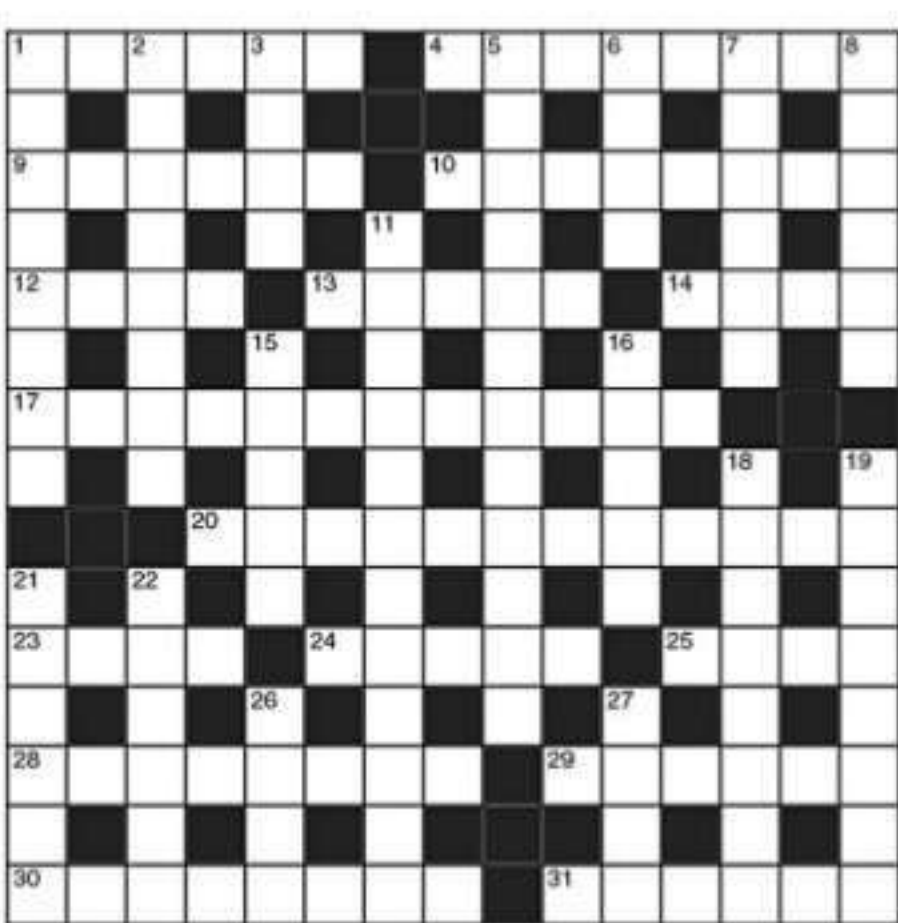
Thousands of sanitation workers had been on strike since August 6 over their 13 demands, severely affecting sanitation conditions in urban areas across the state. During the strike, tension ensued as officials, accompanied by police personnel, attempted to lift garbage using earth-moving machines.

Expressing their gratitude to Saini, sanitation workers' leader Naresh Shastri said, "The Chief Minister has accepted our demands and a written agreement has been undertaken."

"According to the agreement reached at the meeting, sanitation workers on the municipal payroll will be regularised on vacant posts. Contract workers will also be awarded marks for their experience in the regular recruitment process, and a provision has been made to provide them regular employment through the recruitment process," Shastri said. According to a government official, as demanded by the workers, those on municipal rolls will be extended Leave Travel Concession benefit. In-principle approval was also given to extend the medical cashless policy applicable to regular employees of urban local bodies, pensioners and dependents. "Besides, the department has already issued instructions for the payment of a risk allowance of Rs 2,000 per month to workers on municipal rolls," the official said.

CROSSWORD

6092



ACROSS

- Footsore group of workers led by a blockhead (6)
- Stick or bond with glue perhaps (8)
- Not quite a fifty majority (6)
- Sparkling silver on issue (8)
- Grass blown in the wind? (4)
- Black mark may be examined in the lab (5)
- The way you once talked of an eyesore (4)
- Dispels suspicion so that all breathe more easily (6,3,3)
- More than mean (5,7)
- They may be placed but are best misplaced (4)
- Trembling because going to prison (5)
- Whip cut (4)
- Oddly Rex meets the limits (8)
- As a decoration it's not so hot we hear (6)
- Indecision shows us soft in reason (8)
- People count (6)

DOWN

- A crafty contest (4,4)
- Told off (8)
- Turn out to be in error about a point (4)
- It may well determine how one's case proceeds (7,5)
- Spot a weak type (4)
- Noted national property (6)
- Tenders used in harbours (6)
- They aren't charged but make the most noise (5,7)
- Some of them come from Basra (5)
- Organ I have in both sides of my body (5)
- The beauty of justice (8)
- Impotent without servants? (8)
- A sailor girl with unmarried sisters in her care (6)
- Conditions in Kansas and Ohio for example (6)
- Present from the Red Cross (4)
- Surgeon's inner compulsion (4)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6091 **ACROSS:** 1 Tempo, 4 At stake, 8 Ass, 9 Economist, 10 Tirades, 11 Kabul, 13 Rascal, 15 Writer, 18 Tessa, 19 Angelus, 21 Perdition, 23 Ago, 24 Concern, 25 Ahead **DOWN:** 1 Tractor, 2 Mistrusts, 3 Oread, 4 Arouse, 5 Snooker, 6 Ali, 7 Extol, 12 Battle-axe, 14 Avarice, 16 Respond, 17 Nation, 18 Topic, 20 Genoa, 22 Run

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

The world tolerates ____ from those who are successful, but not from anybody else. - John Blake (7)

DOREO ACETCN
VITAS EIMNOC

ANSWER: The world tolerates conceit from those who are successful, but not from anybody else. - John Blake

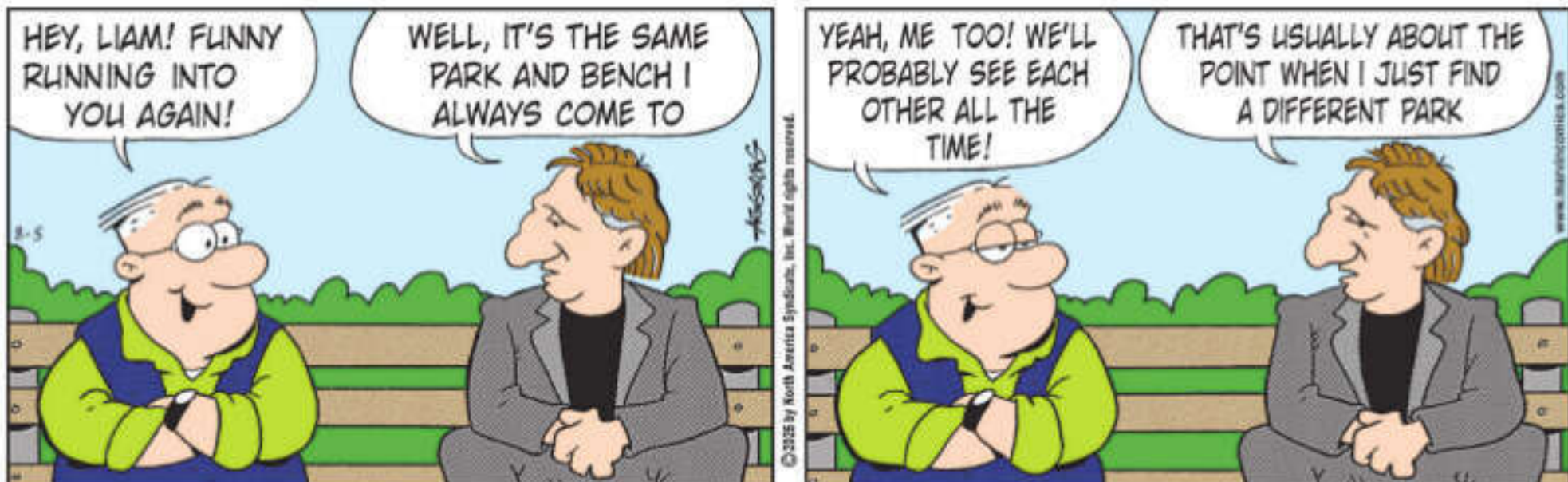
OVER THE HEDGE



CALVIN & HOBBS



MARVIN



DIFFICULTY LEVEL 5s INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL

1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy; 3s = Medium; 4s = Hard; 5s = Very Hard; 6s = Genius



ROYAL STARS

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): Relax and take it easy today. The Moon is opposite your sign, which can create a bit of confusion. Furthermore, the way the cards are falling today, you might have to accommodate someone else. In fact, a friend or a member of a group might come on strong. Tonight: Partners and close friends.

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): In one way, you have a lot of energy to get things done today. Nevertheless, something in the wind is confusing, which might make you second-guess yourself. Also, something to do with money or your possessions might surprise you. Tonight: A health tip?

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): Enjoy socialising with others today. Sports events and fun activities with kids will also appeal. Many of you will be unusually creative and full of original ideas. However, be vigilant with children to avoid accidents. Tonight: Have fun socialising.

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): Be gentle with family members today. Your home routine might be interrupted. Small appliances might break down or a minor breakage could occur. Tonight: Take it easy.

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): Today is full of peppy energy and you're full of ideas. You might suddenly take a short trip. You might see new places and meet new faces. Steer clear of controversial topics, because an element of confusion is possible. Tonight: Talk to someone.

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): Keep an eye on your cash flow, earnings and possessions today, because something unexpected might happen. It might be favourable, or not. However, you might see a new way to make money. Tonight: Take care of your possessions.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): Today the Moon is in your sign dancing with some planets and being challenged by others. It's a mixed bag. If conversations seem to go sideways, don't press any issues because confusion is likely. Tonight: You're in charge.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): You might explore shopping for your wardrobe today. Because your impulses are strong, keep your receipts, and the box. Today, you have a lot of energy, so you may either talk with others or tackle your to-do list. Tonight: Enjoy privacy.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): You make a great impression on others today, which is why you might have a fun exchange with a female friend or acquaintance. Whatever happens might surprise you. Or you might meet someone unusual. Tonight: Be friendly.

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): Be aware that you are noticed more than usual today. You might want to make a strong statement about something, perhaps impulsively. If so, be clear in your communications, because you might be misunderstood. Tonight: Be modest.

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): Travel plans are unpredictable. Unusual ideas, especially about philosophy, religion and politics, might intrigue you today. Tonight: Study.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): Be cautious about dividing or sharing something today or handling someone else's money or their possessions. Discussions about shared property and banking issues also might misunderstood. Tonight: Check your finances.



People participate in the BRICS Dialogue on Civilizations at Rio de Janeiro State University in Rio de Janeiro, Brazil, June 27, 2025. (Xinhua/Wang Tiancong)

The expansion of BRICS marks a qualitative leap in its representativeness and influence. Today, BRICS countries account for nearly half of the world's population, around 30 percent of global economic output, and one-fifth of global trade. The greater BRICS cooperation has entered a stage of high-quality development.



Media professionals work at the media center of the 16th BRICS Summit in Kazan, Russia, Oct. 22, 2024. (Xinhua/Cao Yang)



A businessman (R) from India selects toys at the Yiwu International Trade Market in Yiwu City, east China's Zhejiang Province, Feb. 2, 2023. (Xinhua/Huang Zongzhi)



A drone photo taken on June 17, 2022 shows the headquarters building of the New Development Bank in east China's Shanghai. (Xinhua/Fang Zhe)



An aerial drone photo taken on Aug. 20, 2024 shows a view of the Redstone Concentrated Solar Thermal Power Project near Postmasburg in Northern Cape Province of South Africa. (Xinhua/Zhang Yudong)



A staff member introduces products via livestreaming at the booth of Iran during the 10th Silk Road International Exposition in Xi'an, northwest China's Shaanxi Province, May 21, 2026. (Xinhua/Zhang Sijie)



The China National Center for the Performing Arts (NCPA) Chorus, rehearses with Choralla, a local Saudi choir, for the World Famous Songs Concert at the King Abdulaziz Center for World Culture, in Dhahran, Saudi Arabia, Dec. 11, 2025. (Xinhua/Wang Haizhou)



People visit the exhibition "On Top of the Pyramid: The Civilization of Ancient Egypt" at the Shanghai Museum in east China's Shanghai, Aug. 11, 2025. (Xinhua/Liu Ying)



This photo taken on June 7, 2026 shows a China-made self-driving taxi near the Burj Al Arab hotel in Dubai, the United Arab Emirates. (Xinhua/Wen Xinnian)



Workers sort coffee beans to be exported to China at a coffee processing plant in Addis Ababa, Ethiopia, Feb.13, 2026. (Xinhua/Geng Xinning)



Passengers pose for photos with a model of a high-speed electrical multiple unit (EMU) train of the Jakarta-Bandung high-speed railway at the waiting hall of Halim Station in Jakarta, Indonesia, April 28, 2025. (Xinhua/Xu Qin)



President of Egypt Abdel Fattah El-Sisi being received by Minister of State for Defence Sanjay Seth. PTI



Minister of State for External Affairs Kirti Vardhan Singh receives Malaysian Prime Minister Anwar Ibrahim at Delhi airport. PTI



South African President Cyril Ramaphosa inspects a joint military guard of honour upon his arrival in New Delhi. AP

• BRIEFLY



Prime Minister Narendra Modi presents a copy of the translated version of *Thirukkural* to Russian President Vladimir Putin, Friday. PTI

Modi presents Putin with Russian translation of *Thirukkural*

When Prime Minister Narendra Modi met Russian President Vladimir Putin, on the sidelines of the 18th BRICS Summit in New Delhi on Friday, he gifted the visiting leader a copy of *Thirukkural*, a classic Tamil text. Modi presented the Russian translation of *Thirukkural*, which is published by the Central Institute of Classical Tamil (CICT), an autonomous Institution under the Union Ministry of Education. It is learnt that the official arranged the book from the CICT, which has published the book in 22 Indian languages and over half a dozen foreign languages. ENS

Goodie bags for foreign media delegates

FOREIGN MEDIA delegates in India to report on the high octane BRICS summit, were gifted a curated goodie bag Friday which included Koraput Arabica filter coffee and mug for a morning boost, *makhana* and *sattu* from Bihar to beat the dehydrating Delhi humidity, a tote bag and of course a charging port to keep up with the dizzying level of breaking news. ENS

Modi to host gala dinner tonight

ON THE occasion of the 18th BRICS Summit, Prime Minister Narendra Modi will host a gala dinner on Saturday evening. In addition to all foreign guests, it is learnt that all Union ministers have been invited for the dinner. In view of traffic restrictions, ministers have also been asked to assemble at Parliament House, from where they will proceed in buses to the venue. ENS

Xi-Modi talks today, Beijing says will work to ‘be partners helping each other succeed’

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, September 11

AHEAD OF Chinese President Xi Jinping's arrival in New Delhi for the BRICS summit and a bilateral meeting with Prime Minister Narendra Modi Saturday, Beijing said Friday that the two countries will work to “handle the bilateral relations from a strategic height and long-term perspective” and “be friends” and “partners helping each other succeed.” Xi's visit, his first to India in seven years, is expected to give new impetus to efforts by the two countries for restoration of ties after a long, tense military standoff along the Line of Actual Control in eastern Ladakh. Xi last visited India in October 2019 when he travelled to Mamallapuram near Chennai for an informal bilateral summit. Ties plummeted after the military standoff began in the summer of 2020. On Friday, Xu Feihong, China's Ambassador to India, in a post on X, said, “China and India are arranging for the bilateral meeting between President Xi and Prime Minister Modi. This will be the third year in a row for the two leaders to meet with each other, following their meetings in Kazan and Tianjin.” “China will work with India to act on the strategic guidance of the two leaders, handle the bilateral relations from a strategic height and long-term perspective, step up communication, enhance cooperation, properly handle differences, and be friends enjoying good neighborliness and partners helping each other succeed,” Xu said. In Beijing, India's Ambassador to China, Vikram Doraiswami, in an opinion piece in CGTN, said, “A stable, predictable and cooperative relationship between India and China is not only in the interest of our own 2.8 billion people, but is also a significant factor for the credibility and effectiveness of BRICS as an action-oriented platform for emerging economies.” “There is reason for confidence here. Over the past year, India and China have maintained sustained engagement at the working level, complemented by high-level exchanges that have helped build trust and understanding between our two sides. This has translated into genuine cooperation on the ground,” he said.

On women-led businesses, Iran and UAE are on the same page

Divyva A
New Delhi, September 11

IRAN AND the United Arab Emirates (UAE) may have their geopolitical differences, but they found themselves on the same page at the BRICS Business Forum on Friday as member countries agreed on the need to build networks among women entrepreneurs and innovators across the bloc. As countries across the region battle financial uncertainty in the wake of ongoing conflicts in Russia-Ukraine and West Asia, both Iran and the UAE weighed in on the potential of millions of women entrepreneurs across the 21 countries for building resilience. “Women-led businesses across BRICS are increasingly present in sectors such as manufacturing, services, digital economy, agribusiness and creative industries. However, their participation in cross-border trade and investment remains constrained by limited market access, financing gaps, regulatory barriers and weaker integration into global and regional value chains,” said Zahra Rahaie, founder and CEO of Navak Chemipaksh, which is among Iran's biggest pharma chemical companies. Addressing the gathering, she also pitched for the bloc to create a B2B matchmaking platform for women entrepreneurs and focus on more integration. “Not just inclusion, but strategic integration,” she emphasised. Talking about her experience, Rahaie, also the president of the National Association of Women Entrepreneurs of Iran, told The Indian Express later: “Women entrepreneurs operating in challenging economies such as Iran that face sanctions have capabilities for frugal innovation. They have mastered all of the resources to drive highly sustainable innovations.” From the UAE, Feryal Ahmadi, Deputy CEO and Chief Operating Officer of Dubai Multi Commodities Centre, a government-owned free-trade zone and commodities marketplace in Dubai, spoke about the practical mechanisms that can help women-led businesses use the UAE as a bridge to enter other international markets. “The UAE has developed an extremely successful model of their business model provisioning, which helps us all grow together,” she said. At a panel discussion on ‘Women in Business: Driving Partnerships on BRICS Economies’ earlier in the day, Anna Nesterova, Chairperson of the BRICS Women's Business Alliance (Russia) and Development Founder of Palekh Watch, said that cultural exchange, driven by women entrepreneurs, is not actually a soft topic but a business tool. “It builds trust,” she said, adding, “It's important to get access to funding, and we need new mechanisms for funding joint projects in BRICS that are oriented towards medium and small enterprises, and women-led enterprises.” At the session, which had an all-woman panel speaking to a room full of mostly men, it was noted that across BRICS countries, about 80 per cent MSMEs (micro, small and medium enterprises) are led by women or involve women in a big way, and focus on that segment could build resilience in the region. While all delegations participating in the business forum had women representatives, there was a feeling that the representation of women-led businesses in BRICS should move “from symbolic inclusion to systematic integration”. Across BRICS, women are building businesses, creating jobs and driving innovation across sectors. The opportunity now is to strengthen their access to markets, finance, technology, and cross-border partnerships, said Mónica Monteiro, Chairperson of BRICS Women's Business Alliance in Brazil. “We need to be present when BRICS member states talk about trade and investment and economy,” she said. The BRICS Women's Business Alliance (WBA) is an official cooperation mechanism established in 2020 to increase women's economic participation and leadership across member countries. It aims to unleash the business potential of women and integrate women-led enterprises into global value chains. As the Chair of BRICS moves from India to China, Zhao Haiying, Chairperson of WBA's Chinese chapter, underlined the opportunity to build networks and make them commercially meaningful through BRICS cooperation, moving from introductions to partnerships, and connections to measurable economic profits. “We have the governance, we have organisation, we have network, we have the human right to do business. And this is a great achievement. But now we need to be heard,” Monteiro said.

AMID WEST ASIA WAR, IRAN PRESIDENT IN DELHI FOR BRICS
Pezeshkian meets Modi: ‘We can revive relations’

Targets US, says Tehran, Delhi can boost ties, from trade to tech

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, September 11

IN A signal to the world, Iran's President Masoud Pezeshkian, after meeting Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Friday evening, said India and Iran can “revive the relations together”, and the talks will pave the way for further cooperation in trade, economy, technology, among other areas. This is Pezeshkian's first visit to India as Iran's President. The last Iranian President to visit India was Hassan Rouhani in February 2018. Pezeshkian, who is visiting India for the BRICS Leaders' Summit on September 12 and 13, used the opportunity to signal that Iran was not isolated. After the bilateral talks, he spoke at an event organised to meet religious leaders and businesses. “I have to appreciate the government of India and the Prime Minister for his very nice hospitality. We have had very nice talks with each other. And I hope that these talks and relations will pave the way for further cooperation and sym-



Prime Minister Narendra Modi with Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian in New Delhi, Friday. ANI

pathy in developing culture, technology, trade, science, economy, and other areas. Actually, we can revive them together.” Giving a hard-hitting message to the US, he said, “Today, Iran has been able to successfully stand against Israel and the United States at the same time; they want to bully us, and we do not want to be bullied. We never kneel down before them. If they push us, we push back. They claim that they are advocates of human rights. In truth, they are the devils who are the true terrorists, because they killed 168 schoolchildren in one instant, thanks to their modern technologies.” “You (the US) call us terrorists? What about you, who kill human beings, bomb scientists, and attack schools and hospitals? If you are man enough, just fight the soldiers, the military people. Why do you target infrastructure and people's livelihoods?... The people of Iran will not surrender. We believe in human values, and we believe that all who live — all humanity — enjoy equal rights,” he said. Pezeshkian's visit is significant as Iran has been fighting a war with the US and Israel since

Terror to institutional reforms: BRICS to spell out common ground in declaration

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, September 11

BRICS' DELHI declaration is all set to spell out a common stand against terrorism, consensus for reform of institutions of global governance and strengthened multilateralism and support for India's UN Security Council bid, The Indian Express has learnt. According to sources, these are among the 10 broad takeaways likely to be part of the BRICS leaders' declaration to be adopted on September 12-13. The BRICS Sherpas, sources said, have been trying to hammer out a consensus on the war in West Asia, where Iran and the UAE are divided on the framing of the language. One of the formulations being explored is there can be a “universal condemnation” of violation of territorial integrity and sovereignty — without naming any country. While that is still being discussed, the BRICS Sherpas from

the 11 member countries have agreed on a common language and takeaways. First, a common stand against terrorism has been arrived at, with BRICS countries agreeing to unequivocal condemnation of terrorism and a commitment to combat it in all its forms, said sources. Second, a people-centric approach to India's BRICS chairship, guided by the spirit of “humanity first”, with outcomes helping people of BRICS nations, including women, farmers and entrepreneurs. Third, the BRICS countries have come to a consensus on reform of institutions of global governance and strengthened multilateralism and support for India's UNSC bid. Fourth, BRICS has committed to be a “stronger voice for the Global South”, and India's role in ensuring that the priorities, perspectives and aspirations of the Global South are

adequately reflected in the emerging world order. Fifth, BRICS will also commit to be “ready to share development experience with the Global South”. The summit is showcasing India's strengths and development experience, and highlighting India's rich heritage and culture, people-centric innovations, and home-grown solutions as contributions to shared progress, officials said. Six, BRICS is going to be a “bridge builder”, and position BRICS as a platform for dialogue, understanding and constructive cooperation. This has been a theme in the ministerial and agency-level meetings. Seventh, Indian officials are getting members to “reposition BRICS as a complementary, development-oriented grouping”. This is an important signal at a time when China and Russia have sought to give a harder security and military edge to the grouping. Eighth, officials said the BRICS declaration is going to have “practical, development-oriented outcomes”, which have been achieved over 50 tangible outcomes, including agreed frameworks, action plans, guidelines, principles, forums and networks, for collaboration across the four priority pillars — resilience, innovation, cooperation and sustainability. Ninth, like the G20 summit in 2023, officials said the BRICS Summit too has been a “whole-of-nation effort”, which has brought together Central government, states, institutions, industry, academia, youth, civil society and communities in a shared effort, with events being held in more than 30 cities. And tenth, just like in 2023 for the G20 grouping, there has been robust participation from BRICS nations throughout the year, and it has ensured substantive participation from BRICS countries, officials said.

UN chief Guterres meets PM, discusses West Asia, Ukraine

Press Trust of India
United Nations, September 11

UN SECRETARY-General Antonio Guterres on Friday held wide-ranging discussions with Prime Minister Narendra Modi on current conflicts in West Asia and Ukraine, and the world body chief reaffirming the principle of freedom of navigation. Guterres met Modi in New Delhi on the sidelines of the 18th BRICS summit that India is hosting on September 12-13. The two leaders “had a wide-ranging discussion on the current conflicts in the Middle East and Ukraine, and the impact both are having on the global economy, including regarding

access to food and fertiliser,” the office of Guterres' Spokesperson said in a statement. It said the secretary-general “reaffirmed the principle of freedom of navigation”. The two leaders also exchanged views on the growing danger of lethal autonomous weapons. Guterres expressed appreciation for India's close cooperation with the United Nations. The UN chief has been invited to speak at the summit's Open Session on ‘Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability: Shaping the Future for Inclusive Global Growth’ on September 13. Guterres had travelled to India in February to attend the India AI Impact Summit 2026 in New Delhi.

• AFTER MAKING ITS DEBUT IN FRANCE IN 2026, THE BRICS BHARAT INNOVATES IS THE SECOND MAJOR EXPOSITION OF INDIA'S DEEP-TECH STARTUPS
AI cancer screening among 37 innovations on display

Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, September 11

AI-ENABLED cervical cancer screening, floating solar PV, marine robotics, rare-earth-free e-powertrains and AI-based maternal-fetal monitoring system are among 37 innovations on display at an exposition organised by the Ministry of Education in coordination with the Ministry of External Affairs as part of the 18th BRICS Summit, at Bharat Mandapam. The two-day ‘Bharat Innovates Exposition’, at Bharat Mandapam on Friday and Saturday, will showcase India's deep-tech innovations. The national programme is

designed as a global accelerator for innovations from the Indian Higher Education Ecosystem — building a long-term collaboration between India's innovation ecosystem (startups, Higher Education Institutions (HEIs), labs and research parks) and global stakeholders (corporates, investors, incubators/accelerators, universities, research institutes, governments and overseas alumni). “The BRICS Bharat Innovates (BBI) Exposition at the Bharat Mandapam marks the second major exposition of India's Deep-Tech startups in 2026 after the maiden edition of Bharat Innovates that was held in Nice, France from 14-16 June



Union Minister Pralhad Joshi visits BRICS Bharat Innovates Exposition at Bharat Mandapam on Friday. PTI

2026,” the education ministry said in a statement. The BBI, it added, is aligned with the theme of India's BRICS Chairship — ‘Building for Resil-

ience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability’. The Exposition is being held alongside BRICS Business Forum on 11 September 2026,

providing participants with an opportunity to network with CEOs, investors, business leaders and industry representatives from BRICS member countries. This will facilitate opportunities for B2B engagements, technology partnerships, investment discussions, business linkages and international market access, the MoE said. The exposition, it added, also advances the BRICS Education Track priority of “Enhancing Research, Innovation and Start-up Ecosystems”, one of the five priority areas identified under India's BRICS Chairship 2026. Education Minister Pralhad Joshi was at the exposition at

Bharat Mandapam interacting with deep-tech startups/innovators. “Visited the BRICS Bharat Innovates Exposition being held as part of the 18th #BRICS Summit at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi and interacted with Indian deep-tech innovators showcasing cutting-edge solutions across diverse sectors. Under the leadership of PMS Shri @narendramodi, they are being provided with a unique platform where these startups will showcase their unique skills before the BRICS leaders tomorrow,” said Joshi on an X post. Prime Minister Narendra Modi and BRICS leaders, among others, are also expected to visit the BBI Exposition.



In Master's Footsteps

AS HE prepares to handle more responsibilities in party and politics, Shiv Sena (Shinde) Lok Sabha MP Shrikanth Shinde has taken up another assignment — a master's degree in business administration at the London School of Economics. Shinde, who already holds an MS in orthopaedics, has enrolled for his second master's at TRIUM Global Executive MBA programme offered jointly by LSE, NYU Stern and HEC Paris. The 39-year-old MP has a "political" explanation for his latest pursuit — he wants to follow B R Ambedkar's footsteps and expand his academic qualification to economics and policy. Shinde, who has already learnt the skill to heal, says he wants to learn how to deal with complex economic issues and policies. To complete his 18-month MBA programme, he needs to visit the London campus once every six months. The rest of the time, Shinde can pursue his studies while continuing his political activities in Maharashtra and in Parliament.

Narrative War

THE LAUNCH of foldable iPhone Duo on September 9 was watched not only by potential buyers but also by political social media teams across party lines. It may still be over a month away from being available in stores, but the latest Apple device quickly entered the national social media-based narrative war. The BJP, the Congress and the AAP used the phone's launch video to create memes and mock each other.



Devashish Sharma

IAS officer gets BJP ticket to contest Nagaon bypoll days after vacating DC post

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 11

A WEEK after he resigned as Deputy Commissioner (DC) of Assam's Nagaon district, the BJP announced Devashish Sharma as its candidate for the Nagaon Lok Sabha by-poll next month.

On the nomination, BJP Assam spokesperson Rupam Goswami said, "Sharma is a good bureaucrat. Social service is ingrained in him. The BJP always supports these kinds of people. He likes being among the people and is liked and respected by all." An IAS officer from the 2011 Assam-Meghalaya cadre, Sharma was posted as DC Nagaon in June 2025. He is regarded as an approachable and fair administrator, and is popular across different communities in this sensitive district.

On September 3, Sharma took voluntary retirement from the service, and just days later, on September 8, joined the BJP. Congress had criticised the move, with its Dhubri MP Rakiul Hussain writing to the Election Commission of India requesting a review of decisions taken during Sharma's tenure. Sharma did not respond to calls from *The Indian Express*.

Behind arms heist, a former Army havildar who held grudge against CO

Sreenivas Janyala
Hyderabad, September 11

A FORMER havildar of the Army has been arrested for last month's arms heist at 20 Madras Regiment at Bolarum in Secunderabad Cantonment, police have said — a development that comes hours after investigators claimed to have traced the weapons to a location in Hyderabad.

During a press conference on Friday, Director General of Police C V Anand said that the former havildar, who police have not yet named, broke open the locks of the armoury and stole 12 weapons and ammunition, including four AK-203 assault rifles, seven pistols and an INSAS rifle.

Anand said that the suspect was dismissed from service on June 30, and that the heist was



The stolen weapons have been recovered, police said, adding that four accused are currently in police custody. EXPRESS

an act of revenge against his commanding officer.

Originally from Telangana's Nagarkurnool district, the suspect is believed to live with his family on the outskirts of Hyderabad. Police said that the

former Armyman entered the premises twice on August 31 night by telling the guard that he was from the regiment, and used a scooter to take out the weapons and ammunition. Three others are also in police custody in connection with the theft, the DGP said, adding that the stolen weapons have been recovered.

The suspect first broke open the armoury lock and took out 12 weapons, hiding them in the thick foliage outside. When he tried to enter the second time, a guard allegedly asked him to identify himself, and he claimed he was from the regiment. "It was the theft of AK-203 assault rifles and INSAS rifles that raised suspicion that it could have been an inside job," the DGP said.

According to investigators, the suspect rode home with the arms on a scooter, transferred the cache to his car and headed to Achampet, avoiding the main roads to evade capture. "After questioning over 70 people and finding no clue, we turned our attention to recently retired people and narrowed down on the suspect. We confronted him

with technical evidence — including his cellphone location and CCTV images, and he finally confessed," the DGP said.

Officials said that the suspect tried to bury the cache at different locations to avoid being tracked. The DGP said that officials from Military Intelligence and other agencies helped police crack the case. He said that the case is being investigated.

The theft was discovered on August 31 during an inventory, and Army personnel lodged a police complaint on September 1. Police registered a case of trespass or house-breaking by night to commit an offence and theft in a building used for the custody of property or government property. The theft occurred at a time when the battalion — including its commanding officer — was at Pokhran in Rajasthan for field exercises.



US Ambassador to India Sergio Gor meets Manipur Chief Minister Y Khemchand Singh in Imphal on Friday. CM SECRETARIAT

Gor meets Manipur CM & Gov, discusses tourism, economic ties

Jimmy Leivon
Imphal, September 11

US AMBASSADOR to India Sergio Gor arrived in Manipur's capital city Imphal for a two-day visit on Friday.

His visit marks a significant high-level diplomatic engagement at a time when the state is grappling with a humanitarian crisis stemming from the ongoing ethnic conflict in the region. Gor was accompanied by the US Consul General in Kolkata, Kathy Giles-Diaz.

Soon after his arrival, the envoy visited the iconic Ema Keithel, arguably the world's largest all-women market, located in the heart of the capital city. The place dates back to the 16th century and its name literally translates to 'Mother's Market'. Gor interacted with several woman vendors here.

He also visited Kangla Fort, the administrative centre of the erstwhile Kingdom of Manipur and a key historical and archaeological site. Following these visits, Gor met Manipur Chief Minister Y Khemchand Singh at the Secretariat in Mantripukhri. During the meeting, the latter

highlighted tourism and allied sectors as potential areas for development and cooperation.

In a post on X, Gor wrote, "Enjoyed hearing from Chief Minister Y Khemchand Singh about his vision for Manipur. We exchanged ideas about how the US and India can work together to expand economic ties. The Chief Minister very kindly invited me back for the Manipur Sangai Festival."

In a reciprocal gesture, Singh wrote on X, "It was a pleasure to meet the Ambassador of United States to India, Mr Sergio Gor, at my Secretariat today. We had the opportunity to discuss relations between the US and Manipur. I am confident that the engagement between the US and Manipur (India) will strengthen in the years to come."

Later, the envoy met Manipur Governor Ajay Kumar Bhalla at the latter's official residence. "Appreciated the opportunity to meet Manipur Governor Ajay Kumar Bhalla. We discussed the importance of continued US-India engagement," Gor wrote in another post. He is scheduled to leave Imphal on Saturday.

Censor Board meets after six years, members ask who's on film review panel

Amrita Nayak Dutta
New Delhi, September 11

AT A Central Board of Film Certification (CBFC) meeting after a six-year gap, members have requested a list of those who consistently headed Revising Committees in recent years to review films. *The Indian Express* has learnt.

Recent films that sparked a controversy, strategies for moving forward, and industry outreach programmes were also discussed at the virtual meeting, sources said. Within the CBFC framework, a Revising Committee is a panel that reviews a film if the producers or the board are unhappy with the Examining Committee's decision. An investigation by *The Indian Express* in September 2025 revealed that three board members had been heading most Revising Committees.

The 149th meeting of the CBFC, also known as the Censor Board, took place on August 29 — first after Shashi Shekhar Vempati took over as the CBFC

chairperson. Under the Cinematograph (Certification) Rules 2024, the CBFC board must meet once every quarter. The 12-member board last met on August 31, 2019, and none of the members have been officially re-appointed since 2017, even though their tenure was three years long. The board was last re-constituted on August 1, 2017.

According to sources, it was also discussed that the board should meet at least once quarterly, in accordance with the rules. The Cinematograph (Certification) Rules, 2024, notified in supersession of the Cinematograph (Certification) Rules, 1983, also came up for discussion. A request for clarification on the difference between age-based certification of 16 years and 18 years also came up.

The 2024 Rules introduced age-based certification categories by subdividing the existing UA category into three age-based categories — seven years (UA 7+), thirteen years (UA 13+), and sixteen years (UA 16+), instead of twelve years.

Vibrant events and infra development: Why more tourists now pick Ladakh

Naveed Iqbal
Srinagar, September 11

THE LADAKH administration on Wednesday released tourism numbers for the Union Territory that showed a marked increase in numbers this year. Between January and August, over 4.5 lakh tourists visited the region — higher than the cumulative figure for last year.

In the first eight months of 2026, the total tourist footfall has exceeded the tourist arrivals recorded in 2025 by 20.61%. The growth has been recorded across both domestic and foreign tourists. Between January and August 2026, Ladakh received over 3 lakh domestic tourists and 33,346 foreign tourists, compared to 2,44,308 domestic and 25,082 foreign tourists during the corresponding period in 2025.

August saw the highest foreign tourist footfall recorded in any month so far this year, with 10,075 foreign tourists visiting Ladakh, officials in the administration said. This is considerably higher than the 8,148 foreign tourists recorded in August 2025.

Ladakh Lieutenant Governor Vinai Kumar Saxena termed the growth in tourism numbers "significant", and attributed it to the Centre's sustained push for infrastructure development in Ladakh as well as Prime Minister Narendra Modi's appeal to citizens to visit tourist places in India and promote domestic tourism.

"The fact that Ladakh has already crossed its entire 2025 tourist footfall in just eight months of this year is a very encouraging sign. Our focus, however, is not merely on increasing tourist numbers, but on building a sustainable, responsible and year-round tourism economy that benefits our people," Saxena said.



Between January and August 2026, over 4.5 lakh tourists visited Ladakh — higher than the cumulative figure for 2025. SHUAIB MASOODI

The UT has hosted several festivals, sporting events and cultural programmes that help the government expand the tourism calendar beyond the traditional summer season and bring visitors to Ladakh during the shoulder and off-seasons.

"This creates more sustained livelihood opportunities for our youth, entrepreneurs, homestays, artisans, transporters and local communities. At the same time, visitors will also have the advantage in terms of cheaper air fares, hotels and less crowd."

By developing a calendar of festivals, sporting and cultural programmes, adventure activities and other experiences, the stated aim of the administration is to encourage visitors to travel to Ladakh during the shoulder and off-seasons as well. In August, major festivals like Changthang Nomadic Festival, the first-ever Black-necked Crane Festival, Suru Summer Festival and Ladakh Book Festival added new attractions to Ladakh's tourism calendar, and attracted a large number of tourists.

The first edition of the Black-Necked Crane Festival alone saw the participation of more

than 10,000 people from India and abroad. These festivals showcased the region's unique culture, nomadic traditions, wildlife, and natural heritage.

The tourism calendar remains active in September as well, with a series of major events lined up, including Ladakh Bike Week, Ladakh Festival, Zanskar Festival, and the Ladakh Marathon. The marathon, in particular, attracts runners from across the country and beyond, with many participants travelling to Ladakh with their families, thereby generating wider benefits for hotels, homestays, restaurants, transport operators, guides, local businesses and other tourism-related services.

The tourism growth assumes greater significance and coincides with a major and rapid transformation in Ladakh's connectivity infrastructure since the formation of the UT. According to government estimates, nearly 55% tourists visiting Ladakh arrive by road. Of this, 36% enter Ladakh through the Kashmir route, while 19% arrive through Himachal Pradesh's Manali. The total road network in Ladakh has also increased from 1,799 km in 2019 to over 4,200 km in 2026, while the number of bridges has increased from 19 to 72.

Man held in Mumbai mall fabricated PMO ID card using ChatGPT, say police

Express News Service
Mumbai, September 11

ONE OF the two men arrested by Mumbai police for allegedly using a fake Prime Minister's Office (PMO) ID card to gain entry into Jio World Plaza in Bandra-Kurla Complex created it himself using AI platform ChatGPT in 2025, police said.

A day before PM Narendra Modi arrived in Mumbai on Tuesday to inaugurate the Global Fintech Fest 2026, the two men — a businessman and his bodyguard, who is a retired Armyman — were arrested while trying to enter the mall carry-

ing a fake PMO ID card, as well as a licensed revolver and six live cartridges, police said.

The accused, identified as businessman Rohan Premal Parikh (24) and his bodyguard Dilip Rajaram Kunde (49), were produced before Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate (Esplanade court) DSKhedeekar in Mumbai on Friday after their police custody ended. The court adjourned the matter for further hearing on September 17, and remanded the duo in judicial custody until then.

Parikh's lawyer Satish Maneshinde said they have applied for bail for both the accused.

Odisha govt bets on Gulf to look beyond mining sector investments

Sujit Bisoyi
Bhubaneswar, September 11

ODISHA IS trying to recast its image from a mining-led investment destination into a diversified, technology- and export-driven industrial hub, and is using its three-day investors' meet to court investors from the United Arab Emirates (UAE).

Through its Odisha Investors' Meet — UAE 2026 — from September 9 to 11, the state government is focused on attracting global capital, strengthening export-oriented industries and building new investment and business linkages between Odisha and the Middle East, officials who were part of Chief Minister Mohan Charan Majhi's delegation told *The Indian Express*. "India's next growth story is taking shape, and Odisha is ready to lead it. Now, we're taking Odisha's investment story to the UAE. Total 514

projects worth Rs 9.57 lakh crore in investment in two years (after BJP came to power in Odisha) show that the momentum is real. Odisha is no longer just an opportunity on paper; the world is taking notice," he wrote on X, minutes before he started consultations with investors.

Official data at the Industrial Promotion and Investment Corporation of Odisha (IPICOL), the state's nodal agency for investment promotion, said that 50% of the investment intents that came in the past two years are in the advanced stages of approvals. As Odisha has long been a preferred destination for mining-based investments, the BJP government has shifted its focus to diverse sectors, which would generate direct and indirect jobs.

According to the Additional Chief Secretary, Industries Department, Hemant Sharma, the UAE outreach will also focus on strengthening the transition



Odisha Chief Minister Mohan Charan Majhi at the Emirates Global Aluminium facility in Dubai's Jebel Ali on Friday. PTI

from Odisha's traditional industrial sectors towards new-generation, technology-driven and higher-value sectors. "During the current visit, the state has been targeting sectors like metals downstream, food and seafood exports, port-based industrial and logistics parks, shipbuilding parks, dedicated rare

earth corridors, slurry pipeline infrastructure and chemical and petrochemical parks," he said.

The state government said it has attracted investment intents of Rs 2.2 lakh crore from the Middle East. "A major outcome of the investors' meet was the signing of an MoU between the state government, Abu Dhabi-

based International Holding Company and Adani Group to explore 14 new projects with an indicative investment of \$2.105 Trillion (Rs 2.10 crore)," an official said. The proposed projects will come up in sectors like metal downstream, slurry pipelines, critical minerals and rare earths, chemicals and petrochemical derivatives, renewable energy equipment, healthcare, industrial infrastructure, tourism, skill development and sports infrastructure. It will create over 8 lakh job opportunities.

As part of the visit, Majhi held one-to-one meetings with investors from the Middle East and invited them to explore investment opportunities in Odisha. Considering Odisha's strategic location on the eastern coast, the BJP government has been focusing on port-led development in the state in line with the growth of Gujarat on the western coast. With over 550-km-long coast-

line, the state currently has three all-weather ports at Paradip, Dhamra and Gopalpur, while it has identified 13 other sites for development of ports.

"Port-led development is expected to create significant opportunities for large-scale investment, logistics, exports, global supply-chain linkages and integrated manufacturing," said an official. Odisha has also proposed a shipbuilding park — the National Shipbuilding and Heavy Industries Park, Odisha Ltd — which has received the Centre's in-principle approval. The proposed project, with an investment of Rs 24,700 crore, has been planned along the Mahanadi riverbank in the industrially-starved Kendrapara district, adjacent to Paradip port.

Odisha has also been making efforts to strengthen its position as a key digital infrastructure hub in the eastern part of India, attracting investments in sectors

like data centres and semiconductor units. It has been reframing policies to make them lucrative for investors, offering more incentives. Last year, the Centre approved two semiconductor units for Odisha with an investment of Rs 4,000 crore.

Even as the push to draw investment started over 10 years ago, when the BJD was still in power, officials said the current pace could be attributed to the change of regime in the state. "As the BJP is in power both at the state and centre, it's a crucial factor to boost investors' confidence to invest in the state. Same party ruling at the Centre and the state not just helps to boost investment climate by expediting the clearances required but also in getting new investments on the suggestions of the Union government," said a senior government official.

FULL REPORT ON
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At BRICS, keep difficult conversations alive

THE 18TH BRICS Summit comes when wars, disrupted energy supplies and soaring costs are fragmenting the world order. At the same time, the grouping has expanded, and the diversity of its participants and interests gives the summit a special significance. For instance, Iran, Saudi Arabia and the UAE, which became full members more than two years ago, are embroiled in competition and conflict, and have divergent interests. Presidents Vladimir Putin of Russia and Xi Jinping of China are both participating. India, whose foreign policy has long rested on the idea that strategic autonomy is best preserved by maintaining relationships across the spectrum, has a strong interest in making such a forum work. Delhi knows that there is great value in keeping difficult conversations alive.

For Delhi, the summit is a test of whether it can advance its own and the forum's interests — through more resilient supply chains and greater use of national currencies in trade. These can give countries greater room to navigate a global financial system that is still disoriented and unsettled by the weaponisation of tariffs, over the last year and a half, by US President Donald Trump. Greater economic exchange within the bloc, or more broadly, within the Global South, however, does not make BRICS an anti-Western alliance. It reflects a desire among its members to trade freely, secure supplies from multiple sources and push for reform of global institutions.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi has already met President Putin in a bilateral focused on boosting trade, defence, energy and critical minerals. The highlight of the summit is bound to be the meeting between Modi and Xi, in what will be the Chinese president's first visit to India since the Galwan clashes and the escalation of border tensions. While the two countries are rebuilding ties and Chinese investment has begun to return to India, the relationship remains fraught. India aims to reduce its economic dependence on China even as Chinese imports are deeply embedded in its manufacturing supply chains. Xi's presence in Delhi offers an opportunity to broaden cooperation and temper the edges of the competition. That is also the larger promise of BRICS. India's strategy should be to make it a more useful forum rather than just a bloc that ranges itself against the West, focusing on practical collaboration and strengthening its credibility as a voice of the Global South. A successful summit will be one that leaves India with more room for manoeuvre, fewer vulnerabilities and more channels through which a conversation can be sustained between countries that agree with each other, and also disagree.

For Bihar flood problem, solution lies beyond

BIHAR RECEIVED 27 per cent below-normal rainfall between June 1 and the first week of September. Even then, large parts of the state are under water. The Ganga, Gandak, Kosi, Budhi Gandak, Punpun and Ghaghra have all risen above danger levels in different stretches. A combination of high upstream river flows and erratic weather — spells of heavy, localised rainfall amid an overall rainfall deficit — has contributed to the rivers spilling over their banks. The unusually high level of the Ganga also created a "backwater effect" in the Gandak and Punpun. Since these rivers drain into the Ganga, its high water level made it difficult for them to discharge their water. As a result, water backed up in the tributaries, adding to the flooding.

Since colonial times, flood-prone Bihar has tried to contain its rivers within defined channels through embankments. But embankments separate rivers from their floodplains, while continuous silt deposition raises riverbeds and reduces channel capacity. When an embankment breaches, the artificially contained water can rush into homes and fields. Bihar, therefore, needs to revisit the idea that higher or stronger embankments will *ipso facto* contain floods. Embankment maintenance must be accompanied by the restoration of drainage channels, protection of floodplains, better land-use planning, restoration of wetlands, and deployment of early-warning systems. The Ganga Basin River Management Plan, implemented for more than a decade, acknowledges these imperatives. But the persistent monsoon floods in Bihar underline that much needs to be done to give the river space to spread safely during periods of high discharge. Addressing Bihar's concerns will require greater coordination between the riverine states on reservoir releases.

Bihar has long argued that the Farakka barrage and the India-Bangladesh Ganga Water Sharing Treaty have compounded the state's river-management challenges. It contends that the barrage has altered the Ganga's flow regime, affecting the movement and deposition of sediment load. The extent to which this contributes to floods in Bihar remains contested. Even so, renegotiation of the 1996 treaty, which expires in December, should take into account Bihar's concerns over silt accumulation and the state's river-management needs. The new arrangement needs to be informed by updated data on river flows and climate-change projections. In an era of erratic weather, states and countries sharing river basins should strengthen coordination to manage water flows and mitigate flood-related distress.

AI can kill humanity in a decade? Get in line

IT'S BEEN a while now since reality has all but caught up to the dystopias of science fiction. Take the revelation by Jacob Coxon, a former researcher at Anthropic. "AI," he said after quitting his job, "could kill us all" by the end of the decade. What's more, there are enough people at companies like Anthropic and OpenAI who are aware of the danger but continue to gamble with smarter models so that they aren't left behind in the race that only billionaires can win. For most people, though, there's only one response to this existential threat to the species: What's all the fuss about?

In the second decade of the 21st century, doomsday is passé. Titans of industry, scientific minds backed by machines of war and just plain old human consumption have taken the planet to the brink of apocalypse. Nuclear weapons, the infamous Doomsday Clock inching towards midnight, floods, heat waves, melting glaciers, rising seas — through it all, people can binge watch and chill. AI could well destroy humanity. It just needs to get in line.

Behind the mass psychosis that drives humans to ever greater peril, despite knowing the danger, is the banality of risk. As members of the only species aware of its own mortality, humans know their existence will come to an end. But like the smoker who puffs away at his cigarette despite knowing the harm, people are likely to ask AI about how to survive the machine apocalypse.

The Editorial Page

SATURDAY, SEPTEMBER 12, 2026

India can change what BRICS stands for — more choices, not more blocs

IT'S AN extraordinary conclave of global leaders. As the BRICS Summit opens today at Bharat Mandapam, the leaders will represent almost half the world's population, 40 per cent of global GDP and over a quarter of global trade. The geopolitics makes the lineup even more exceptional, almost audacious. Narendra Modi will host, amongst others, Russia's Vladimir Putin, South Africa's Cyril Ramaphosa, Iran's Masoud Pezeshkian, Indonesia's Prabowo Subianto, China's Xi Jinping and the UN Secretary-General. Almost miraculous, in these Manichean times.

It will be tempting to judge it, though, as one judges all summits: Can a communiqué survive the night? Can two wars be papered over in a paragraph? And if Xi shows up smiling, is that a thaw? None of these is the real test. Anyone who has attended the drafting of a summit line in this town knows how it goes. It starts with the communiqué and ends with the communiqué, and whatever grand vision India has for the international system two decades from now is considered — politely — by India's diplomats to be somebody else's bailiwick: The professors. The real test is whether India brings an idea to the meeting or is simply a venue for others' ideas.

Surjit Bhalla wrote one for India in this paper yesterday ('Forget BRICS, look West', IE, September 10). His maths is not wrong, and neither is his analysis. China will never rebalance. But BRICS was never meant to

be either a growth miracle or a security blanket. To fail it for not being something it never set out to be is to flunk it in the wrong exam. The real mistake comes at the conclusion. Looking West because America has shown itself willing to punish partners who drift is not grand strategy. It is a mere change of address.

BRICS is imbalanced. China pushed hardest for new members. Its bank is in Shanghai. Russia and Iran, the members under Western sanctions, are the ones most interested in de-dollarising their trade. And it is Washington, not Beijing, that now threatens tariffs against any bloc that flirts with a rival to the dollar. Equidistance between America and China is not a policy; it's an assertion of powerlessness. Alignment with either is surrender. What India should do instead is work, quietly, to change what BRICS is for. The world doesn't need more blocs. It needs more choices. A grouping that seats Iran beside the UAE will never agree on ideology, and need not.

The international system, and Asia at its centre, is too large and too plural to be organised around a single axis. India's place in the world gives it both the latitude and the responsibility to say this with conviction. Brazil and South Africa, which gain nothing from either Chinese or American primacy, can say it with the same conviction, and should join Delhi at the table.

The rule applies in the other di-



AMITABH MATTOO

The international system, and Asia at its centre, is too large and too plural to be organised around a single axis. India's place in the world gives it both latitude and responsibility to say this with conviction

AI governance architecture must include its largest stakeholders



SUNIL MEHTA



RICHA ROY

AI sharpens the argument for an International Institute for Regulatory Development. It should be a global apex body for AI, finance and climate risk

IN THE six weeks that preceded the BRICS Summit in New Delhi, both Demis Hassabis and Bill Gates underscored the need for an AI governance institution, tracking risks across labour, finance, elections, health and beyond. Both emphasised international coordination, yet did not envisage fast-growing emerging markets represented in such institutions.

AI's risks transcend sovereign boundaries and sectoral silos. The chair of the Financial Stability Board (FSB), Andrew Bailey, warned that leverage, stretched valuations and AI optimism are interacting in ways that could amplify a market correction across borders, implying a bubble, a global financial risk. Emerging markets are massive users of AI; their resources, data and labour power its models; they are most vulnerable to its technological, sovereignty, financial and climate risks. The BRICS Summit presents an opportunity to address them.

When India held the 2023 G20 presidency, the authors argued for an International Institute for Regulatory Development (IIRD) under the aegis of the G20 and FSB, to set standards for emergent technologies, undertake global regulatory research, and "tropicalise" rules for fast-growing emerging economies. Three years on, AI sharpens the argument for IIRD. It should be a global apex body for AI, finance and climate risk, with three core functions.

First, research, regulatory capacity-building for early warning. A permanent secretariat producing shared assessments of how AI and other global risks transmit through financial systems and climate exposures, with data drawn from emerging and advanced markets. Existing institutions are inadequate — the FSB is a coordinating umbrella, not a research institute, and the two should complement, not duplicate each other.

Second, an exchange of practice. A living repository of what has worked. The precedents exist. Project Agorá, with 40 private participants such as SWIFT and multiple central banks, and Project Dunbar, in which the central banks of Singapore, Australia, Malaysia and South Africa created a shared platform for digital currencies, show what global regulators can build together. The results of AI pilots in UPI could, for instance, be a valuable part of this exchange.

Third, proportionate standards. Weighted governance that reflects where growth and users are, and a formal channel

into the FSB, the Basel Committee, and climate and frontier-AI bodies. Proportionality matters as much as representation: Standards to be calibrated to contexts.

Giving the geopolitical complexity, design choices are critical. The IIRD should be seeded at Delhi, though not owned by BRICS. It should be chartered as an open institution, housed in India, funded by a mix of public, private and multilateral funds, with the New Development Bank as one contributor, and with membership open to the G20, the OECD, multilateral development banks and the FSB.

The IIRD would not threaten the turf of existing institutions, but complement them by producing shared research and early warning on how AI risk transmits through finance and climate, with data from emerging and advanced markets — a gap the FSB itself admits; facilitate a living exchange of practice; feed proportionate, mutually recognised standards into the FSB, Basel; and be a precursor to a global frontier-AI body. The Delhi declaration should mandate a working group, chaired by India and open to non-members, to bring an IIRD charter to the 2027 summit, and to present it in parallel to the G20 finance track — critically, to institutionalise a communiqué.

India's presidencies of global groupings have been praised for being inclusive. As with any international summit, there is the risk of critique of the spectacle surpassing the technical negotiations and sustained institutional engagement. The BRICS IIRD working group offers an opportunity to both retain the inclusivity and preclude the critique.

Bretton Woods institutions originated in America and Europe, designed for a world that no longer exists. AI's governance is being designed by a handful of companies and governments for a world that does not yet exist. Both exclude countries whose citizens will be AI's largest, most vulnerable stakeholders. India's common-law heritage, technological prowess and Global South convening power allow for designing a different architecture. Its BRICS chairship is the moment to offer a third draft, with the Global South as co-creators of the new rules.

Mehta chairs the Asia Society India Centre and is former chairman of PNB, YES Bank, IndusInd Bank and country head of AIG India. Roy is a Chevening Gurukul Fellow at the University of Oxford and partner at Cyril Amarchand Mangaldas. Views are personal

rection, too. Reforming a Western-designed system is a legitimate wish, but a world where Washington is replaced by Beijing as the trusted guarantor of Asian choices simply replaces one centre with another. The harder ambition is an Asia in which China is powerful but not hegemonic, India influential but not domineering, ASEAN does not have to choose, the Gulf defines itself, and the small don't have to be anyone's client states. None of that is "anti-China". All of it is opposed to hegemony. That distinction is the whole argument.

Three things are within India's reach this weekend. First, an interoperability protocol that links domestic fast-payment systems, building on UPI's existing presence in the Gulf and Southeast Asia and allowing any member to join (or leave) at will. Not a BRICS currency, but a set of alternatives so that no country ever has to rely on a single financial plumbing system. Second, reform of NDB governance that gives newer members more power over its capital. Third, if the sherpas insist on a statement about Ukraine and Gaza, let's make it one about principles, not positions: Not an endorsement of anyone's war aims but a defence of sovereignty which applies to Ukrainians and Gazans alike, and an offer of Indian good offices that this government has, for whatever reason, been extremely reluctant to extend.

● WORDLY WISE

He who has great power should use it lightly. — Seneca

When I teach Indian foreign policy at Jawaharlal Nehru University, I teach Kautilya, too. The *mandala* confuses my students for reasons opposite to those I expect. They think an old book will give them hierarchies. They find networks. I call their attention to the inner ring, where the *vijigishu* sits: The king who wishes to conquer. Then you realise that every king in a *mandala* considers himself the *vijigishu*. The map has as many centres as it has points. Hegemony, in Kautilya, isn't how the world is. It's what one powerful ruler wants to make of it, despite all the other *vijigishus*. Asia should settle, instead, for a Kautilyan compromise: A circle of states that can disagree and still cooperate, whose sovereignty is absolute and none of which has the power or the excuse to impose its will on the others.

History is being made whilst we wait. But it isn't made by onlookers. It's hammered out on anvils. For two days this weekend, India is in possession of the anvil. Washington and Beijing wield the hammers. If India can lay ideas on that anvil this weekend, there's a chance Asia will have more than one centre when the dust settles. And if there's one enduring product of this summit that survives the photo-op, let it not be a declaration. Let it be a different question we ask about Asia. Not "Who will dominate?" but "How do we ensure that nobody does?"

The writer is dean and professor, SIS, JNU and former vice-chancellor, University of Jammu

From god of beginnings, sutras for nation-building



SHASHANK R JOSHI



Before starting any new venture for Viksit Bharat — a startup, a lab, a school — invoke the Ganapati principle: Will this organise or disorganise?

GANAPATI IS not only a god to be worshipped; he is a principle to be lived. Every year, as the *dhool-tasha* announces his arrival, Mumbai stops. India stops. A clay idol becomes the centre of our consciousness. Why does a form with an elephant head and a human body resonate so deeply with modern, aspirational India? The answer lies in the Vedas. In the Rig Veda, he is "Brahmanaspati". "*Gananaam tva Ganapatim havamahe, Kavin kavinam upamashravastamam...*" (We invoke you, lord of all groups, the wisest of the wise)". Long before he became the god of beginnings, Ganapati was the Vedic principle of organising chaos into cosmos. "*Gana*" means group, collective, system. "*Pati*" means master. In modern management terms, he is the first systems thinker. Our *rishis* never created a form without philosophy. Each part of Ganesha is a sutra for nation-building.

The elephant head is *maha mastaka* — big intellect, big memory, big vision. An elephant never forgets its path. Viksit Bharat needs this big head to think 25 years ahead, to remember our civilisational roots while embracing AI, biotech, and quantum. Next is *shurpa karna*, the winnowing ears. His ears are like winnowing fans. He listens to everything but retains only the grain, throws away the chaff. In the age of social media noise, fake news and polarisation, this is our greatest *sadhana*. *Viveka* is to listen to all stakeholders — farmer, jawan, scientist, youth — but to keep only what is true and useful for the nation. *Vakratunda*, the curved trunk, is adaptability. His trunk can uproot a tree and pick up a needle. That is flexibility with strength. Viksit Bharat will need this to be strong on borders and soft in welfare. The *mushaka vahana*, the mouse, is the most profound symbol. A tiny mouse carries this huge god. The mouse is *iccha* — desire, consumption, greed that nibbles away everything. If desire rides us, we are destroyed. If wisdom rides desire, we progress. The climate crisis, our sugar epidemic, our consumerism — can be controlled only when *buddhi* rides over *bhoga*. That is why Ganesha comes before Lakshmi. Wealth without wisdom is *vinasha*. Finally, "modak in hand". The *sadhana* modak is not just sweet. It is the sweet fruit of disciplined effort — *purushartha*. Viksit Bharat will not come by slogans, but by the tapas of every Indian.

We call him Vighnaharta — remover of obstacles. But his Vedic name is also Vighnakarta — he creates obstacles for the egoistic. Every obstacle in our path to becoming a developed nation — corruption, casteism, pollution of our rivers, lifestyle diseases — is actually his grace. He is blocking the wrong path, so we take the right one.

Ecological Ganesha will let the clay return to clay. Let our *visarjan* be *visarjana* — letting go of ego, not polluting water. The Vedas say — *mrityiiva mritim* — from earth to earth. The economic Ganapati Bappa will let our modak be made of millets — *shree anna* — linking our farmers to our festivals. That is true *atmanirbharta*. Finally, the spiritual Bappa: Before starting any new venture for Viksit Bharat — a startup, a lab, a school — invoke the Ganapati principle: Will this organise or disorganise? Will this serve the *gana* or only me? Ganesh Chaturthi is not 10 days of noise. It is 10 days of training for the mind to become *sthita pragnya* — stable in wisdom, like his belly that holds the entire universe yet stays calm.

The writer is a Mumbai-based endocrinologist and Padmashri awardee

40 YEARS AGO

September 12, 1986



28 killed in train-bus collision

AT LEAST 28 bus passengers were killed and over 60 injured, several of them seriously, in a major train-bus collision at an unmanned level-crossing at Pathalipahar in the north Lakhimpur district of Upper Assam, bordering Arunachal Pradesh, according to the latest official reports reaching Guwahati. Forty-eight passengers were admitted to hospitals. A spokesman of NF Railway said the collision occurred as the bus driver failed to observe necessary caution.

PM on border security

THE PRIME Minister, Rajiv Gandhi, said the

Centre would not hesitate to take steps under the powers granted by the Rajya Sabha to counter any attempt by the Punjab government that might weaken border security. Gandhi was reacting to the state government's decision to appoint an enquiry committee to go into the recent incident on the India-Pakistan border when 13 alleged terrorists were killed in an encounter with the BSF

The Gorkha question

THE LEFT Front government wants to handle the GNLF-led movement for a separate state in Darjeeling purely as a political problem. It was ready to extend autonomy to the region, but under no circumstances would it allow Gorkha leaders to carry on any anti-national

or divisive movement. This was stated by Chief Minister Jyoti Basu at a press conference. Basu said that secessionist and divisive forces should not find any element of inspiration in any section of the press.

NCERT silver jubilee

ON THE occasion of the silver jubilee celebrations of the National Council of Educational Research and Training (NCERT), the Prime Minister, Rajiv Gandhi, awarded fellowships of the National Institute of Education to 19 eminent educationists. Inaugurating the silver jubilee celebrations, the Prime Minister said that the new education policy (NEP) was designed to make the nation's vast human resources an asset instead of a liability.



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● **WHAT THE OTHERS SAY**
If education indicates a society's future, then Israel is facing an especially bleak one.
— *Haaretz, Israel*

The Ideas Page

SATURDAY, SEPTEMBER 12, 2026

On caste census & NPAs, same reluctance to make privilege publicly visible



SATISH DESHPANDE

AREPORT in this newspaper ('Note on meeting over caste census rewritten after Ministry pushback', IE, September 3) about the alleged "miscommunication" between the Registrar General of India (RGI) office (which conducts the Census) and the Ministry of Social Justice (MoSJ) (which maintains lists of Scheduled Castes and Other Backward Classes), suggest that the curious case of the caste census just got curiouseer. After an abrupt about-turn on this issue before the 2024 elections, the Modi government first postponed the Census beyond reasonable limits (doubtless because of the impending delimitation), then unveiled a thinly disguised attempt to sabotage the effort through an "open-ended" question on caste, rather than using drop-down lists along with an "Others" option for unlisted caste names. The excuse given then was that caste lists were not available. It is now clear that this was never true, and that the MoSJ had in fact offered to supply the RGI with the SC and OBC lists. This takes to new heights the attempts made by governments to avoid, prevent or sabotage the caste count. Congress did it in 2011, and now the BJP is doing it even more blatantly. Since the 2001 Census, every proposal to count caste has attracted immediate and insistent opposition. Different opponents are motivated by different interests, including some who sincerely believe that it is against the larger goal of transcending caste. But the most vocal and effective opposition seems to be inspired by straightforward self-interest, or more appropriately, caste and class interests. Of course, those who argue for the caste census are also pursuing interests of some kind, and these too may be related to caste and class. The division of opinion on this question seems to be decided by the overriding perception that

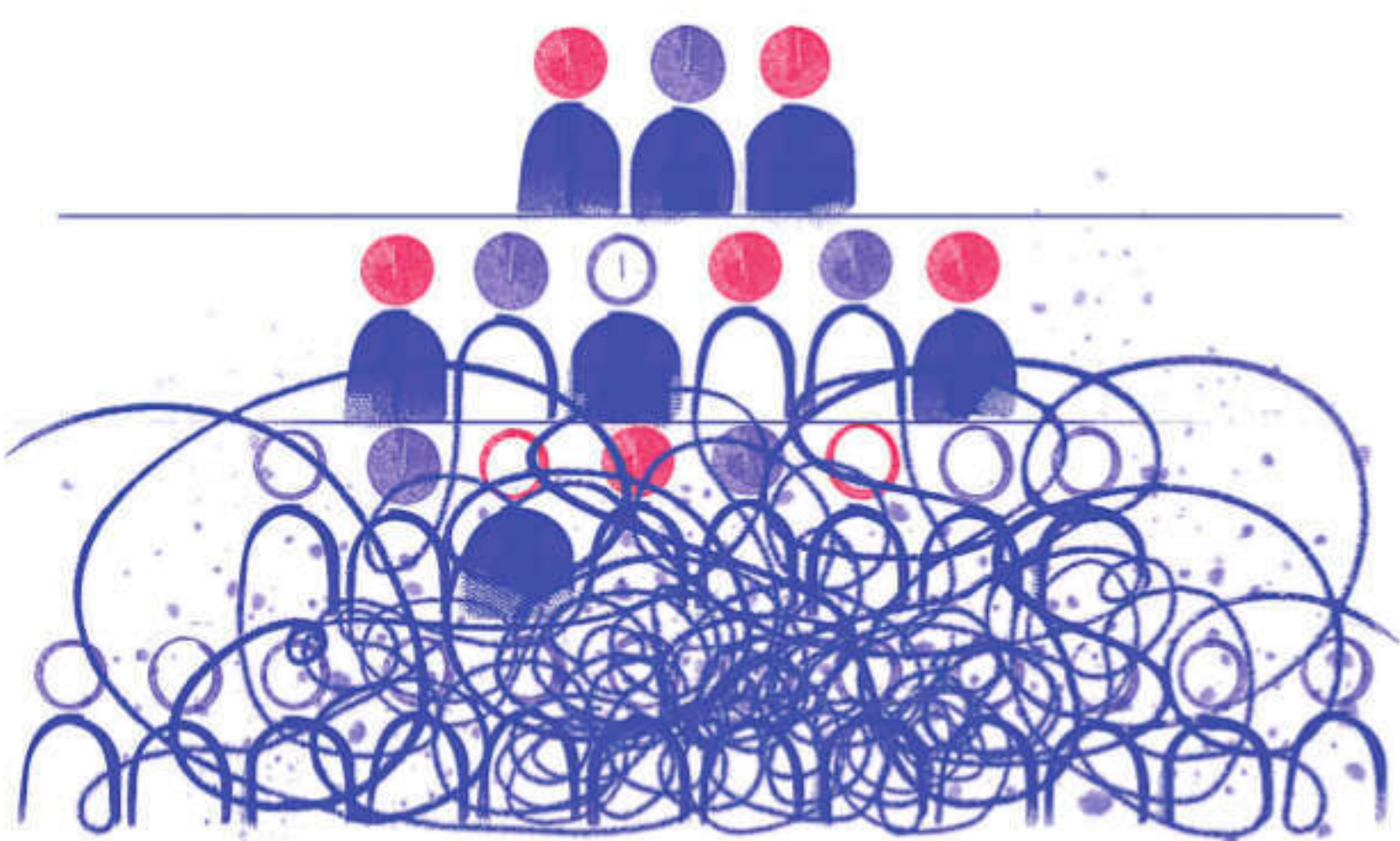


ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

the counting of caste is linked to benefits of some kind that governments may potentially provide to particular groups. The interesting thing, however, is that some benefits are only too visible — reservation is the prime example — while others may be even more consequential and yet remain invisible. Since most people jump to the conclusion that a caste census is somehow about reservations, it follows that those against reservation would oppose the counting of caste, and vice versa. It is no surprise, therefore, that the anti-reservation organisation Youth for Equality was the primary petitioner against the Bihar caste survey, or that the Akhila Karnataka Brahmana Mahasabha petitioned against a similar survey in Karnataka. Equally understandable is the opposition of dominant caste groups who are prominent beneficiaries of reservation, who fear that a caste count will lead to a loss or reduction in their share. Hence we find the Akhila Bharata Veerashiva Lingayat Mahasabha and the Rajya Vokkaliga Sangha of Karnataka petitioning the Karnataka High Court to stay

Since elected governments must indulge the rich and powerful, but also seek votes from the vast mass of people who are neither, they pretend to count caste while ensuring that it actually isn't counted

the 2025 caste survey. Unsurprisingly, in both Bihar and Karnataka, the petitioners invoked every possible legal argument against caste surveys, including those that had already been rejected by the Supreme Court or had been superseded by constitutional amendments such as the 105th Amendment. While the introduction of reservation for Economically Weaker Sections (EWS) in 2019 — effectively for the upper castes — may have softened attitudes a little, beneficiaries of reservation have long been the objects of resentful contempt from the so-called "General Category". For the elite in this category, who occupy the highest echelons of our society, surveys of this kind cause an even more visceral sense of outrage. It is as though being asked their caste de-motivates them by implicating them in something connected to reservations. That is why some celebrities — tech magnates, film stars and other rich, famous and powerful people — disdainfully dissociate themselves from such surveys. Since elected governments must indulge the rich and powerful, but also seek votes from the vast

mass of people who are neither, they pretend to count caste while ensuring that it actually isn't counted. But the spectrum of positions on a caste census is a truncated one because it assumes that benefits from the state are of only one kind, like reservation. This one-sided perspective ignores a vast array of benefits showered by the state upon those who count but are never counted. The euphemistically named "Non-Performing Assets" (NPAs) are perhaps the best-documented instance of such benefits, most of which remain undocumented. Despite a 2015 Supreme Court ruling authorising the release of information under the Right to Information Act on "willful defaulters" owing large sums to public sector banks, both the banks and the Reserve Bank of India have steadfastly refused to provide details on loans written off. In 2024, the RBI issued the Wilful Defaulters and Large Defaulters Directions, which require individual banks to list on their websites the instances of default where suits have been filed. But no information (other than aggregate amounts) is provided on loans written off, despite repeated requests by RTI activists. The most recent instance is the Bank of Baroda's refusal to name defaulters on loans totalling Rs 35,715 crore (from 2020-21 to 2025-26) that have been written off with only 28 per cent average recovery. The caste census and NPAs seem to have little in common with each other, but an otherwise aggressively surveillance-oriented state seems similarly reluctant to collect or release data in both instances. This suggests that the reluctance stems from the same root cause: An unwillingness to make privilege publicly visible. The real reason for undermining the caste census could be an aversion to counting the privileged and highlighting inequalities. Curiously enough, neither a caste census nor a defaulters' list would reveal anything about the privileged that we do not already know in a general way. But an official and public count or list is resisted because it violates an implicit right: The right of the privileged to control their own social visibility.

Deshpande is a retired academic based in Bengaluru. Views are personal

A BRICS primer for the 'naraz fufas'



RAM RAJYA
BY RAM MADHAV

CONGRESS LEADERS were griping at Prime Minister Narendra Modi's recent "naraz fufa" (sulking uncle) jibe. Modi's jibe meant that, just like in family functions where there will always be an elderly uncle who finds reasons to be upset, some leaders in the Opposition always find excuses to be critical about things. Senior Congress leader P Chidambaram's comments on the 18th BRICS Summit being held in Delhi betray the "naraz fufa" tendency, if not ignorance about current global geopolitics. Normally, countries take pride in hosting important multilateral events. But for Chidambaram, the BRICS summit is a useless exercise. "We are part of BRICS, we are part of SCO, we are part of G20, and we are part of Quad. What benefits are we getting out of that? I can't see," he cribbed indignantly in an interaction with a news agency. BRICS, with 11 countries as members, another 10 as partners, and dozens more waiting to join, has emerged as the voice of the Global South. In the past two decades, it has grown in size and influence and boasts today of representing 50 per cent of the world's population, 40 per cent of the global economy and 26 per cent of global trade. In comparison, the G7 grouping of major Western powers accounts for less than 10 per cent of the population and around 44 per cent of global GDP. India emerged as an important balancing power for many countries in the Global South as the US opted to step back from its active role in the world. It assumed the BRICS chair in January for the fourth time. Over the past seven months, the country hosted more than 350 high-level engagements across important pillars like political and security, economics and culture and people-to-people engagement. It has contributed to the advancement of the BRICS agenda of regional cooperation and development. India has hosted these summits thrice before — in 2012 during the UPA regime and in 2016 and 2021 under the present NDA government. When the summit was hosted in 2012, the heads of the five member countries were present. But



in 2016, the Modi government took special interest in inviting the heads of six BIMSTEC neighbours as outreach members. While the 16th summit in Russia in 2024 saw the participation of the highest number of heads of state so far, the Delhi summit is expected to exceed that record. The Modi government adopted an innovative approach in choosing the expansion of the BRICS acronym as themes for the summits that it hosted. Building Responsive, Inclusive and Collective Solutions was the theme for the 2016 summit, while the theme for this year's summit is Building Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability. In the face of various economic, technological and trade-related disruptions, nations have to develop resilience of the highest order to tackle them. As the deep-tech era of artificial intelligence, robotics, semiconductors and biotechnology dawns, innovation is the key to national self-reliance while cooperation is necessary to mitigate the divide between tech haves and tech have-nots. A serious ecological crisis looms large over most countries, with El Niño threatening food and water security, giving sustainability issues greater urgency for the highly populous Global South. The global order built in the aftermath of World War II stands largely dissolved today. A new order is yet to take shape, and the interregnum, marred by conflicts and disorder, looks exactly like how Antonio Gramsci, the Italian statesman of the last century, described it as the "time for monsters". That makes the functioning of any grouping difficult. The G20, the world's most expansive and powerful group, found building consensus a challenge since the Russia-Ukraine conflict broke out. India played a catalytic role — in Bali in 2022 and in New Delhi in 2023 — in ensuring that consensus was achieved in the G20 despite tensions and disagreements. This BRICS summit is being held under the shadow of the US-Iran conflict, which dragged several other Gulf nations like the UAE and Saudi Arabia, also members of BRICS, into its vortex. The leaders of Iran, Saudi Arabia and the UAE converge at the summit in New Delhi for the first time after the conflict broke out in late February. Given India's experience in managing conflicting interests and also given the enormous goodwill and bonhomie that PM Modi enjoys with leaders of all these nations, one can hope that the summit will succeed in coming out with a unanimous declaration.

The writer is national vice-president, BJP and president, India Foundation

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Remembering 9/11

TWENTY-FIVE YEARS after the September 11 attacks, the world continues to remember the thousands of innocent people who lost their lives in that terrible tragedy ('25 years on, America's response to 9/11 is its biggest self-inflicted hurt', IE, September 11). The attacks caused immense suffering and left a permanent mark on global history. The anniversary provides an opportunity to pay tribute to the victims and acknowledge the courage of first responders. A united global commitment to peace, dialogue, human dignity and the rule of law remains the best way to ensure that such a tragedy is never repeated.

Rukma Sharna, Jalandhar

Judicial reminder

IN THE current political climate, the courts frequently have to step in to uphold the sanctity of the legal principle that "bail is the rule, jail is the exception" ("Court protects space for protest, it needs to", IE, September 11). It was heartening to read that a magistrate's court granted bail to a 30-year-old former TISS student over a month after he was arrested for attending a gathering to mark the death anniversary of Professor G N Saibaba. One hopes the government takes heed of such judicial reminders and does not extend the newfound "dimagi Naxal" label to such judges.

Raja Pandit, via email

Sibling love

THIS STUDY on China's only children choosing partners like themselves says something bigger about how families shape our idea of love and duty ('Love means not having to deal with siblings', IE, September 11). Growing up as the sole focus of parental care can make sharing responsibility feel unfamiliar. India's joint families show the opposite pattern, where marriage means welcoming a whole web of relatives. Perhaps the real lesson is that falling marriage rates in China reflect deeper shifts in family structure, not just personal fussiness about siblings.

K Chidanand Kumar, Bengaluru



DEVUTT

AT 'CHIHATRON Ki Goonj' in Pune last month, Rahul Gandhi quoted *Manusmriti* 9.3 to a gathering of young women. The verse states that when a woman reaches adulthood, she is married and is under her husband's control. He accused the verse of being an insult to women and told the crowd to shatter patriarchy. This brought the crowd to its feet. No Hindu apologist in the country can defend that verse without forfeiting any claim to moral credibility. This is exactly what is wrong with this attack. It is correct. However, it is too simple. Patriarchy is not the invention of *Manusmriti*. Religious scripture, by nature, follows this principle. The *Vinaya Pitaka* of the Buddhist canon places eight *garudhammas* on nuns, placing the most senior *bhikkhunis* beneath the most junior *bhikkhus*, who were ordained on the same day. Paul of Tarsus writes that wives should be subordinate to their husbands, just as the Church is to Christ. The Islamic legal system, on inheritance and testimony, dictates that women receive a lesser share compared to men. The hijab on young girls is "consent" only to left-liberal feminists. The presence of women is deemed to be such a threat to male discipline that all monastic traditions of the Subcontinent — Hindu, Jain, and Buddhist — have framed legislation against it. All scriptures swim within this principle of patriarchy. Expressing

In Manu's view, 'sattvik' has nothing to do with food. It has to do with psychology and rebirth. 'Sattvik' means austerity, knowledge and wisdom, purity, control of the senses, and performance of duties, among other things

ment to self-presentation to political attack. For much of the modern era, controlling the image required infrastructure. There were photographers, advertising agencies TV crews, campaign budgets. Generative AI radically compresses that machinery. I study sustainability in fashion, an industry that understands better than most how images manufacture desire. A campaign photograph can make a garment signify rebellion, luxury, or responsibility. The physical object matters, but so does the story wrapped around it. Generative AI puts this logic on steroids. We are moving to an economy in which convincing realities can be manufactured on demand. That is entertaining when everyone understands the game. The difficulty begins when this capacity enters domains where authenticity matters. Here sustainability offers a useful lens.

Sustainability is often reduced to carbon emissions, recycling, or renewable energy. At its core, however, it asks a more fundamental question: What happens when the consequences of what we produce are separated from the act of producing it? Fashion learnt this painfully. For decades, cheap clothing appeared almost frictionless to consumers because much of its

The synthetic image that appears instantaneously on our phone is not consequence-free simply because it is intangible. There are questions of energy, data, consent, intellectual property and labour and, increasingly, trust

outrage toward *Manusmriti* is not deserving of admiration, it is picking on a prey that has already been slaughtered. A more sophisticated politician would exploit the gap between Manu's teachings and what the Sanatan lobby believes they have the right to enforce in his name. Let's start with homosexuality. Where *Manusmriti* does consider gay sex to be an infraction, the punishment, if there is one, is no more serious than bathing while still dressed. The book is much more concerned about the violation of caste than about sex. In comparison, religious books have prescribed death for the same act. Everyone speaks of Sharia law's homophobia but few point to the homophobia in Buddhist monastic manuals. Compared to many religious traditions, Manu is almost indifferent to who has sex with whom, and as long as they do not cross caste boundaries, he remains unconcerned. The disdain and contempt of the Sanatan lobby for all things queer is hardly Manu-compliant. Now let's take meat. Chapter 3 of *Manusmriti* describes a system of how different meats offered to the ancestors as oblations satisfy them for different periods of time; fish for two, goat for six, rhino for 12 years, and so on. This is a ritual economy built on the slaughter of animals. Every temple trust and every Durga Puja committee that is uprooting meat and replacing it with vegetarian offerings in the

name of Sanatan Dharma is actually distorting the tradition. In Manu's view, *sattvik* has nothing to do with food. It has everything to do with psychology and rebirth. *Sattvik* means austerity, knowledge and wisdom, purity, control of the senses, and performance of duties, among other things. Rajas means restlessness, loss of stability, and greed for ill-gotten gains, while tamas derives from greed, sleep, lack of persistence and cruelty, and is coupled with atheism, inconsistency, negligence and begging. Manu is not interested in what we eat but in what we pursue. The smug fame-seeking fund-diverting double-speaking Sanatan missionary is far from *sattvik*. Finally, let's take trees. *Manusmriti* 1.49 declares that plants are conscious and feel pain and pleasure. Chapter 11 demands penance that is real for the unjustified destruction of plants. Each forest reserved for private enterprise, each tranquil sanctuary sacrificed to a private resort or zoo by a government that believes in protecting Sanatan Dharma contravenes the philosophy of Manu, and is not its modern interpretation. There is so much in *Manusmriti* that could be used to challenge the so-called defenders of Hindu dharma on their own terms. It calls for reading beyond Chapter 9. But it is clear that neither Rahul Gandhi nor the RSS has actually read this book.

Devdutt is an author and mythologist

An AI lesson dressed in the clothes of the '80s

ment to self-presentation to political attack. For much of the modern era, controlling the image required infrastructure. There were photographers, advertising agencies TV crews, campaign budgets. Generative AI radically compresses that machinery. I study sustainability in fashion, an industry that understands better than most how images manufacture desire. A campaign photograph can make a garment signify rebellion, luxury, or responsibility. The physical object matters, but so does the story wrapped around it. Generative AI puts this logic on steroids. We are moving to an economy in which convincing realities can be manufactured on demand. That is entertaining when everyone understands the game. The difficulty begins when this capacity enters domains where authenticity matters. Here sustainability offers a useful lens.

Sustainability is often reduced to carbon emissions, recycling, or renewable energy. At its core, however, it asks a more fundamental question: What happens when the consequences of what we produce are separated from the act of producing it? Fashion learnt this painfully. For decades, cheap clothing appeared almost frictionless to consumers because much of its

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true cost — waste, water, emissions and precarious labour — remained somewhere else in the value chain. The sustainability movement forced businesses to examine what was hidden behind the finished product. We need a similar instinct for AI. The synthetic image that appears instantaneously on our phone is not consequence-free simply because it is intangible. There are questions of energy, data, consent, intellectual property and labour and, increasingly, trust. For decades, photographs carried a peculiar authority. They could be manipulated, staged or selectively framed, of course, but their basic cultural proposition was that a camera had encountered something in the world. Generative AI breaks that assumption. The consequence is not simply that we may believe things that are false, but that we begin doubting things that are true. The so-

cial cost is the gradual erosion of our confidence in visual evidence itself. The answer is not to reject generative AI, but to develop norms as fast as we are developing capabilities. And we need to acquire a new reflex. For the last generation, digital literacy meant learning not to believe everything we read online. For the next, it will mean learning not to believe all we see. There is something fitting about the fact that this lesson has arrived dressed in the clothes of the 1980s. Fashion knows that styles return, but never to precisely the world they left behind. AI is giving us the power to manufacture a past. What we do with that power will say far more about our future.

The writer is professor of practice, Sustainability at Masters' Union, India. Views are personal



त्रिपुरा विश्वविद्यालय
TRIPURA UNIVERSITY
(Central University), पूर्वप्रमुख: Suryanagar, त्रिपुरा (N), त्रिपुरा - 799022

No. F.TU/REG/ADV/NT/2026/1
Date: 11.09.2026

NOTIFICATION

The last date for online submission of applications invited vide Employment Notification No. F.TU/REG/ADV/NT/2026, dated 11.08.2026 has been extended till 26.09.2026 upto 23:30 hours.

All other criteria as mentioned in the Employment Notification shall remain unchanged. (NB: Hindi version is available on T.U. website).

Sd/- (Prof. Samir Kumar Sil), Registrar (ic)

WESTERN RAILWAY
Material Management Department
VARIOUS MATERIALS SUPPLY
E-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE No. S/53/2026 Date 07.09.2026

S.N.	Tender No.	Short Description of Items	Quantity	T.O.D.
422	30263166	Element Engine Air Filter (Disposable Bag Type)	698 Nos	8-Oct-26
423	06261625	Self Priming Mono Block Pump	1098 Nos	5-Oct-26

CORRIGENDUM

Please read the quantity as "1170057 Nos" for the Tender Notice No.: S/51/2026 dated: 02.09.2026 at Sr. No. 416

Regarding detailed notice EMD, Purchase restrictions and detailed tender conditions, please visit website www.irps.gov.in and wr.indianrailways.gov.in.

Like us on:  facebook.com/WesternRly • Follow us on:  X.com/WesternRly

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER
ROAD CONSTRUCTION DEPARTMENT,
ROAD DIVISION, GUMLA-835207,
E-mail :- eercdgumla-jhr@nic.in

Corrigendum

इस कार्यालय के e-Tender Ref. No. RCD/GUMLA/ 665/2026-27 dt. 02.09.2026 द्वारा आमंत्रित एवं PR No. 388975(Road)26-27 (D) द्वारा प्रकाशित Widening & Strengthening of Ghaghra to Jokari Road via Ranhe, Kundo, Rukighati (Bishunpur) (Total Length-19.100 KM) Under Road Division Gumla कार्य की निविदा को अपरिहार्य कारणवश स्थगित की जाती है।

Sd/-
Executive Engineer
PR 389600 Road(26-27).D R.C.D. Road Division Gumla



NATIONAL INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY, SILCHAR
(An Institution of National Importance)
Silchar - 788 010 (Assam)

NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER

E-tender invited from experienced and financially sound contractor/agency as follows.

Sl. No.	Name of Work NIT-E/Estale/2026-27/05	Estimated Cost (In Rs.)	Cost of tender documents (In Rs.)
1.	Painting and renovation work of New Guest House Block at NIT Silchar.	72,76,643/-	2,000/-
2.	Conversion of overhead line to underground electrical cables at P-Type quarters and providing input power to newly constructed community shed at NIT Silchar.	35,09,808/-	2,000/-
3.	Supplying and installation of street light at the road starting from LP school point upto the entrance of Hostel 9 and at the road in front of Boy's Hostel 5 at NIT Silchar.	16,67,097/-	1,000/-
4.	Supplying and installation of post top lamps at the entrance of Old LTD building, approach road of NABL lab and the backside of CSE building at NIT Silchar.	17,59,129/-	1,000/-
5.	Supplying and installation of light with pole at the Basketball court at NIT Silchar.	7,14,128/-	1,000/-
6.	Electrical Renovation work at PED lab of Electrical Engineering Department.	9,67,675/-	1,000/-

Last date of online submission is on **26/09/2026**. Any further clarification, modification etc., will be posted in the website <http://www.nits.ac.in> & CPPP only.

Sd/- Registrar

NOTICE

Notice under Order V Rule 20 of the Code of Civil Procedure against Debari D. Yormadi S/o Shri Yormadi issued by the High Court of Delhi at New Delhi in CRL.M.A. 18776/2026 IN CRL. L.P. 281/2014.

IN THE HIGH COURT OF DELHI AT NEW DELHI
(Notice Under Order V Rule 20 of the Code of Civil Procedure)
CRL.M.A. 18776/2026 IN CRL. L.P. 281/2014
Leave Petition against order dated 22.10.2013
Passed By Ld. ASJ/SPECIAL JUDGE-NDPS, South District, Saket Court Complex, New Delhi
D R I Petitioner
Versus
Debari D Yormadi & Anr. Respondent/s

NOTICE TO The Respondent No.1 :- Debari D. Yormadi S/o Shri Yormadi
M-19, New Mahavir Nagar, Near District Centre, Janakpuri, New Delhi

Whereas the above noted petitioner has been presented an Leave Petition Under Section 378(4) Cr. P.C., 1973, against the **order/judgment dated 22.10.2013** passed by **Shri M.K. Nagpal, Additional Sessions Judge/Special Judge-NDPS, South District, Saket Court Complex, New Delhi in SC No. 35A/06** which was listed before the Court on **03.07.2026** and the Court ordered issuance of notice of Leave Petition to you. And whereas it has been proved to the satisfaction of the Court that you cannot be served on the ordinary manner. Notice is hereby issued that if you wish to defend the above mentioned leave petition to you may cause an appearance to be entered on your behalf either in person or through an advocate duly appointed by you for the purpose before the Court on **16.09.2026** (Actual) at 10.30 am.

If no appearance is made on your behalf, by yourself, your pleader or someone by law authorized to act for you in the said leave petition on the aforementioned date, no further notice of the subsequent date of hearing of the said leave petition will be given and the same will be heard and determined ex parte in your absence.

Given under my hand seal of this Court the **05th day of September, 2026**

Sd/-
AR (Cr. I) for Registrar General



SOUTHERN POWER DISTRIBUTION COMPANY OF TELANGANA LIMITED

e-Procurement Tender Notice (Paper Notification)

TGSPDCL intends to float tender for procurement of (a) Clamp Meters (Tong Testers)(b) Digital Insulation Resistance meter(c) 33KV & 11KV Indoor switchgear units Cable(d) 100 sq.mm AAA Conductor(e) 500 KVA Structure Mounted DTRs(f) 11KV 3 way & 5 way Non motorized RMUs(g) 11KV 24 V DC Feeder VCBs with CRPs & CTs(h) LT Metal Parts(i) 8.0 Mtrs/140 kgs PSCC Poles to Sididipet circle(j) 9.1 Mtrs/280 kgs PSCC Poles to Sididipet circle(k) 11 Mtrs/365 kgs PSCC Poles to Sididipet circle(l) 11KV HT TVR -5/A 0.25 class (Net meter)(m) 3Ph LTCT Net Meters 100/5A 0.5S accuracy DMS with CTs and Box(n) 11KV, 20/5A CPTT Sets of 0.25 class accuracy on e-procurement platform.For further details of each item above, please visit www.tgspowerpower.org, www.tender.telangana.gov.in, www.auction.telangana.gov.in Phone: 040-23431360, 1033, 1035, 1026
DIPR R.O.No.523-PPCL-AGENCY/ADVT/2026-27 Sd/- CHIEF ENGINEER (P&MM),TGSPDCL, Hyderabad

INSTITUTE OF MENTAL HEALTH AND HOSPITAL, AGRA
Mathura Road, Agra-282002
Phone-0562-2602650
E-mail: imhh.agra@gmail.com Website- www.imhh.org.in

WALK IN INTERVIEW

No. Dir./App./Walk in /2026/410 Date:-11-09-26

IMHH, Agra invites applications for following position on Contractual basis. Details of the posts, age, qualifications, experience and reservation as per U.P. Govt. rules, Emoluments, general conditions and application form can be downloaded from Institute Website- www.imhh.org.in

Post Name	Upper Age Up to (in years)	No. of Posts & Reservation	Salary Amount in (Rs.) Per Month
Clinical Psychologist	45	04 (1 SC, 02 UR & 01 OBC)	Rs. 60,000 Fixed Pay

DIRECTOR I.M.H.H., Agra

TENDER NOTICE
ANDHRA PRADESH MSME DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION (AP MSME DC)

2nd Floor, PVS Towers, Mangalagiri - 522503, E-mail: apmsmedc@ap.gov.in

Tender (2 call) Notice No. APMSMEDC/INC/64/34/2026, Dt.: 11.09.2026

Sealed tenders are invited from Manufacturers/ Authorized Dealers/ Distributors, and eligible bidders for the Supply, Installation, Testing, Commissioning and Trial Run of Machinery and Equipment for establishment of Fulfilment Centres / Packaging Experience Centres for SHG Enterprises under the Swayam AP Brand in 13 districts in Andhra Pradesh on behalf of Society for Elimination of Rural Poverty, Andhra Pradesh (SERP-AP). Machinery Details: Schedule A: Pouch Sealing, Coding & Labelling Equipment, Schedule B: Filling Machines, Schedule C: Packing, Weighing & Vacuum Packaging Machines, Schedule D: Food-Safety, Fulfilment & Ancillary Equipment, Schedule E: Bottling, Quality-Control, Training & Fulfilment Support Equipment

The tender document may be downloaded from the Central Public Procurement Portal (CPPP) and the AP MSME DC website at <https://eprocure.gov.in/eprocure/app> and www.apmsmeone.ap.gov.in. For further information or clarification, bidders may contact: The Executive Director, AP MSME DC, Mobile +91-8886611154, E-mail: ceo-apmsmedc@ap.gov.in The last date for submission of bid is 26.09.2026 at 5:00 PM.

Sd/- Chief Executive Officer, APMSMEDC
DIPR NO.5426PP/CL/ADVT/1/2021-22, Dt: 11/09/2026



MADHYA PRADESH PUBLIC HEALTH SERVICES CORPORATION LTD.
(A Government of Madhya Pradesh Undertaking)
Oil Fed Building, 01, Arera Hills, Bhopal
URL : <https://mpphscil.mp.gov.in>, Phone : 0755-2578915
Dated : 11.09.2026

TENDER NOTICE

Tenders for following item/Services floated on website and Portal from dated 10-09-2026 to next 30 days:

- Online Tender Enquiry No. : T-958/MPPHSCIL/Various Centrifuge Equipment and Complete Electrophoresis Apparatus/QC/2026, Dated - 05.09.2026 Uploaded on portal & Website.
- Tender (s) for Various for Microbiology Equipment
- Tender (s) for BiPAP Machine, Bilirubinometer Transcutaneous and Transport Incubator.
- Tender (s) for Various for Maternal Health (MH) Instrument
- Tender (s) for Various for Infantometer & Neonatal cum Pediatric Weighing Scale - Electronic.
- Tender (s) for Various Equipment
- Tender (s) for Various Drugs
- Tender (s) for Various Surgical & Consumables
- Tender (s) for Various Ayush Consumables/Drugs.

All Prospective bidders are requested to visit **"www.mptenders.gov.in/https://mpphscil.mp.gov.in, https://gem.gov.in"** for further details.

M.P. Madhyam/128043/2026 **CGM (TECHNICAL-II)**



शासकीय चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय, जिला-महासमुन्द (छ.ग.)
Email:- gmcmahasamund@gmail.com
Phone No. 07723-299171

क्रमांक/ 2673/शा.चि.म./ क्रम/ 2026 महासमुन्द, दिनांक 08/09/2026

निविदा सूचना का प्रारूप

शासकीय चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय महासमुन्द के विभिन्न विभागों हेतु अधिकृत विक्रेताओं से लघु उपकरण (Minor Equipment) प्रदाय करने हेतु मुहरबंद निविदाएं आमंत्रण की जाती है। निविदा प्रपत्र कार्यालय की वेबसाइट <https://gmcmahasamund.ac.in/> से डाउनलोड कर "अथवा अधिष्ठाता कार्यालय से आवेदन प्रस्तुत कर 25/09/2026 को दोपहर 12:00 बजे तक प्राप्त किये जा सकते है। निविदाकार अपना प्रस्ताव व दर बंद लिफाफे में दिनांक 28/09/2026 को दोपहर 1:00 बजे तक प्रस्तुत कर सकते है, निविदा फिस रुपए 1000/- ऑनलाईन अथवा निविदा के साथ जमा करना है।

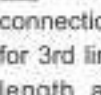
निविदा बिक्री करने की अंतिम तिथि 25/09/2026 समय दोपहर 12:00 बजे तक। निविदा जमा करने की अंतिम तिथि 28/09/2026 समय दोपहर 1:00 बजे तक। निविदा खोलने की तिथि 28/09/2026 समय दोपहर 3:00 बजे।

स्थान: कार्यालय अधिष्ठाता शासकीय चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय, जिला- महासमुन्द (छ.ग.)

हस्ता/-
अधिष्ठाता
शासकीय चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय
महासमुन्द (छ.ग.)

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER

Sr. DSTE, Chakradharpur, South Eastern Railway acting for and on behalf of the President of India invites e-tenders against Tender No. mentioned below to open on **01.10.2026 at 15.00 hrs.** Manual offers are not allowed against these tenders and any such manual offer received shall be ignored. **Sl.No.-1. Tender Notice No.: ST-CKP-OT-26-27-85. Name of work:** S&T work in connection with Construction of loop line for 3rd line and one sick siding of 70 M length at Garpos. **Tender Value:** ₹ 2,89,70,231.46. **Earnest Money:** ₹ 5,79,400. **Sl.No.-2. Tender Notice No.: ST-CKP-OT-26-27-86. Name of work:** S&T work in connection with Development of a Crossing Station with Provision of an additional full length loop line between Tatanagar and Haludipukur. **Tender Value:** ₹ 9,21,67,302.34. **Earnest Money:** ₹ 18,43,400. **Sl.No.-3. Tender Notice No.: ST-CKP-OT-26-27-87. Name of work:** S&T works for Provision of balance and additional work at Adityapur Station. **Tender Value:** ₹ 1,84,52,858.15. **Earnest Money:** ₹ 3,69,100. **Sl.No.-4. Tender Notice No.: ST-CKP-OT-26-27-88. Name of work:** Provision of additional display Boards (i.e. True colour OVD, PDB and AGDB) at Tatanagar, Chakradharpur, Rourkela, Jharsuguda Stations. **Tender Value:** ₹ 2,01,84,231.41. **Earnest Money:** ₹ 4,03,700. **Sl.No.-5. Tender Notice No.: ST-CKP-OT-26-27-89. Name of work:** S&T works in connection with Construction of 2 additional Loop Lines in DN grid of Maluka yard. **Tender Value:** ₹ 1,55,49,986.50. **Earnest Money:** ₹ 3,11,000. **Sl.No.-6. Tender Notice No.: ST-CKP-OT-26-27-90. Name of work:** Alteration Work for Construction of 2 additional Loop Lines in DN grid of Maluka yard. **Tender Value:** ₹ 1,50,24,140.07. **Earnest Money:** ₹ 3,00,500. **Sl.No.-7. Tender Notice No.: ST-CKP-OT-26-27-91. Name of work:** S&T work for Construction of Bridges and other associated works for Drainage improvement of Tatanagar East Yard. **Tender Value:** ₹ 1,07,26,270.75. **Earnest Money:** ₹ 2,14,500. **Completion Period:** 15 (Fifteen) Months (for Sl.No. 1), 18 (Eighteen) Months (for Sl.No. 2), 06 (six) months (for Sl.No. 3 to 6 each) & 12 (Twelve) Months (for Sl.No. 7). The tender details can be viewed at website <http://www.irps.gov.in>. The tenderer/bidders must have Class-III Digital Signature Certificate & must be registered on IREPS Portal. Only registered tenderer/bidders can participate in e-tendering. e-Tender forms shall be issued free of cost. (PR-755)



NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY
CORRIGENDUM-01/2026

(A) Corrigendum under NIT No. IZN-Elect-OT-29-2026, Dated:01-09-2026 In the E-tender notice No IZN-Elect-OT-29-2026, which was published on IREPS portal on Date: 01-09-2026, the Corrigendum No.1&2, dated:08-09-2026 and Corrigendum No.3, dated: 09-09-2026 have been published for modification in the following Scheduled items and tender Document:-
Particulars: Advertised Value (INR), Existing Value: ₹ 1,34,12,012.50, **Modified Value:** ₹ 1,36,25,254.30, **Particulars:** Earnest Money (INR), Existing Value: ₹ 2,68,300/-, **Modified Value:** ₹ 2,72,500/-, **Particulars:** Tender Closing Date Time, Existing Value: 23-09-2026 12:00, **Modified Value:** 26-09-2026 12:00, **Particulars:** Change in Item Quantity of Schedule-01 Items Existing Value: Schedule Item No.-23 Quantity- 90 Numbers, **Modified Value:** Schedule Item No.-23 Quantity- 60 Numbers, **Particulars:** Modification in Item Description of Schedule-01 Items, Existing Value: Schedule Item No.- 25, 29, 30, 48, 55, 56, 58; Technical description as provisioned in original NIT, **Modified Value:** Technical Description of Schedule Item No. 25, 29, 30, 48, 55, 56, 58 have been modified, **Particulars:** Addition of Scheduled Items, Existing Value: Nil, **Modified Value:** New Schedule Item No. 23a, 46, added, **Particulars:** Deletion of Scheduled Items Existing Value: Schedule Item No. - 46 & 47 provisioned in original NIT, **Modified Value:** Schedule Item No. 46 & 47 Deleted.
All others terms and condition will remain same as per original tender. Detailed tender notice, Eligibility Criteria, terms & condition and Corrigendum are available at website <http://www.irps.gov.in>.
(B) Corrigendum under NIT No. IZN-Elect-OT-28-2026, Dated:04-09-2026 In the E-tender notice No IZN-Elect-OT-28-2026, which was published on IREPS portal on Date: 04-09-2026, the Corrigendum No.1, dated: 09-09-2026 have been published for modification in the following Scheduled items and tender Document:-
Particulars: Advertised Value (INR), Existing Value: ₹ 1,11,59,462.67, **Modified Value:** ₹ 1,12,69,942.83, **Particulars:** Earnest Money (INR), Existing Value: ₹ 2,23,200/-, **Modified Value:** ₹ 2,25,400/-, **Particulars:** Change in Item Quantity of Schedule-01 Items, Existing Value: Schedule Item No.-32 Quantity-36 Numbers, **Modified Value:** Schedule Item No.-32 Quantity-24 Numbers, **Particulars:** Modification in Item Description of Schedule-01 Items, Existing Value: Schedule Item No.-10, 36, 44, 45, 48, 52, 53, 54, 58; Technical description as provisioned in original NIT, **Modified Value:** Technical Description of Schedule Item No. 10, 36, 44, 45, 48, 52, 53, 54, 58 have been modified, **Particulars:** Addition of Scheduled Items, Existing Value: Nil, **Modified Value:** New Schedule Item No. 32a, 40a added, **Particulars:** Deletion of Scheduled Items, Existing Value: Schedule Item No.-40 provisioned in original NIT, **Modified Value:** Schedule Item No.-40 Deleted.
All others terms and condition will remain same as per original tender. Detailed tender notice, Eligibility Criteria, terms & condition and Corrigendum are available at website <http://www.irps.gov.in>.
Sr. Divl. Electrical Engineer (G) CPRO/Vidut-178 Iztanagar
Never travel on roof and foot boards.

Farakka treaty nearing expiry, JDU revives campaign against barrage

Santosh Singh
Patna, September 11

NDA ALLY Janata Dal (United) has intensified its push against the Farakka Treaty by launching a campaign across 12 districts of Bihar situated on the banks of the river Ganga – a development that comes at a time when Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary reiterated that Bihar’s “interest should be guarded in the Farakka treaty”.

At its core, the JD-U’s ‘Nitish Samvad’ campaign is a push-back against the water treaty that Bihar politicians see as detrimental to the state’s interests.

A bilateral agreement between India and Bangladesh signed in December 1996, the Farakka treaty regulates the sharing of the Ganga waters at the Farakka Barrage in West Bengal, primarily during the dry season (January 1 to May 31). It will lapse this December.

But the JD-U has now gone a step further in this pushback. Citing a stance repeatedly taken by its chief and former chief minister Nitish Kumar, the party is demanding that the bar-

rage be dismantled. “We have called it ‘Nitish Samvad’ for a larger connection with the public. Nitish Kumar has repeatedly raised the demand with the Centre to dismantle the Farakka Barrage, which causes heavy siltation and floods,” JD(U) national working president and Rajya Sabha MP Sanjay Kumar Jha told *The Indian Express*.

He further said: “One can find several of Nitish Kumar’s video speeches detailing his stand on Farakka. We also carry his audio message as we visit people across 12 districts through which Ganga flows in Bihar.”

The JD(U) team has so far covered four districts: Buxar, Bhojpur, Begusarai, and Khagaria as part of the campaign. Former CM Nitish Kumar, however, will not be travelling for it. Jha, who is leading the initiative, said the party hopes to wrap up the campaign well before the Farakka treaty ends in December.

“We are completely against its renewal, as it fails to serve our interests. Instead, it remains one of the primary causes of devastating floods in Bihar.”

Produce Shamli man ‘detained’ by father over conversion on September 16: Allahabad HC

Bhupendra Pandey
Lucknow, September 11

FOLLOWING ALLEGATIONS that a 31-year-old Shamli man was being detained, after his decision to convert to Islam and marry a Muslim woman against his father’s wishes, the Allahabad HC ordered the man be produced on September 16.

The bench was hearing a habeas corpus petition filed by Ayush Malik’s friend, Sultan.

The petition claimed Ayush married a woman named Chandni Qureshi against the wishes of his father, Devraj Singh Malik. It said Chandni and her father, Islam Qureshi, were subsequently arrested in a case registered under the Uttar Pradesh Prohibition of Unlawful Conversion of Religion Act, 2021, along with charges including extortion, criminal intimidation, criminal conspiracy, forgery and cheating on a complaint lodged by Devraj.

A single bench of Justice Sandeep Jain, in its order on

Wednesday, said if Ayush is not produced on the said date, state authorities and his father shall file personal affidavits disclosing why they have not done so and the steps being taken to secure his production.

It all began when Ayush was seen in a video in June purportedly offering Eid prayers. At the time, Ayush had told media persons, “There was no pressure on me. I was always interested in Islam as a child. I converted to Islam around 2007, years before I met Chandni.” Sultan’s plea said Ayush embraced Islam “without any coercion, undue influence or inducement.” It alleged the authorities colluded with Devraj in facilitating Ayush’s illegal detention.

Justice Jain stated, “From a perusal of the documents..., it prima facie appears Ayush Malik has voluntarily renounced Hinduism and embraced Islam and, thereafter, solemnised marriage with Chandni Qureshi against the wishes of his father.”

17 killed in two separate road accidents in Maharashtra

Mumbai: Seventeen people were killed in two separate road accidents in Bhandara and Nanded. In Bhandara, nine people — six women and three children — died after a Mahindra Bolero from Sakoli towards Lakhani crashed into the rear of a Tata Eicher truck on NH-53 at 3.31 am Friday.

Eight died at the spot and another woman was declared brought dead in Nagpur. Thirteen others were injured. In Nanded, eight people were killed and seven injured when a mini-van carrying 12 passengers collided with a truck on NH-61 near Nanded at 7 pm Thursday evening. Police said the truck was allegedly travelling on the wrong side at high speed.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi announced ex-gratia assistance of Rs 2 lakh from the PM National Relief Fund for the next of kin of each deceased and Rs 50,000 for each injured person. **ENS**



GOVERNMENT OF MAHARASHTRA
FINANCE DEPARTMENT
EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (Eol)

Ref. No. : FD/BEACON/EOI/2026-27/01
Date : 12.09.2026

THE Finance Department Government of Maharashtra invites Expressions of Interest (Eol) from eligible entities for selection as Partner Agency for advisory on structuring, incorporation and operationalisation of a proposed State Finance Institution (NBFC), to be registered with the Reserve Bank of India.

Eligible Applicants: Central/ State PSUs, Public Sector Banks, Scheduled Commerical Banks and their subsidiaries engaged in investment banking or transaction advisory. (Please refer the detailed eligibility criteria specified in the Eol document).

Selection Process : Two-stage process- Stage1: Shortlisting through this Eol on eligibility and experience criteria; Stage 2: Detailed Request for Proposal (RFP) comprising Technical Presentation and Financial Bid, invited only from shortlisted Eol Participants, Eol is available from 12.09.2026, last date of submission of Eol is 30.09.2026. For the complete Eol document, terms, eligibility criteria and detailed schedule, please visit the State e-Tendering Portal (mahatenders.gov.in) or the Finance Department website (<https://finance.maharashtra.gov.in>).

Deputy Secretary (BEACON)
Finance Department, Government of Maharashtra
Mantralaya, Mumbai- 400032,
ds.beacon@maharashtra.gov.in, 022-22029721

DGIPR/2026-27/2817



बिहार सरकार

स्वास्थ्य विभाग
प्रेस विज्ञापित

नवनि्युक्त विशेषज्ञ चिकित्सा पदाधिकारियों के योगदान समर्पित करने हेतु निर्धारित समय-सीमा को विस्तारित करने संबंधी आवश्यक सूचना :-

बिहार स्वास्थ्य सेवा के अधीन विशेषज्ञ चिकित्सा पदाधिकारियों की नियुक्ति हेतु बिहार तकनीकी सेवा आयोग से विज्ञापन संख्या-09/2025 (जेनरल सर्जन), 10/2025 (स्त्री रोग), 13/2025 (हड्डी रोग), 14/2025 (शिशु रोग), 15/2025 (पैथोलॉजिस्ट), 16/2025 (फिजिशियन) एवं 18/2025 (रेडियोलॉजिस्ट) प्रकाशित किया गया था। उक्त विज्ञापनों के विरुद्ध आयोग से प्राप्त अनुशंसा के आलोक में विभागीय अधिसूचना सं० 1689(2) से 1691(2) दिनांक-20.07.2026 द्वारा कुल-200 योग्य अम्बार्थियों को सेवा में नियुक्त करते हुए विभिन्न स्वास्थ्य संस्थानों में पदस्थापित किया गया था। नियुक्ति की उक्त अधिसूचनाओं में योगदान समर्पित करने हेतु 30 दिन का समय निर्धारित किया गया था।

2. उल्लेखनीय है कि नवनि्युक्त विशेषज्ञ चिकित्सा पदाधिकारियों के योगदान समर्पित करने संबंधी क्षेत्रीय कार्यालयों से प्राप्त प्रतिवेदन की समीक्षा के क्रम में पाया गया कि 49 नवनि्युक्त विशेषज्ञ चिकित्सा पदाधिकारियों द्वारा अब तक पदस्थापित संस्थान पर योगदान समर्पित नहीं किया गया है। उक्त संबंध में विभाग द्वारा दूरभाष पर सम्पर्क करने के क्रम में कतिपय नवनि्युक्त चिकित्सकों द्वारा योगदान समर्पित करने हेतु इच्छा व्यक्त की गयी है।

3. वर्णित स्थिति में उपर्युक्त अधिसूचनाओं से नवनि्युक्त विशेषज्ञ चिकित्सा पदाधिकारियों के योगदान समर्पित करने हेतु पूर्व में निर्धारित समय-सीमा को दिनांक-25.09.2026 तक विस्तारित किया जाता है। अतः जिन विशेषज्ञ चिकित्सा पदाधिकारियों द्वारा अब तक योगदान समर्पित नहीं किया गया है, वे दिनांक- 25.09.2026 तक नव पदस्थापित स्थान में योगदान समर्पित करना सुनिश्चित करेंगे। नवनि्युक्त विशेषज्ञ चिकित्सा पदाधिकारियों द्वारा उक्त विस्तारित समय-सीमा के अन्दर किये जाने वाले योगदान को स्वीकृत करने की कार्यवाई संबंधित नियंत्री पदाधिकारी द्वारा सदनसुर किया जायेगा। उक्त सूचना www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar पर भी देखी जा सकती है।

(विनोद कुमार पाठक)
सरकार के उप सचिव

PR. No. 011568 (Health) 2026-27

नशामुक्त हो जाए बिहार, सुरक्षित रहे घर परिवार।

GOVT. OF BIHAR
BIHAR COMBINED ENTRANCE COMPETITIVE EXAMINATION BOARD
I.A.S. Association Building, Near Patna Airport, Patna-14.
Website : bceceboard.bihar.gov.in / Helpdesk : helpdesk.bceceboard@bihar.gov.in

UNDER GRADUATE MEDICAL ADMISSION COUNSELLING
(UGMAC)-2026 for MBBS/ BDS/ B.V.Sc. & A.H./ B.F.Sc. in Govt. Medical/ Dental / Veterinary Colleges / College of Fisheries and Private Medical/ Dental Colleges of Bihar
Adv. No.- BCECEB(UGMAC)-2026/06 Dated 11.09.2026
Notice regarding Resignation / Withdrawal of allotted seat from Round-1 Counselling and Online Counselling Programme for Round-2

In continuation to Adv. No. BCECEB(UGMAC)-2026/03 dated 25.08.2026 & 2026/04 dated 31.08.2026, it is informed to all eligible & interested NEET(UG)-2026 qualified candidates and all concerned that as per Health Department, Bihar, Patna Letter no. 1246(1) dated 10.09.2026, 2 (Two) New Govt. Medical Colleges viz. (i) Sriram Janki Medical College & Hospital, Samastipur (ii) Govt. Medical College, Chapra (Saran), 1 (One) Pvt. Medical Colleges viz. Kurma Sanskriti Medical College & Hospital, Kurma, Jehanabad and some additional seats in different Private Medical Colleges has been added.

2. In the light of above, updated seat matrix has been uploaded on Board's website.

3. The online Registration & submission of Application Form-cum-Choice Filling/ Editing of Application form data / Editing of Choices (Round-2) will start from 12.09.2026.

4. Eligibility criteria for counselling / admission Fee payment procedure, instructions and other details for filling up online applications form-cum-choice filling are available in the prospectus of UGMAC-2026 and the related Advertisement No.-BCECEB(UGMAC)-2026/01 dated 07.08.2026 and 2026/05 dated 11.09.2026, which can be seen / downloaded from the Board's website: bceceboard.bihar.gov.in.

Controller of Examination



जल संसाधन विभाग
कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
तिरहुत नहर प्रमंडल, हाजीपुर
E-Mail I.D. : eectdhajipur@gmail.com
शुद्धि पत्र

इस कार्यालय के पत्रांक -1453 दिनांक 10.08.2026 द्वारा आमंत्रित निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या -02/2026-27 को विभिन्न समाचार पत्रों में PR No -009848(WRD) 2026-27 द्वारा प्रकाशित है, में अपरिहार्य कारणों से निम्नांकित संशोधन किया जाता है -

क्र० सं०	पूर्व में संसूचित तिथि	संशोधित तिथि
1	2	3
04 निविदा कागजात डाउनलोड एवं अगलौड करने की तिथि	दिनांक 09.09.2026 से दिनांक 15.09.2026 (10:30 बजे पूर्वान्न से अपराह्न 03:00 बजे तक सिर्फ बेदासाइड www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)	दिनांक 16.09.2026 से 22.09.2026 (10:30 बजे पूर्वान्न से अपराह्न 03:00 बजे तक सिर्फ बेदासाइड www.eproc2

BUILD SYSTEMS THAT ARE FAST YET ACCOUNTABLE: SITHARAMAN

AI a double-edged sword, can influence elections also: FM

‘AI helps us spot fraud faster, but it also allows attackers to automate larger, more sophisticated cyberattacks’

Akash Mandal
Mumbai, September 11

FINANCE MINISTER Nirmala Sitharaman on Friday termed AI a double-edged sword, flagging the risks posed by newer technologies like agentic AI, tokenisation, and quantum computing. Technologies like AI have the capability of even influencing electoral outcomes in some cases, she added.

“The model that I’m referring to, I’m not naming it, is fully capable of influencing the opinion on the ground without people even sensing that they are being influenced. To the extent that I, being a minister, being in politics, I’m clearly seeing it capable of influencing elections,” said Sitharaman.

Despite obvious benefits like increased speed and efficiency, AI poses notable risks.

“Speed works both ways. When decisions and transactions become instantaneous, software errors, fraud, and market shocks can spread at the same rapid pace, naturally. AI acts as a double-edged sword: it helps us spot fraud faster, but it also allows attackers to automate larger, more sophisticated



AI may assist judgment, but responsibility must remain human and institutional, the FM said at Global Fintech Fest in Mumbai. ANI

cyberattacks,” Sitharaman said, speaking at the Global Fintech Fest in Mumbai. “Furthermore, the rise of quantum computing means our traditional security and encryption systems must be upgraded before current defences become obsolete,” she added.

Lighter, but firm regulatory approach

Exploring a possibility of a lighter regulatory approach for the fintech sector in order to iron out these risks without stifling innovation, Sitharaman welcomed the Reserve Bank of India’s move to recognise the United Fintech Forum as a self-regulatory organisation for the industry.

“I’m therefore glad that just yesterday, September 10, the Reserve Bank of India recognised the Unified Fintech Forum as another self-regulatory organisation for the fintech sector under the SRO-F’T framework,”

she added.

Sitharaman said the challenge for policymakers in the wake of newer technologies is to “build systems that are fast yet accountable, autonomous yet reversible when mistakes occur, and innovative without diluting consumer trust.”

“AI may assist judgment, but responsibility must remain human and institutional. The more serious the consequence of a decision, the stronger the requirement for review, explanation and appeal,” she explained. While leaving some leeway for innovation, Sitharaman pointed out the need for regulators to be aware of their respective responsibilities, adding that no activity should escape appropriate oversight just because “it sits at the boundary between sectors or is delivered through a technology platform rather than a conventional financial institution.”

FULL REPORT ON [WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM](#)

AHEAD OF 18th BRICS SUMMIT 2026

FMs, central bank chiefs flag unilateral tariffs

Aanchal Magazine
New Delhi, September 11

FLAGGING “SERIOUS concerns” about unilateral imposition of tariffs and non-tariff measures, BRICS finance ministers and central bank governors (FMCBG) in a joint statement said that such measures distort trade and are inconsistent with World Trade Organisation (WTO) rules.

Highlighting the growing share of emerging markets and developing economies (EMDEs) in global output and growth, the BRICS FMCBG also called for a merit-based, inclusive and transparent selection process that would increase regional diversity and representation of EMDEs in the leadership of International Monetary Fund (IMF) and the World Bank.

Noting that the global economy is facing significant headwinds, the FMCBG said risks to the global economic outlook remain elevated, reflecting persistent geopolitical tensions, trade fragmentation and protectionism, policy uncertainty, fiscal and inflationary pressures,

• WHAT THE JOINT STATEMENT SAID



● Unilateral imposition of trade and finance-related actions, including the raising of tariffs and non-tariff measures, distort trade and are inconsistent with WTO rules

● There is an urgent need to reform the Bretton Woods Institutions to make them more agile, effective, credible, inclusive, accountable to enhance their legitimacy

ures, growing debt and financial vulnerabilities.

“We continue to have serious concerns with the unilateral imposition of trade and finance-related actions, including the raising of tariffs and non-tariff measures, which distort trade and are inconsistent

with WTO rules. These pressures weigh most heavily on EMDEs. BRICS economies, however, have demonstrated resilience and continue to make a significant contribution to a stable, strong, sustainable, inclusive and balanced global growth,” the joint statement re-

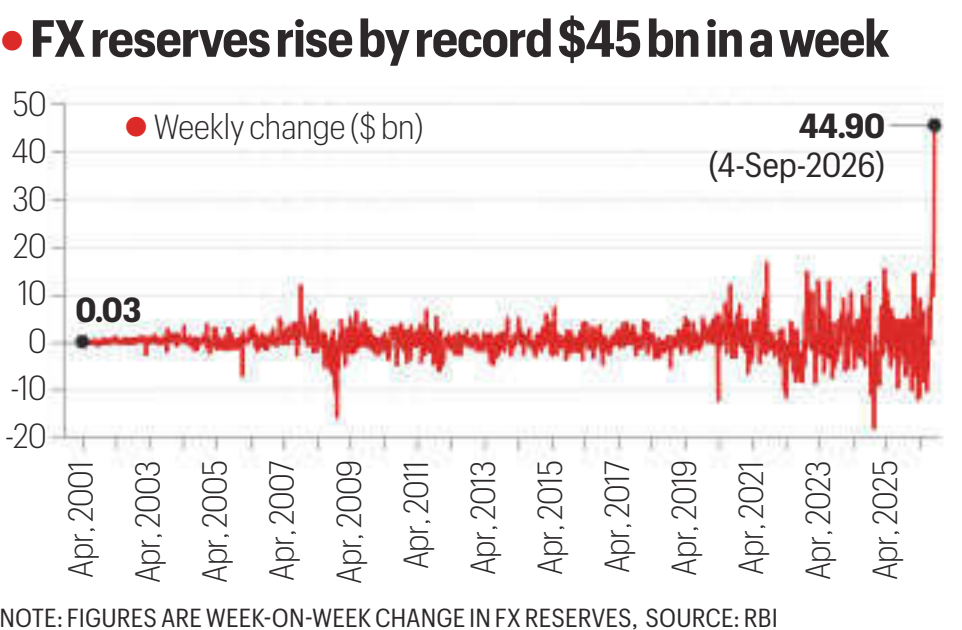
India climbs to 4th spot as forex reserves post record weekly gain

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, September 11

INDIA HAS overtaken Russia in fourth spot in the list of countries with the highest foreign exchange reserves after data released by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) on Friday showed that its reserves increased by \$45 billion in the week ended September 4 — the highest weekly gain ever.

As per latest data, India’s forex reserves stood at a new record \$785.71 billion as on September 4, up \$44.9 billion from August 28. Data from the Bank of Russia shows its international reserves stood at \$753.5 billion as on September 4, having fallen \$20.7 billion from \$774.2 billion the previous week.

China and Japan are at the top, with forex reserves of \$3.85 trillion and \$1.21 trillion, respectively. In third is Switzerland, with reserves of \$1.09 trillion. The massive \$44.9 billion gain in India’s forex reserves is over two-and-a-half times higher than the previous greatest weekly gain of \$16.7 billion, recorded in the week ended August 27, 2021, and has been driven by the unexpectedly high



NOTE: FIGURES ARE WEEK-ON-WEEK CHANGE IN FX RESERVES, SOURCE: RBI

inflow of Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank) deposits under the RBI’s concessional swap scheme. The sharp increase follows an earlier-than-anticipated closure of the swap scheme. Originally set to close on September 30, the rapid inflow of these deposits led to the RBI closing it one month earlier than initially planned.

Till August 31, \$127.23 billion of these FCNR(B) deposits had come in. The RBI’s two other concessional swap schemes for Overseas Foreign Currency Borrowings (OFCBs) and External Commercial Borrowings (ECBs) have seen the inflow of \$5.26 bil-

lion and \$3.89 billion, respectively. In total, \$136.38 billion had come in until August 31 under the special forex drive that was announced on June 5 and became operational on June 8. The swap windows for OFCBs and ECBs remain open till December 31.

This forex drive has ensured that India’s forex reserves have risen for 10 weeks in a row. A higher level of forex reserves gives the RBI greater ammunition to defend the rupee when the need arises, as has been the case from time to time.

FULL REPORT ON [WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM](#)

NSE sets IPO price band at Rs 1,700-1,785

ENS Economic Bureau
Mumbai, September 11

THE NATIONAL Stock Exchange (NSE) has fixed the price band for its mega initial public offering (IPO) at Rs 1,700-1,785 per equity share, valuing the country’s largest stock exchange at up to Rs 4.42 lakh crore (\$46 billion) at the upper end of the band. The IPO will open for public subscription on September 17 and close on September 21. The IPO is entirely an offer for sale (OFS) of up to 12.64 crore equity shares, with a face value of Rs each, by 10 existing shareholders.

At the upper price band, the issue is expected to raise Rs

22,562 crore. Since the offering is an OFS, the proceeds will accrue to the selling shareholders and not NSE. The selling shareholders include State Bank of India, Bank of Baroda, Canada Pension Plan Investment Board, Aranda Investments (Mauritius) Pte Ltd, MS Strategic (Mauritius) Ltd, General Insurance Corporation of India, New India Assurance Company, SBI Capital Markets, Stock Holding Corporation of India and United India Insurance Company.

NSE managing director and CEO Ashishkumar Chauhan said the stock exchange has not applied to SEBI for permission to trade on its own platform. BSE, which came out with an

IPO earlier, is listed on NSE.

The stated objective of the IPO is to facilitate the OFS and enable the listing of NSE’s equity shares on BSE. NSE currently has 247.5 crore outstanding equity shares with a face value of Rs 1 each.

Investors can bid for a minimum of eight equity shares and in multiples of eight thereafter. Under the book-building process, not more than 50% of the issue will be reserved for Qualified Institutional Buyers, while not less than 15% will be available to Non-Institutional Investors and not less than 35% to Retail Individual Investors.

FULL REPORT ON [WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM](#)

leased late Thursday said.

The finance ministers and Central Bank Governors of the BRICS countries, had met in Jaipur on August 12-13 and in Mumbai on September 10 under the theme “Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability”.

India is hosting the 18th BRICS Summit in New Delhi on September 12-13. BRICS is an informal grouping of 11 major emerging markets and developing countries: Brazil, China, Egypt, Ethiopia, India, Indonesia, Iran, Russia, Saudi Arabia, South Africa and the United Arab Emirates.

Under the BRICS theme for this year, the FMCBG statement said they seek to “strengthen collective capacities, promote innovation, and advance sustainable development and resilience in the face of evolving global challenges”.

On the reforms required for global economic governance, the FMCBG said they will continue to strengthen coordination among BRICS members to make international financial institutions more representative, transparent and accountable.

• BRIEFLY

Inclusive growth needed for Viksit Bharat: NITI CEO

Mumbai: India has made reasonable progress on economic growth, and it needs inclusive growth to become a developed country by 2047, NITI Aayog CEO Anurag Jain said on Friday. Speaking at the Global Fintech Fest 2026, Jain said some states have done extremely well on health and education parameters as well. “But there are certain states which are lagging behind, so we need to concentrate on them also,” Jain said. He said India has a good foundation to achieve prosperity by 2047 through economic inclusion. PTI

SEBI seeks IT, cyber framework for MII arms

New Delhi: Markets watchdog SEBI on Friday proposed extending the IT and cyber security framework of Market Infrastructure Institutions (MIIs) — comprising stock exchanges, depositories, and clearing corporations — to their subsidiaries to strengthen regulatory oversight. While MIIs are governed by SEBI and operate in compliance with its IT and cybersecurity frameworks, the applicability and regulatory jurisdiction of these framework are not explicitly defined over their subsidiaries. PTI

• MARKETS

 Sensex 74,781.76 -120.83 -0.16%	 NIFTY 23,398.10 -79.70 -0.34%	 Gold ▼ ₹1,51,938	 US Dollar ▲ ₹95.56
		 Silver ▲ ₹2,28,920	 Oil ■ \$115.98

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1 KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF SEPTEMBER 9, 2026

● **US DEBT HAS CROSSED \$40 TRILLION AND ITS TRADE DEFICIT HAS ALSO WIDENED DESPITE A SLEW OF TARIFFS ON TRADE PARTNERS**

Trump’s unusual threat to US Federal Reserve and why it matters to India

Ravi Dutta Mishra
New Delhi, September 11

AFTER MONTHS of threatening allies and rivals alike with tariffs to coerce them into signing lopsided trade deals, US President Donald Trump seemingly has gone a step further and warned the Federal Reserve (Fed) to cut interest rates, or else the US would stop trading with countries with which it has a trade deficit.

Trump’s warnings have become more and more aggressive amid growing worry over US debt and trade deficit. The latest data showed that US debt has crossed a record \$40 trillion and the trade deficit also

widened despite a slew of tariffs on trade partners. High debt numbers are increasingly making investors nervous amid rising oil prices due to the US-Iran war, and are pushing US 10-year bond yield (a benchmark for global borrowing costs) towards 5%.

International think tanks estimated that the US government will spend little over \$1 trillion this fiscal year paying interest on the debt, which is equivalent to its national defence spending.

According to the Council on Foreign Relations, the US debt-to-GDP ratio has now reached 125%.

India, other trade partners at crossroads

Uncomfortable debt and deficit numbers explain why Trump is going after even the closest trade partners in a bid to bridge the trade gap and simultaneously pushing for lower interest rates.

As the US aggressively narrows its trade deficit with China to its lowest in two decades, Washington has begun pressuring trade partners like India to do the same.

For India, US pressures are playing on three fronts. One, steep market access demands under trade deals; two, outflow of investment from India to the



The US-India trade framework has created considerable tensions, particularly among Indian farmers. REUTERS

US; and three, pressure to lower dependency on input items originating from China, which the US believes is operating a

‘shadow transshipment network’ which ultimately helps Beijing widen the effective trade deficit, displace domestic

production, reduce GDP growth, and lower associated federal tax receipts in the US. India and the US have been negotiating a bilateral trade agreement since February 2025, and in February this year, the two countries announced a framework for an Interim Agreement. This framework agreement has already created considerable tensions, particularly among farmers.

International trade experts have warned that if India lowers customs duties on US imports, the livelihoods of Indian farmers engaged in growing apples, cotton, grapes, oranges, soybeans, walnuts and some other agricultural

products would face direct pressure.

Impact on India

India has already taken various steps to assuage the US by stepping up energy imports and lowering tariffs on broad swaths of products that are of US interest, from bikes to whiskey and tax holiday for data centres and items required to boost nuclear power production in India.

The *Indian Express* recently reported that the US’ share in India’s liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) imports has already surged to over 50% in the six months since the West Asia crisis started. Industry sources said that fear of US scrutiny is

pushing cotton prices higher. Indian apparel exporters last month approached the Commerce and Industry Ministry and the Textile Ministry seeking regulation of cotton yarn exports to arrest a sharp surge in prices amid US restrictions on the use of cotton originating from China’s Uyghur region.

The Apparel Export Promotion Council (AEPCC) said cotton yarn prices have increased by around 60%, from approximately Rs 250 per kg in early 2026 to around Rs 400 per kg currently, putting increasing pressure on the apparel manufacturing value chain.

FULL REPORT ON [WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM](#)

YEMENI GOVERNMENT SAYS FORCES HAVE WITHDRAWN FROM PERIM ISLAND

Houthis seize key Red Sea island, tighten grip on key shipping route

Trump rejects Saudi request for US strikes on Houthis: *Axios*

Reuters
Aden, Dubai, September 11

YEMEN'S IRAN-aligned Houthi Friday reached strategic island of Perim in Bab el-Mandeb Strait, four Yemeni government sources told *Reuters*, potentially tightening their grip on one of the world's vital shipping routes. Earlier, two sources from the Saudi-backed, internationally recognised Yemeni government said its forces had withdrawn from Perim and that the Houthis had also taken the mainland Red Sea coastal town of Dhubbab, which faces the island. If the Houthis gain full control of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait, on the opposite side of the Arabian Peninsula from the Strait of Hormuz, it could give their backer Iran a critical advantage in the war with the US, reducing supplies through a second major transit corridor and sending oil prices surging. In a further potentially significant development for



Houthi rebels march mobilise troops in Sanaa, Yemen, Thursday. REUTERS

Riyadh, satellite imagery showed smoke on Thursday in the vicinity of Saudi Arabia's East-West oil pipeline, which has become a vital means for the kingdom to divert its crude exports from Hormuz. There was no confirmation from Saudi Arabia of any incident in the area. The Saudi government media office and state oil giant Aramco did not respond to requests for comment on the smoke visible in the imagery verified by *Reuters*. Aramco has used the East-West pipeline to ramp up crude flows from Saudi Arabia's east-

ern coast to the Red Sea to its west after US-Israeli airstrikes on Iran began six months ago, prompting Tehran to effectively shut Strait of Hormuz. Global oil prices were on track to end the week above \$100 a barrel for the first time since mid-May, though they were slightly lower on Friday after the *Financial Times* reported that foreign ministers in West Asia were trying to work out a temporary deal to manage shipping through the Strait. Yemeni government forces, meanwhile, indicated they would try to retake areas cap-



tured by the Houthi militants in their lightning offensive this week along Red Sea coastline. They announced they would deploy weapons and aircraft to eliminate any movement of the "terrorist" Houthi militias in strategic areas, including the road leading to the coastal city of Mocha, which the militant group captured Thursday along with Red Sea islands of Hanish. Military spokesman Colonel Majed al-Nazili called on civilians to avoid using the route between the city of Taiz and Mocha and steer clear of equipment belonging to the Houthis, moun-

tain fighters who withstood years of devastating Saudi air strikes during Yemen's civil war. Saudi Arabia has been bombing Houthi targets in Yemen but not the strategic areas the group has seized this week. Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman called US President Donald Trump twice on Thursday and urged him to launch strikes against the Houthis, *Axios* reported, citing two US officials. Trump rejected the request, and US officials said the administration does not intend to take direct military action against the Houthis at this time, report said. According to *Axios*, US is increasingly concerned about the rapidly escalating conflict in Yemen and is stepping up support for Saudi Arabia while seeking to avoid direct involvement. Gulf foreign ministers plan to meet their Iranian counterpart in a push by Oman and Iran to secure buy-in for a temporary deal to manage shipping through the Strait of Hormuz, the *Financial Times* reported Friday. The gathering is scheduled to be held on Monday in the Omani coastal city of Salalah, the report said, citing two people briefed on the matter. *Reuters* could not verify the report.

Israel strikes south Lebanon, says Hezbollah base destroyed

Abdi Latif Dahir & Hwaida Saad
Beirut, September 11

A HUGE explosion sent shock waves across southern Lebanon overnight, as the Israeli military said it had destroyed an underground Hezbollah base in a strategically significant area of Israel's conflict with the Iran-backed militia. The blast lit up the sky with a sudden orange flash and tore through the Ali al-Taher ridge, a commanding hilltop about six miles from the border between Israel and Lebanon that Israel captured this month. Lebanese and Israeli officials say Hezbollah, a Lebanese militia supported by Iran, established a major underground installation beneath the ridge. Israel says the complex had for years served as a command center for planning and launching attacks against it. The ridge overlooks much of southeastern Lebanon, including Nabatieh, one of country's largest cities. "The explosion caused massive sounds in Nabatieh," Abbas Fakhreddine, the city's mayor, said on Friday. The explosion generated ground waves that were likened to an earthquake measuring 4.2 on the Richter scale, Lebanon's National News Agency reported, citing the country's National Center for Geophysics. NYT



Firefighters at a petrol station hit by a Russian drone, in Kyiv on Friday. REUTERS

Russia widens air war with fresh strikes on Kyiv petrol stations

Associated Press
Kyiv, September 11

RUSSIAN DRONES targeted roadside gas stations in Kyiv for a second straight day Friday, as Moscow broadened its air war in what Ukrainian officials say is an effort to rattle civilians. Russian strikes on urban gas stations have intensified in recent months, mostly in regions near the front line in eastern and southern Ukraine. It is part of a campaign to disrupt civilian life and weaken morale that has also included attacks on food distribution hubs, leaving some supermarket shelves bare in the Ukrainian capital. Ukraine is urgently trying to improve its air defences as Russia's invasion stretches into its fifth year, and won pledges of more support from Canada. Ukraine, meanwhile, has extended its own long-range drone campaign deep into Russia, straining air defenses across its bigger neighbour's vast territory. On Thursday, its military reported hitting a refinery more than 3,000 kilometers away in Siberia as Kyiv tries to hurt Russia's vital oil sector. Its strikes have caused fuel shortages in Russia, one of the world's biggest energy producers. Russia's oil product exports hit record lows in August, and Moscow is importing fuel from South Korea and India, the Center for Research on Energy and Clean Air said in a report. "Ukrainian strikes on Russia's refining capacity have

Over 500,000 Russian troops killed in Ukraine: UK defence chief

Kyiv: More than half a million Russian troops have been killed in Ukraine since the start of Moscow's full-scale invasion in February 2022, a senior British defence official said Friday. The dead are part of 1.5 million Russian casualties in Ukraine, Air Chief Marshal Sir Richard Knighton, Chief of the UK's Defense Staff, said. The UK figures roughly coincide with those published by the Ukrainian military. There was no comment from Russian officials. He didn't say what Ukraine's losses were. AP

After poll victory, German Far-Right AfD seeks allies to form state government

Far-Left party says open to working with AfD, rejects formal coalition

Reuters
Magdeburg, September 11

AFTER ITS triumph in Sunday's state election in Saxony-Anhalt, Germany's far-right AfD needs to attract defectors from other parties or reach an agreement with the small far-left BSW party that is setting difficult conditions in return for its support. Ulrich Siegmund, the 35-year-old AfD leader who is expected to become state premier, said there were discussions with both the BSW and individual members of other parties "to see if there is any common

ground that could help secure a stable majority". He said he wanted to form such a majority in the state legislature "as soon as possible". However, there is nothing unusual in German politics about coalition negotiations that last for weeks or even months before a government can be formed. Even if he secures an agreement with another party that would allow him to become premier, his majority is likely to be a slim one, making governing more complicated than his record score in the election might suggest. The BSW, which won five seats in the state parliament, has said it is interested in working with the AfD. But so far the BSW has said it does not want to enter a formal coalition and wants an independent state premier, a condition that Siegmund rejects.

Hong Kong court sentences 3 Tiananmen vigil organisers to prison in national security case

Hong Kong: Three Hong Kong activists who organized annual vigils in remembrance of China's 1989 Tiananmen Square crackdown were sentenced Friday to about five to seven years in prison in a case widely seen as a barometer of the city's eroding freedoms as Beijing clamps down on dissent. Lee Cheuk-yan, Chow Hang-tung and Albert Ho were convicted of inciting subversion earlier this year under a Beijing-imposed national security law.

Lee received a seven-year prison term and Chow was sentenced to seven years and three months. Both pleaded not guilty. Ho was given a lower sentence of five years and two months, partly because he pleaded guilty. The three were leaders of the Hong Kong Alliance in Support of Patriotic Democratic Movements of China, which for three decades organized a Tiananmen vigil that was the only large-scale, public commemoration of the 1989 crackdown in China. AP

Russia may target Europe border crossings: Tusk

Associated Press
Warsaw, September 11

TWO INCIDENTS along Ukraine's borders with Poland and Moldova this week are a preview of potential intensified Russian provocations at Ukraine's border crossing points with Europe, Polish Prime Minister Donald Tusk said. Two people died when Russian drones hit the Starokozache border crossing between Ukraine and Moldova on Tuesday night while a "direct threat"



Polish PM Donald Tusk

to a Polish-Ukrainian crossing point on Wednesday night was only avoided thanks to cooperation between Warsaw and Kyiv, Tusk said on Thursday.

He gave no further details of the incident, nor did he present evidence of Russian involvement. Tusk said he received a briefing on Thursday from CIA Director Jim Ratcliffe, who was recently in Moscow, about the risks posed by Russia in the region in the coming months. "Russia already decided to engage in provocative attacks on border crossing points, for example in Moldova," he said, speaking on Thursday in Bratislava, Slovakia, during a meeting of central European countries

and Ireland. "We expect similar actions regarding border crossings with Ukraine in other countries as well, including Poland." Tusk added that he received information from Ratcliffe indicating Poland and Europe should be prepared for "various scenarios" on the Russian-Ukrainian front and in the countries on the European Union's eastern flank. Ukraine shares borders with Poland, Slovakia, Hungary, Romania, and Moldova, as well as Russia and its ally Belarus.

25th ANNIVERSARY OF 9/11



(Clockwise from top left) Dr Jill Biden, former President Joe Biden, former First Lady Laura Bush, former President George W Bush, former New York Mayor Michael Bloomberg, Vice President JD Vance and former New York Mayor Rudy Giuliani in New York; President Donald Trump and first lady Melania Trump in Washington, DC; Iris Weinshall, Senate Minority Leader Chuck Schumer, former Secretary of State Hillary Clinton, former President Bill Clinton, former First Lady Michelle Obama and former President Barack Obama in New York; flowers adorn a 9/11 memorial; officers carry a US flag beside the reflecting pools at the 9/11 Memorial. REUTERS, AP

● FAMILY MEMBERS TO READ NAMES OF ALL 2,977 VICTIMS OF SEPTEMBER 11 ATTACKS AND SIX KILLED IN 1993 BOMBING

25 years on, Americans reflect on attack that changed a nation

Reuters
New York, September 11

AMERICANS MARKED the 25th anniversary of the September 11 attacks on Friday, honoring 3,000 people killed when hijacked planes struck the World Trade Center, the Pentagon and the field in Pennsylvania. In New York, victims' families joined Vice President JD Vance and four former US presidents at Ground Zero. The ceremony began at 8:46 a.m. ET with a moment of silence when American Airlines Flight 11 struck the World Trade Center's North Tower. Family members then read the names of 2,977 people killed on September 11, along with the six killed in the 1993 World Trade Center bombing. Some readers

were children who never met relatives they lost. Other moments of silence marked the crashes of three other airplanes and the collapse of the towers. For the first time, a seventh moment honoured thousands who have died from illnesses tied to toxic dust. Gregory Carafello attended to honour friend James Martello, working at Cantor Fitzgerald, which lost over 650 employees. Carafello was on 18th floor of the South Tower but managed to evacuate. "Everyone should realize that it was a very bad, catastrophic day for many families," he said. "These were not warriors. These were people like you and me going to work." At the Pentagon in Arlington, where Flight 77 struck the building, killing 184, President Don-



A boy looks at the Brooklyn 9/11 Wall of Remembrance during a candlelight ceremony in Coney Island on Friday. REUTER

ald Trump recalled those aboard who perished, including a pregnant woman, a family of four headed to Australia and three sixth-graders on a trip. Trump and Defense Secre-

tary Pete Hegseth used their speeches to defend the Iran war, saying it was necessary to prevent Tehran from acquiring nuclear weapons. Mourners also gathered in

Shanksville, Pennsylvania, where passengers brought down United Airlines Flight 93, which was headed for Washington. The attacks shaped generations, influencing US foreign policy, domestic politics and attitudes toward security. They initiated the "war on terror", leading to US invasions of Afghanistan and Iraq. For victims' families, friends and first responders, the anniversary remains a tribute to lives lost and heartbreak. Caroline Ogonowski's father, John, was the captain of Flight 11. Ogonowski, now 39, had her first baby this year and named him after her father. "This year, there's this new sadness in knowing that they won't ever get to know each other," she said. "My father will never know his

grandson. And my son will never know his grandfather." Ogonowski said future generations must be taught what happened and who was lost. A generation has grown up since 2001 too young to remember the attacks but shaped by them. Muslim Americans and immigrants from Muslim-majority countries faced increased prejudice and hate crimes. Zohran Mamdani, New York's first Muslim mayor, faced calls from some Republicans to skip the ceremony, which he rejected. The New York City Fire Department lost 343 members that day. Over 600 additional firefighters have since died of 9/11-related illnesses, department figures show. Twenty-six have died this year alone.

● BRIEFLY

SWITZERLAND

5 dead, 40 injured after bus hits barrier, probe on

POLICE SAY five people have died and 40 others were injured after a Dutch tour bus slammed into a roadside crash barrier and overturned in eastern Switzerland. The bus, with 45 on board, overturned Thursday between the villages of Susch and Zerne in the Alpine canton of Graubunden. Three people remained in serious condition at hospital, police said. Prosecutors and police were investigating what led to the accident. AP

CONGO

Ebola outbreak expands to seventh province

THE EBOLA outbreak in eastern Congo, the world's fastest-growing outbreak of the disease on record, has now spread to seven provinces in the African country, authorities said. According to the governor of the north-western province of Sud-Ubangi, Jean-Rene Galekwa Vundawe, laboratory tests by national research institute found in a sample the Bundibugyo virus, the rare kind of Ebola that caused the current outbreak. AP

The Big Picture

SATURDAY, SEPTEMBER 12, 2026

15

AT 11.18 AM on January 31, Pishaura Singh, the revenue official of Gilpan, a border village in Tarn Taran district, Punjab, was tying his turban when he heard the sound — a low hum he had trained himself to hear.

"It's a drone," he told his wife, stepping outside and pointing his phone camera to the sky. The UAV, suspected to be launched from Pakistan, was flying towards his house. It eventually fell near his kitchen garden, barely 700 metres from the iron fencing along the India-Pakistan border.

What struck Singh was a blue stamp bearing Urdu letters, possibly identifying the consignment the drone was carrying — a kg of contraband, including drugs, sealed in two packets.

Singh, a member of the village defence committee formed by the Punjab government to help tackle cross-border smuggling and drones, said, "I called our local police station and the Deputy Superintendent of Police, but they didn't answer my calls. I eventually called the Senior Superintendent of Police in Tarn Taran, and only then did the local police respond. Later, the BSF [the Border Security Force, whose jurisdiction extends to these parts] also came."

Senior police officers say drones have been ferrying narcotics, weapons and explosives from launchpads deep inside Pakistan's Punjab and dropping them across the border in Indian Punjab, often under the cover of darkness. Nearly 294 Pakistani drones were intercepted by the BSF and other allied agencies in Punjab in 2024, 287 in 2025, and around the same number had been intercepted until August this year.

"Drones can be launched from any place, at any time, with very little preparation. But we have evidence of active Pakistani military participation in helping smugglers launch these drones through training modules," said a senior security official.

A flight across the border fence

In Punjab, the 462-km fence along the International Border or Zero Line was built mainly in the late 1980s and early 1990s to stop infiltration and smuggling during the militancy years. It is a multi-layered physical barrier, guarded in peacetime by the BSF, with riverine and flood-related gaps.

The fence does not sit on the Zero Line. Under older ground rules, it was meant to stand some 150 yards (less than a km) inside Indian territory, but in many stretches, it was built much deeper, sometimes two to three km inside the Indian side, leaving large tracts of farmland between the fence and the actual border or Zero Line.

By 1993, most of the feasible land border had been fenced and floodlit. This fence, 8-12 feet tall, is topped with multiple rows of concertina/razor wires and, in some places, high-voltage 'cobra' wires. A patrol track runs along the fence, which is dotted with observation towers and border outposts.

However, with the incursions now aerial, the fence has largely turned into a modern Maginot line — the heavily fortified line of concrete obstacles and bunkers built by France during World War II — which ended up being ineffective because the German army simply went around it.

Now, for the first time, an analysis of data from over 1,200 drones intercepted by multiple security agencies, including the BSF and the Punjab Police, since 2024 has helped map the routes, launch and drop sites, and operating patterns of the drones that are fast emerging as a sophisticated cross-border threat.

The analysis has revealed a disturbing evolution in the drone operations: what began as relatively simple radio-controlled incursions has transformed into a more technologically resilient enterprise, with modified platforms, anti-jamming capabilities and even satellite-linked systems.

Despite India employing counter-drone measures, many drones can now detect interference and automatically turn back to Pakistan before coming back, turning this into a relentless cat-and-mouse battle along Punjab's 550-km International Border.

Security agencies have identified at least eight key launch pads in Pakistan's Punjab, from where sustained drone sorties take place into Indian Punjab.

The two primary drone launch pads used by Pakistani smugglers are Jahman and Masteki, two villages that are strategically located along the International Border. Jahman sits directly across from Khalra sector in Tarn Taran district of Indian Punjab. Further south, Masteki lies in Sehjra enclave, a pocket of Pakistani territory surrounded by India on three sides, positioning the village roughly opposite Khem Karan town in Tarn Taran, Indian Punjab.

Other Pakistani launch pads are near Kasur, also on the other side of Khem Karan; Qila Jiwan Singh, opposite Rajatal in the Attari sector; Wagah, opposite Attari; and Narowal, on the other side of Dera Baba Nanak, in Indian Punjab's Gurdaspur district.

Sources said the data analysis has also revealed the main landing areas in India. "The drones usually fly into Bhindi Saidan, Attari, Rajatal, Dall, Daleri, Maari Meghaan, Wan and villages around Khemkaran, including Kals and Mastgarh," said a source.

'Drones are routine here'

Mahawa, in Amritsar, is a kilometre away from the Zero Line, placing its villagers directly in the path of illegal drone incursions. Of its 2,800 acres, nearly 150 acres lie between the Zero Line and the border fence.

Village defence committee member and farmer union leader Harchand Singh Mahawa said drones frequently travel six kilometres inside the Indian border, flying directly over residential settlements and agricultural lands. "Recently, a drone dropped a consignment on a farmer's field. He came to us. He was afraid that police



LOOKING UP AT THE DRONES

Standing 12 feet tall, the 462-km fence along the International Border, fortified by rows of concertina and high-voltage wires, appears formidable, but it is no match for the intruder that flies across to drop arms, ammunition and drugs. MAN AMAN SINGH CHHINA & KAMALDEEP SINGH BRAR on the drones that keep the security establishment on its toes

553 KM

PUNJAB'S INTERNATIONAL BORDER WITH PAKISTAN

BORDER FENCE: The 462-km fence, built 2-3 km from the border, was built in the late 1980s and early 1990s to stop infiltration and smuggling during Punjab's militancy years

PAKISTAN

might arrest him," he said.

The recent security analysis found that drones largely drop their consignment on agricultural fields for couriers to pick it up, but sometimes, they drop the payload on farmhouses or homes due to navigational errors or incorrect GPS data.

The village defence committee in Mahawa assured police that the villager who owned the land was the person who informed them about the consignment.

"Our role as committee members is to coordinate with the BSF and local authorities when we find stray drones and pistols. We also ensure that innocents are not getting implicated," said Harchand Singh Mahawa.

In the Mahawa case, the police eventually filed an FIR against "unidentified persons".

In Gilpan, Pishaura Singh, the village defence committee member in whose kitchen garden a drone dropped a kg of contraband, says another drone dropped off its payload at the edge of the village the same evening. "The BSF received the location and moved to cordon the area, but by the time they arrived, the men had already picked up the drone and the contraband and fled. Many of these drones carry drugs and are responsible for so many youngsters taking to drugs," he said.

Known for the retreat ceremony on the Zero Line, Attari is another border village that witnesses daily flights of drones carrying contraband. Harpreet Singh, the sarpanch of Attari village, which has a population of around 25,000, is known for his activism against drugs and smuggling.

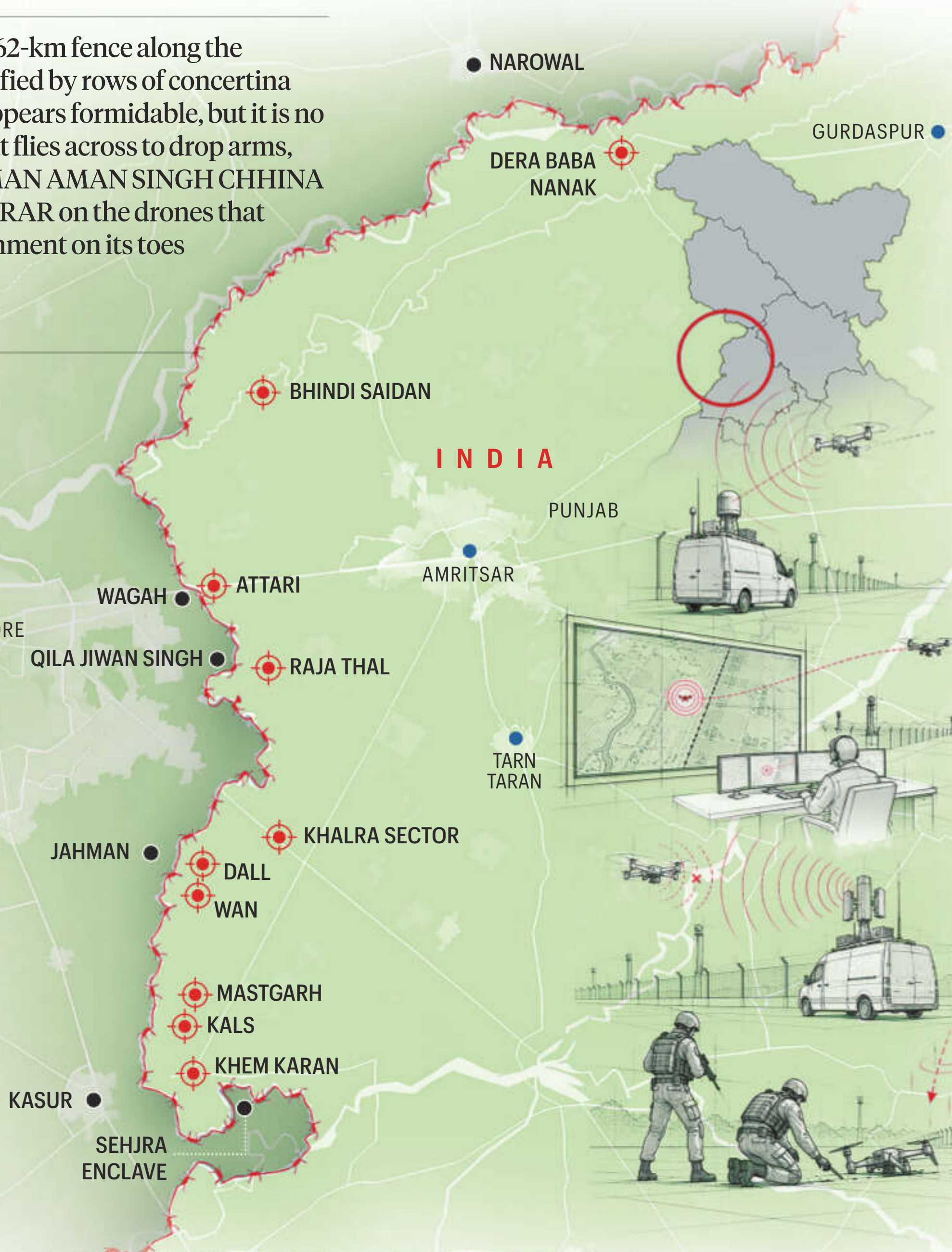
He was recently injured, allegedly in an attack by narcotics smugglers. "Villagers informed me about drone activity. I spotted a person at the spot, receiving the consignment from a drone. We caught him, but by then, he had handed the consignment over to someone else. It is a routine affair here," says Singh.

A battleground in the skies

A senior security official told *The Indian Express* that it was around 2019 that Pakistani drones were first noticed in Punjab. The drones then were relatively rudimentary, operating through radio-frequency direction control. "In 2026, drones with satellite communication and anti-jamming abilities were seen operating in Punjab. Many Pakistani drones now also use Starlink satellite communication to navigate, and some of these have also been downed in Punjab," the official said.

Most drones in use for drug smuggling, police alleged, are of Chinese make, including the DJI Mavic 4 Pro that can do multiple sorties and the DJI Matrice 300 RTK, which is capable of carrying a big payload.

While the BSF has equipped its personnel with portable drone interception equipment along the International Border in Punjab, the Punjab government has also procured mobile anti-drone systems mounted on specialised vehicles, including



A drone that was captured at Khilcha village in Ferozepur district, Punjab; the Punjab government's anti-drone system in Dall village, around 100 metres from the International Border



1,200 drones

were intercepted by security agencies in Punjab. An analysis of data recovered from these drones has helped map the launch points, drop zones and operating patterns of the cross-border drone network

FINDINGS FROM DRONES

THE TAKE-OFF

8 launch pads

in Pakistan's Punjab, from where sustained drone sorties take place into India. The Pakistani villages of Jahman and Masteki are the main launch pads

THE LANDING

Bhindi Saidan, Attari, Dall, Khem Karan and Wan in Indian Punjab are among the main landing areas where the drones allegedly drop contraband

DRONES THAT GLITCH

Drones largely drop arm or drug payloads on fields for couriers to pick up, but sometimes, drops are in farmhouses or homes due to navigational errors or incorrect GPS data

INTERCEPTIONS

3.5-10 KM

from the International Border is where the highest number of drones are captured on the Indian side

PEAK ACTIVITY

HIGHEST NUMBER OF DROPS ARE ON THURSDAYS AND SATURDAYS

10 PM & 4 AM

is when maximum drone activity happens

12-15 drones/hour

is the average number that flies into the Indian side

45 minutes

is the average sortie duration per drone (24 minutes for modified drones)

FLYING ALTITUDE

500 FEET

BASIC DRONES

2,500 FEET

OCTOCOPTER DRONE

ANTI-DRONE SYSTEM

Punjab became the first state to have an anti-drone system in August 2025, when Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann launched the 'Baaz Akh (Hawk Eye)' to curb drone-enabled cross-border smuggling

HOW IT WORKS

DETECTS DRONES: The system can identify drone movements and signals and, automatically, alert security agencies

TRACKS DRONES: Once alerted, security agencies can track the drone on a digital map

JAMMING: The system can disrupt the drone's control signals, be it radio frequency or satellite navigation frequencies

NEUTRALISATION: The drone then is forced to make an emergency landing and can be intercepted

the 'Baaz Akh' (Hawk Eye) Anti-Drone System (ADS).

The Rs 51.4 crore Baaz Akh was launched by Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann in August 2025 and was intended to stop cross-border smuggling from Pakistan. With that, Punjab had become the first Indian state to deploy an independent, state-level anti-drone grid as a second line of defence.

The Baaz Akh system focuses on detection, tracking, jamming, and neutralisation, typically disrupting radio frequencies and GPS signals. It has a range of 8-10 km, automated alerts, and an ability to identify ground control stations.

However, officials said, many of these systems do not prove to be as effective since Pakistani drones manage to return to their base even after being jammed.

"The Pakistanis have equipped their drones with fail-safe 'return-to-home' mechanisms. When our systems attempt jamming, locking, or disruption of the control signal, the drones detect the interference and automatically return to their launch point in Pakistan before they can be fully neutralised or recovered on the Indian side," said a top Punjab Police officer.

Officials said that even in cases where detection succeeds, many of the current anti-drone systems fail against autonomous or resilient drone networks that have features that reduce vulnerability to radio frequency disruption. Sometimes, the jamming fails because the drones are far away.

Security officers said that far more jamming units, at least 100, were needed for effective, wider coverage. Sources said the government has planned to expand the system with additional units of anti-drone systems, handheld jammers and vehicle-mounted systems, along with ensuring village committees, CCTVs, and ground

nakas keep an eye on the sky.

"It is a layered, human-supported system involving coordination with BSF, police quick reaction teams and ground recovery. Detection alone does not always equal immediate neutralisation or seizure without rapid ground response," an official said.

Security officials say there are other challenges: small/low-signature drones that often go undetected, the potential of drones acting together and coming in swarms using AI and decentralised communication, as well as remote terrain and harsh weather that make some drop zones inaccessible.

In the cover of darkness

The security analysis found that the drones they captured had an average sortie duration of 45 minutes each, with modified drones having a significantly lower average of around 24 minutes. "For example, one particular DJI Matrice drone had a sortie duration of 42.67 minutes while a DJI Matrice 4 Pro drone had a sortie duration of 15 minutes before it was downed," one of the sources told *The Indian Express*. The altitude at which drones fly also varies, ranging from nearly 500 feet (DJI drones) to 2,500 feet by a modified drone, called octocopter.

The data also showed that the highest number of drops usually take place on Thursdays and Saturdays, and the intercepted drones lie some 3.5-10 km away from the International Border. "The maximum drone activity takes place between 10 pm and 4 am at an average of 12 to 15 drones per hour," said an official.

Pishaura Singh from Gilpan said he has seen drones drop consignments even in the afternoon. "There are villages right on the border, where people are standing in the open, sharing locations, waiting for drops. We have videos of this."

• BRICS SUMMIT

India's BRICS balancing act

For India, the grouping is not a replacement for the West. Yet, over-reliance on the Western economic order comes with pitfalls, from patent controls to sanctions and tariffs

China and the rest: Grouping's ever-widening economic gap



Ravi Dutta Mishra

THE IRAN war and the forthcoming US midterm polls in November may have kept US President Donald Trump occupied. But not too long ago, Trump targeted BRICS — the intergovernmental organisation named after its founding members Brazil, Russia, India, China and South Africa — with tariff threats for its “un-American” policies.

As India gears up to host Chinese President Xi Jinping and Russian President Vladimir Putin, alongside Iran's President Masoud Pezeshkian among others, for the two-day BRICS summit (September 12-13), the West's ties with the key members of the bloc have been deteriorating.

While Iran and Russia have been removed from the Society for Worldwide Interbank Financial Telecommunication (SWIFT) — a secure global messaging network used by financial institutions to transmit information and payment instructions safely — and are entangled in conflict, the US has been locked in a trade war with China for years and is now forcing countries to limit dependency on Chinese products.

New Delhi, too, has been on the receiving end of the weaponisation of the Western financial system when the US imposed steep tariffs last year amid disagreements in trade deal negotiations. India's sovereign decision to purchase Russian oil, albeit during the ongoing Ukraine war, also turned it into a target. However, these are only the most prominent impacts of over-reliance on the Western economic order.

West remains important

India could be looking to balance ties with Western and BRICS countries to chart its development path amid the ongoing rupture in the global economic order. While the share of global GDP held by BRICS nations has grown from 17% to 35% between 1995 and 2024, surpassing the G7, the US and EU continue to be India's largest export market and source of investments. Beyond goods, integration with Western economies has paid rich dividends and aided the growth of India's service sector — where many of the new-age well-paid jobs are created.

Experts say expansion of south-south trade, geographic concentration of critical minerals in the BRICS region and prospects of growth in alternative development finance like the BRICS Bank could aid India's growth. This is no counter-balance to the Western economic order today. But it could help India reduce its reliance a decade on.

Strict patent monopolies

Nevertheless, dependence on the West for now is a vulnerability. The worst impact of Western dominance on international intellectual property (IP) was felt during the Covid-19 pandemic. In October 2020, at the height of the pandemic, India and South Africa sought a waiver of certain provisions of the Trade-Related Aspects of Intellectual Property Rights (TRIPS) Agreement to help developing nations get access to vaccines and other life saving medicines. TRIPS is an international agreement administered by the World Trade Organisation (WTO) that sets minimum standards for protect-

• THE EXPANDING WESTERN SANCTIONS REGIME

Chart 1: Who's imposing sanctions?

● 1990-2022 (total sanctions) ● 2000-2022

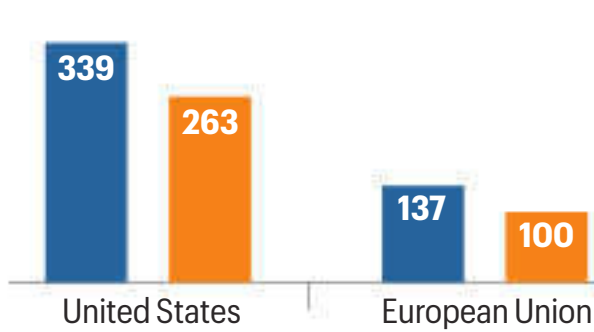


Chart 2: Sanctions on Asia

● Decade-wise fresh sanctions

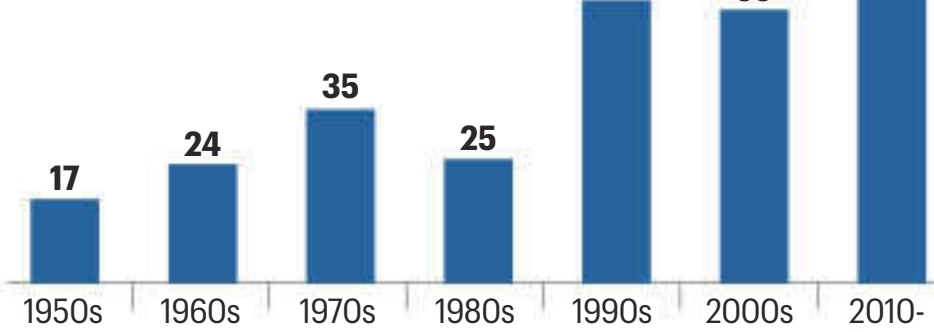


Chart 3: Type of sanctions

Decade	Trade	Financial	Travel	Military aid	Arms
1950s	27	14	8	1	7
1960s	30	29	8	13	29
1970s	47	54	4	23	11
1980s	53	51	21	13	19
1990s	76	147	32	58	69
2000s	71	102	68	71	63
2010-2022	209	327	205	62	67

Source: 'Asphyxiation by Sanctions: Harm, Fear and Smog' working paper written by former RBI governor Urjit R. Patel

1,325

Sanctions imposed globally since 1949

- US-led sanctions jumped in recent decades after the collapse of the Soviet Union
- Spectrum of economic sanctions has ballooned from trade to military
- The second-largest sanctioner after the US is the EU

486

of these sanctions have been by the US



PM Narendra Modi with (from left) Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian, Russian President Vladimir Putin and South African President Cyril Ramaphosa. Union ministers S Jaishankar and Piyush Goyal are also present. ANI

Trade target

India has been on the receiving end of the weaponisation of the Western financial system.

● The US imposed steep tariffs last year amid disagreements in trade talks.

● India's decision to purchase Russian oil during the Ukraine war also turned it into a target.

ing IP. In a shock to the developing world, developed countries turned down the ask.

“The unsuccessful attempt by India, South Africa and sixty other developing countries to secure the Covid TRIPS Waiver released last year, the “hegemonic sanctioner”. Patel said that India should view the emerging international financial architecture around BRICS and the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB) as a “risk mitigant” and a rational response to the ever-expanding sanctions regime.

Sanctions regime

As steep US tariffs laid bare the risks of overdependence on the US market for sanctions, former Reserve Bank of India governor Urjit R Patel called the US, in a working paper released last year, the “hegemonic sanctioner”. Patel said that India should view the emerging international financial architecture around BRICS and the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB) as a “risk mitigant” and a rational response to the ever-expanding sanctions regime.

Patel's paper said that out of 1,325 global sanctions since 1949, 486 have been imposed by the US, which currently administers over 30 sanctions programmes — making it responsible for “three times as many sanctions as any other country or in-

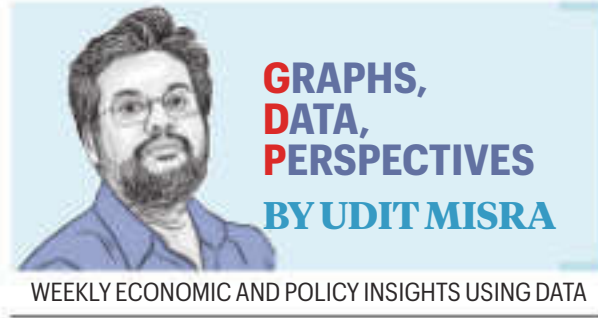
ternational body” (*see box*).

Outlining shifting US policies, Patel said India's plan to develop Chabahar Port had initially started in 2003, but US sanctions targeting Iran imposed a “hard break” on progress. The project was revived between 2015 and 2017 after the US eased sanctions. But shortly after India signed a 10-year agreement with Iran to operate and develop the port in 2024, the US again warned of sanctions.

Western economic policies

While the US has been explicit in imposing tariffs to slash imports from developing nations, the European Union has implemented a range of environment-linked trade regimes which act as a barrier to India's export growth. BRICS nations, in particular, have “condemned and rejected” the European Union's Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism and similar trade curbs, saying they undermine their transition to a cleaner economy.

Indian trade experts have said that trade-climate linkage through regulations such as CBAM is less about protecting the environment and more about promoting the interests of the developed world.



OVER THE weekend, India will host the 18th BRICS Summit in New Delhi. BRICS is an informal grouping of 11 major emerging markets and developing countries: Brazil, China, Egypt, Ethiopia, India, Indonesia, Iran, Russia, Saudi Arabia, South Africa and the United Arab Emirates.

It started out as BRIC — referring to the four countries that initially came together, namely Brazil, Russia, India, and China — on the sidelines of the United Nations General Assembly in New York in 2006. In 2010, South Africa joined the grouping, and it was renamed BRICS.

The idea was to provide a platform for the concerns of emerging economies of the time and counter the overwhelming domination of the industrialised and developed economies (read: the G7) in international institutions.

This is the 20th year since the grouping began, but curiously enough, there is now a dragon in the room: China. Key economic data shows just how much China dwarfs the rest of the BRICS members. Typically, economic might is ascertained by the overall size of the economy as measured by the Gross Domestic Product (GDP) in US dollar terms. Similarly, economic prosperity is measured by GDP per capita, which gives a semblance of how rich an average citizen is in a country.

Overall size of the economy

Even in 2006, China was the largest economy among the five countries after which the grouping is named. Yet, when taken together, China's overall GDP was less than the GDP of the other four members. However, such was the pace of increase in China's economic growth that by the time the inaugural summit meeting happened in 2009, China had overtaken the combined economic size of BRIS (BRICS minus China). Since then, the gap has continued to increase each year. As of 2026, China's GDP alone is more than double that of the other four combined.

Chart 1 shows the country-specific GDP trajectory. Between 2006 and 2015, India did better than the others and overtook them to become the second-biggest economy within BRICS. However, China's rise outstrips all the rest.

Since 2009, China has opened a similarly massive gap even against the G7 countries (barring the US). While the 2008 financial crisis dragged most other developed countries, China grew fast to become the second-largest economy in the world.

Prosperity of average citizen

Even though China was the largest economy within the BRICS in 2006, it was nowhere near the most prosperous. In 2006, an average Russian, Brazilian or South African was anywhere between 3 and 3.5 times richer than an average Chinese. As chart 2 shows, two decades later, an average Chinese is richer than a Brazilian and twice as rich as a South African,

• CHINA'S ECONOMIC HEFT

CHART 1: Its economy is far larger than others in BRICS

● China ● Brazil ● India ● Russia ● South Africa

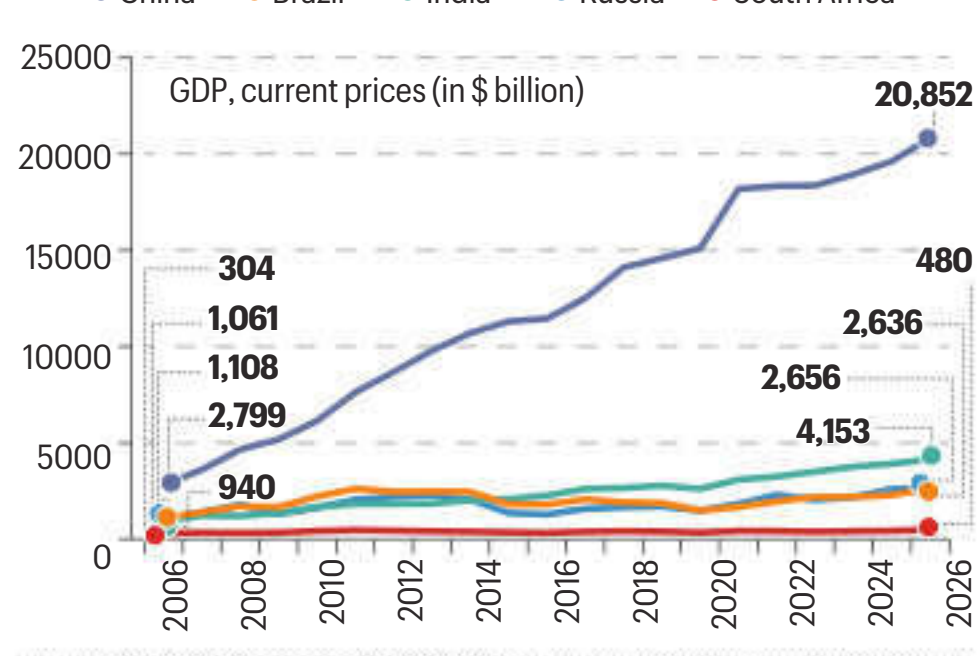
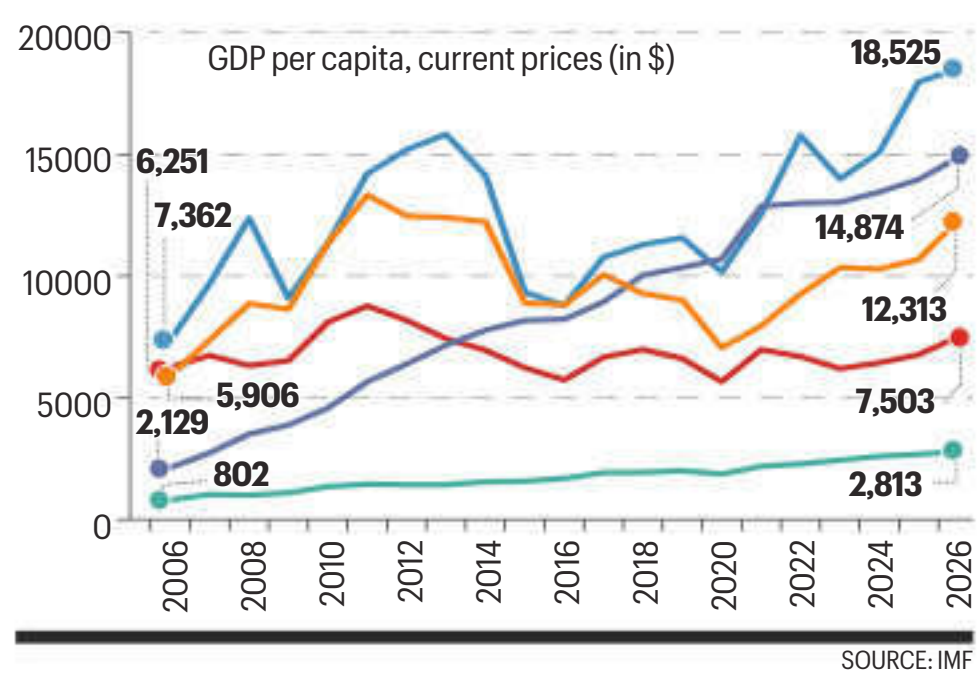


CHART 2: Average prosperity: Second last to second best

● China ● Brazil ● India ● Russia ● South Africa



SOURCE: IMF

The dragon in the room

The central idea behind BRICS in 2006 was to challenge the dominance of the big industrialised economies in how the world was run.

● Today, it is China which is the big industrialised superpower on the planet.

● The key question is: Will such overwhelming economic might not have an imprint on what the grouping decides?



China's GDP is more than double that of the other four combined. NYT FILE

and is closing the gap with an average Russian. As against an average Indian, an average Chinese was about three times richer in 2006 and is five times richer now.

Upshot

The central idea behind BRICS in 2006 was to challenge the dominance of the big industrialised economies in how the world was run. China, however, has grown so fast that today it is the big industrialised superpower on the planet. In the process, it has dwarfed not just all its BRICS siblings but almost all the erstwhile big economies. Indeed, China has grown so fast that the rest of the world is now finding ways to counterbalance China. The key question is: Will such overwhelming economic might not have an imprint on what the grouping decides?

What the recent trajectory of India-China ties means for the summit



Shubhaji Roy

CHINESE PRESIDENT Xi Jinping arrives in India on Saturday for the third time since he assumed the country's presidency — and the first time after a gap of seven years.

The ostensible reason for his visit is participation in the BRICS leaders' summit over the weekend, but the conditions arising from the 2020 border standoff that marked a low point in relations make the trip significant from a bilateral perspective. The fault line in the relationship, alongside a turbulent global scenario, will heavily influence the summit.

China's growing might

With Goldman Sachs analysts calling India, China, Brazil and Russia the “emerging economies” in the world in 2001, “BRIC” as a grouping was born in the immediate aftermath of the 9/11 attacks.

Twenty-five years on, their trajectories have diverged. China has become the second-largest economy after the US; India has grown at a modest rate but been outpaced by Beijing; Russia has faced challenges from wars of its own making; and Brazil has floundered amid frequent regime changes and

scandals. South Africa, a later entrant, has also not lived up to expectations.

Since 2009, when the first BRICS leaders' summit took place in the shadow of the global financial crisis, China has also emerged stronger after weathering the financial crisis better than many Western nations.

Increasing assertions

Apart from its economic rise, China has also grown militarily, with big-power ambitions to dethrone the US. These aspirations are visible in its increasingly aggressive and assertive stance in its neighbourhood, in its actions in the South China Sea, the Indo-Pacific, and the borders it shares with India.

India has faced the brunt of border standoffs frequently, but under Xi, a sense of belligerence from the Chinese state has been greater than at any time in the recent past.

After the 1962 war and the 1967 border clashes in Sikkim, major border standoffs include those in 2013 (Depsang, Ladakh), 2014 (Chumar, Ladakh), Doklam (2017) and since 2020 in eastern Ladakh, which is still ongoing with the deployment of about 50,000 Indian troops along the Line of Actual Control (LAC). The June 2020 clashes led to the killing of 20 Indian defence personnel, including a Colonel-rank officer, and at least four Chinese defence personnel.

Years of diplomatic and military-level talks led to a disengagement of troops in 2024, and incremental steps have since been taken to stabilise the relationship. These include resumption of direct flights,



PM Modi with Chinese President Xi Jinping at the 2024 BRICS Summit. WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

easing visa restrictions, restarting the Kailash Mansarovar Yatra and relaxing restrictions on Chinese investments.

But significant structural differences remain, such as the massive trade deficit, with the lack of market access for Indian businesses often flagged as an issue. India, too, is acting against Chinese firms for tax evasion. Crucially, strategic and political trust has been diminished over the border standoff, now in its seventh year. The collusion between China and Pakistan during Operation Sindoor has further exacerbated the crisis of trust and credibility.

What it means for BRICS

The BRICS summit, with leaders of over 30 countries and groupings in attendance, is being held against this backdrop.

What has complicated the picture is the US government's actions under President Donald Trump in the last one-and-a-half years. His arbitrary tariff moves have cornered countries around the world, including China and India, and the two nations now find themselves on the same side in attempting to counter its effects. After years of high economic growth, China has also revised its expectations for the near future.

Additionally, Trump's war on Iran has raised questions of powerful nations violating others' territorial integrity and sovereignty. But then, both China and Russia are guilty of the same in their respective neighbourhoods. Still, the war in West Asia has imposed an economic cost on all countries. Energy prices and inflation have risen, and BRICS countries, as part of the Global South, are naturally bearing the brunt.

The question now is whether a moment of shared interests and concerns between India and China can become an opportunity to improve ties and bring other developing countries on the same page on common concerns. Xi's visit is being seen as a positive signal, but only to a degree.

BRICS has the potential to offer areas for cooperation, but so far in its approach, Beijing has viewed itself as the “first among equals” in the grouping. It has long supported expanding BRICS membership from the original five, aiding the 2023 expansion that led the grouping to reach its current strength of 11 members.

Then there is the fact that China and

Russia have attempted to frame BRICS as an “anti-West” grouping, while India sees it as a “non-Western” grouping. These divergent perspectives are complicated by US actions against fellow members, such as tariffs on Brazil and political disagreements with South Africa.

India, which has built robust ties with the US over the last 25 years and is wooing Europe, Australia, Canada, and other Western nations for closer partnerships, is decidedly not “anti-West”. It recognises the need to turn to the West for access to capital, technology and as a destination for its people more than China or Russia.

In this geopolitical environment, compared to China's framing of BRICS, India is hosting the summit also to signal to the US that it has other partners in fields ranging from technology to fuel security. The UAE and Saudi Arabia have been investing in the Indian economy, while Russia has stepped in as an energy supplier amid the closure of the Strait of Hormuz, and Brazil is ready to partner on critical minerals.

Again, the war has polarised members of the grouping — Iran is attacking US military bases in West Asia, while the UAE is hosting several military bases and personnel. That is where India needs China's might to move the two partners towards cooperation and demonstrate a more unified flank. Whether they can come to a consensus on such matters, and agree to build on the gains made so far, will affect not just their ties but also BRICS' efficacy as a grouping.

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Centre	हिंदी माध्यम	English Medium
9 Karol Bagh	15 सितंबर सुबह 8:00 बजे	23 Sept 6:00 PM
9 Noida	5 अक्टूबर दोपहर 3:00 बजे	14 Sept 6:00 PM
9 Indore	23 सितंबर सुबह 8:00 बजे	21 Sept 11:00 AM
9 Lucknow	30 सितंबर सुबह 11:30 बजे	24 Sept 8:00 AM
9 Prayagraj	28 सितंबर सुबह 11:15 बजे	30 Sept 11:30 AM
9 Ranchi	22 सितंबर सुबह 8:00 बजे	14 Sept 5:30 PM
9 Patna	25 सितंबर रात 5:30 बजे	5 Oct 2:30 PM
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A House Full of Memories

Shubhra Gupta

BASED ON Aravind Adiga’s 2011 novel *Last Man In Tower*, Ben Rekhi’s film of the same name keeps its focus on the main thrust: shark-like developers swooping in on the crumbling parts of Mumbai, swatting aside low-stakes initial reluctance with the promise of fancy high-rises.

The last man in the way of builder-tycoon Dharmen Shah’s (Boman Irani) rapacious intention is retired teacher Yogesh Murthy (Manoj Bajpayee), who just wants to live out the rest of his life in familiar surroundings, in a flat which houses the memories of his dead wife.

The movie adaptation is written by Sooni Taraporevala, who brings to it an insider knowledge of an old Bombay hand

The residents of Vishram Society embody the remnants of a city that used to be, multi-religious, cutting across class, democratic at its core, increasingly under siege

who has seen it turn into Mumbai. The residents of Vishram Society embody the remnants of a city that used to be, multi-religious, cutting across class, democratic at its core, increasingly under siege: the name of the building is an irony that writes itself, with the 95-minute run-time giving us a snapshot view of friends-and-neighbours turning upon each other.

Even those who haven’t read the book will know how this will end, because projects called Shanghai (remember Dibakar Banerji’s film of the same name, which promised an India turning into shining China?) have no hesitation in steamrolling over those who stand in the way: Bajpayee’s Masterji is a quietly stubborn but dignified presence, who will remind



you of elderly men desperate to cling on to their comfort zone.

Of the pro-and-anti gang, to be found in the Vishram compound arguing with each other, or gossiping over chai, there’s the old couple Mr and Mrs Pinto, as well as single mother Mrs Rego, all of whom ‘side’ with Masterji in the beginning; of the others, Mrs Puri (Divya Dutta), mother to a special child, is amongst the quickest to abdicate.

What’s nice is that the film doesn’t vil-

lainise the residents willing to flip over, or the handful of nay-sayers: we see why Mrs Puri is so keen to be part of the change, as well as the reasons why Masterji, who affectionately watches over Mrs Puri’s son, is so resistant, even if it will give his own son (Sukant Goel) the financial fillip the latter wants.

LAST MAN IN TOWER ★★★

DIRECTOR: Ben Rekhi

CAST: Manoj Bajpayee, Divya Dutta, Sukant Goel, Chandan Roy Sanyal, Harish Khanna, Swaroopa Ghosh, Darshan Jariwala

Bajpayee is the unbending moral centre of the film, a role he gravitates towards with practised ease. This is Divya Dutta’s second stand-out role in 2026,

after *Chiraiya*. Irani seems to have an affinity for rapacious builders, made softer here than his ‘party-*ho-ya*-broker’ in *Khosla Ka Ghosla*, Banerji’s memorable outing about ordinary people and their housing woes.

What I missed, though, is the satirical edge of the novel, and the tone leads to blandness, even as the film leaves us with that thorny question: the cold sterility of a brand new high-rise, or the familiar seediness of the old?

Back to the Badlands

Shubhra Gupta

THE ARENA is Bundelkhand, not Chambal, but Tigmanshu Dhulia knows his terrain. And that familiarity makes *Ghamasaan* stand out from the series of films shot on locations created on sets, their artifice seeping into the storytelling: the best part of this conflict between cops and robbers is the authenticity of the place, and the people.

Maharaj (Arshad Warsi) is Bundelkhand’s Bandit King, as opposed to Phoolan, Chambal’s *Bandit Queen* (in which Dhulia was casting director), as well as *Paan Singh Tomar* (which Dhulia directed, turning it into one of his, and lead Irrfan’s, best collaborations) from the same area who famously gave us that line about *baaghis* and *dakaitis*.

There’s no such nuance in the way Maharaj perceives himself: he is who he is, ruling with an iron hand which doesn’t bother hiding its fist. If you go against him, your head will be lopped off. Urging his loyal lieutenant (Jatin Goswami) to finish off a victim — pouring petrol (or is it diesel) over a body and throwing a burning match at it



— Maharaj listens to the agonies of a dying man with pleasure.

On the trail of Maharaj, based on real-life dacoit Dadua, whose deep connections with senior cops and politicians of the area were no secret, is Special Task Force head Aditya (Pratik Gandhi), sent into the area to launch an intensive comb-and-search operation.

It’s no easy task, as we see through the

GHAMASAAN ★★★

DIRECTOR: Tigmanshu Dhulia

CAST: Arshad Warsi, Pratik Gandhi, Ishita Dutta, Rajpal Yadav

STREAMING ON: Zee5

unhurried two-hour thirty-minute runtime, stopping off at hideous massacres in villages, and zooming in on the faces of those who live in fear of both the lawless and the law, which itself is under pressure from those in power in state capitals, who depend on the fear they can generate when it comes to booth-capturing and vote-*chori*.

Dhulia’s dexterity in intertwining the politics of the land and the brutality of the

landscape is something that kept me watching through the narrative, which sometimes becomes a bit uneven. The matter-of-factness with which the killings take place, and the orders are given from those on the *gaddi*, leaches some of the tension, which can be both good and bad: these men, whichever side of the divide they may be, do what they do because that’s what they do; they don’t need swelling background music to aid them.

A couple of threads are created specifically as distractions. Aditya’s wife (Ishita Dutta) understands the gravity of his job, and is thrust into a situation — a face-off between Maharaj’s men and her — which could have turned ghastly: I was left asking why it didn’t, one of the things that was left dangling.

The other is Arshad Warsi as Maharaj, who didn’t make me believe all the way that he could be a cruel man with zero compassion. That’s rare for an actor who slides into his roles with joyful ease: in some places here, his smile becomes his own — likeable — rather than a bestial grin, as he lounges in his scenic hideout, which reminded me of *Charas*, one of Dhulia’s early films. But Pratik Gandhi’s stoic, steadfast cop, whose duty comes first, more than makes up for Warsi’s occasional slip-ups: Aditya is a real hero, minus the cape and the clapping.

And there’s also Rajpal Yadav, in a striking supporting role, which leaves a mark.

A Sequel that Falls Short

Shalini Langer

WHEN A regular-Joe film is titled just *Fall*, you can be pretty sure it will be about a rise. When it is followed by a *Fall 2*, you can swear by it.

The first *Fall* released to a decent success in 2022, and achieved some bigger highs via social media reels. In that, two best friends climbed up a desolate TV tower to bury their grief, and encounter heartbreak and vultures.

Fall 2 substitutes the tower for a fictional Mount Kwan in Thailand, but can’t resist the grief, betrayal or vultures still, with an over-the-hilltop pending that suggests our survivor is headed for *Fall 3*.

Jax (Harriet Slater) is the sister of Shiloh (Virginia Gardner), the daredevil who died and attained social media notoriety/hero worship with her TV tower adventure. Having parted with very harsh words for Shiloh the last time they met, Jax is wrung out with guilt and pain, and especially angry at the fans stalking her dead sister’s memory.

Luce (Arsema Thomas) lands up at her door, and Jax is more than happy to hand over Shiloh’s things to her, as Shiloh and Luce used to be good friends. And then, two scenes of convincing later, Jax has agreed to Luce’s proposal that they embark on what Shiloh planned to be her next adventure, the trek across Mount Kwan.

That trek is more of a walk across a thin plank that goes around the mountain at a height of 4,000 feet, after a climb up its steep side on some rusted iron bars — that too, in off-season with a chance of rain, earthquakes and landslides.



FALL 2: DEADPOINT ★★★

DIRECTOR: Michael Spierig, Peter Spierig

CAST: Harriet Slater, Arsema Thomas, Tom Brittney, Virginia Gardner

Halfway across this walk is ‘The Devil’s Elbow, a hairpin bend. Up above is a dragon who ‘eats all your fears’.

See why all this should appeal to two Americans who have presumably no one to answer to or talk them out of this idiocy? If you don’t — like most folks — this film is not for you.

But stick around, and *Fall 2* does its job of inducing altitude terrors pretty efficiently. The writers of *Fall* are also associated with its

sequel, and they do take their job seriously, from the ropes to the hooks, to the bolts, to the planks, to the mini oxygen cylinders and laser beams that can stretch all the way down from the cliff, onto a pool table inside a bar. The detailing is impressive, and both Slater and Thomas are committed to both falling down and getting up — and repeat.

Tom Brittney as their shifty guide John is good too. An American at a desolate Thai bar agreeing to take one on an illegal hike for the royal price of \$5,000 is usually up to no good, but John does have his charm.

As long as *Fall 2* is sticking to the cliff, it does its job well. But then comes one incredulous plot addition after another, and down the hill we go.

More Chaos than Chemistry

Shubhra Gupta

HAIWAAN VS Insaan, monster vs human, that age-old conflict in the movies, gets a refresh in *Haiwaan*, with Priyadarshan repping his own 2016 Malayalam hit *Oppam*. Here Saif Ali Khan plays the sightless Shyam, up against Akshay Kumar’s murderous Parshuram, in a film which stays largely faithful to the original.

In Priyan’s world protagonists and antagonists are always arrayed in black and white, with lashes of heavy-handed humour thrown in. The mix works in some of his movies, mostly his loud comedies in which the cast is tasked with delivering dialogues when not hanging off cliffs: *Haiwaan* is the usual mix of genres in Priyadarshan’s films, in which tonal switches abound, the first half setting up the premise of an innocent man being imprisoned for a crime he didn’t do, and the second turning into an unintentional comic police procedural.

How many cops does it take to overcome a blind man? Four burly men launch themselves at a man who’s been strung up and beaten mercilessly, and yet the latter is able to deal with them in a closed room, leaving them in a bloody heap. Yes, it’s a Bollywood movie, and yes, we know how to suspend disbelief, but seriously?

This was meant to be a much-awaited reunion of our Khiladi boys, Akshay and Saif, who’ve long been partners on film sets. Saif has the more expansive role — his Shyam can play all kinds of musical instruments, from the guitar to the violin to the piano, he can tap about with his cane, playing quasi-daddy to a little girl; and he can



HAIWAAN ★★★

DIRECTOR: Priyadarshan

CAST: Akshay Kumar, Saif Ali Khan, Boman Irani, Shriya Pilgaonkar, Saiyami Kher, Rajpal Yadav, Sharib Hashmi, Rajesh Sharma, Manoj Joshi

beat baddies into a pulp — with Akshay showing up to skulk and slit throats, but neither is believable.

The first half gives Boman Irani’s conscience-stricken judge a chance to anchor the proceedings, and he does that well enough, letting Shyam in on a secret which has been weighing him down. As the supervisor of the building the judge lives in, Shyam knows each nook and corner; his sense of smell outweighing his inability to

see, leading him to be an unlikely witness in a murder.

Subplots involve a domestic help (Shriya Pilgaonkar) saddled with an abusive husband and a brother in hiding. Said help suddenly comes on all heavy with Shyam, giving us a taste of this harum-scarum script where anything goes — from a too-handy-with-his-fists policeman (Sharib Hashmi), an ever-present autorickshaw driver (Rajpal Yadav), a smart cop (Saiyami Kher) whose sleuthing instincts find little play, and a grim-faced nun (Suchitra Pillai) presiding over a boarding school.

When Priyadarshan is on top of his game, all his madly disparate moving parts somehow come together and give us a rumbustious climax. Sadly, *Haiwaan* is more miss than hit, more *uff uff* than *ole ole*.

•STREAMING WATCHLIST



Chumbak

NETFLIX

CHUMBAK IS written and directed by Aatish Kapadia and produced by Jamnadas (JD) Majethia and Aatish Kapadia, the creators of *Sarabhai vs Sarabhai* and *Khichdi*. Set in an urban

Indian neighbourhood, the series follows five families whose lives are so intertwined that a small problem in one home can quickly become a fullblown colony matter. The cast features Neena Gupta, Devan Bhojani, Amyra Dastur, Anant V Joshi, Sumeet Vyas and Manasi Parekh, among others.



The Revolutionaries

PRIME VIDEO

INSPIRED BY true events and based on Sanjeev Sanyal’s bestseller *Revolutionaries: The Other Story of How India Won Its Freedom*, the period drama follows four young revolutionaries during India’s freedom struggle. Created and directed by Nikkhil Advani, the series explores their fight against British rule, as well as the personal relationships and sacrifices that shaped their journey. The series stars Bhuvan Bam, Rohit Saraf, Pratibha Ranta and Gurfateh Pirzada in lead roles. It releases on September 11.



A Love Other Than Yours S1

PRIME VIDEO

THE KOREAN romance follows Namgung Ho and Lee Mi-do, a couple whose decade-long relationship has settled into comfortable familiarity. While sociable Ho sees marriage as the natural next step, Mi-do, a filmmaker struggling with her career, finds herself drawn to another man. As their relationship begins to unravel, the couple must confront whether to take the next step or choose a love beyond each other. Releases on September 12.

Drawn Together

PRIME VIDEO

ADAPTED FROM Mercedes Ron’s En-frentados duology, this follows Marfil Cortés, daughter of a wealthy Spanish businessman, whose life in New York is upended when she is kidnapped and then released. Her father assigns the enigmatic Sebastian Moore as her bodyguard, and despite their differences, the two are drawn to each other. When they return to Spain, new threats emerge, and Marfil and Sebastian must confront a dangerous world where nothing is as it seems. The Spanish romantic thriller is directed by Óscar Pedraza.

ALAKA SAHANI



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GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA

TENDER NOTICE

Sr. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / BMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	MUNICIPAL COUNCIL, TOHANA	CONSTRUCTION OF STREET GALLI NO.11 IN PASTER COLONY WARD NO. 17 MC TOHANA + 38 WORKS	07.09.2026 15.09.2026	4,72,40,323/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	933314172 mctohana@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in

No. 49161/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA

TENDER NOTICE

Sr. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / BMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	THE PRAKAT CO-OP, SUGAR MILLS LTD., PRAKAT	SALE OF SLUDGE WITH MOLASSES AND IMPURITIES INCLUDING CLEANING OF MOLASSES STORAGE TANK + 33 OTHERS	09.09.2026 22.09.2026	322 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9426281313 pratikpugam@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in

No. 49159/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA, MINISTRY OF RAILWAY RESEARCH DESIGNS & STANDARDS ORGANISATION

Manak Nagar, Lucknow-226011

WAGON DIRECTORATE

Open E-Tender Notice

Dated 08.09.2026

On behalf of President of India WAGON DIRECTORATE, RDSO Lucknow invites “Open E-Tender” online for the following work in prescribed format.

Description of work and place	E-Tender No.	Advertised cost of work (Rs.)	Bid security (Rs.)	Cost of tender document (Rs.)	Completion Period	Date and time of tender closing
SMART WAGON - Bearing & Wheel Health Monitoring Module (Order no. 1)	RDSO_MW_SMART WAGON_4RT Dated:08.09.2026	7,85,02,777.44	15,70,100/-	00.00	78 months	12.10.2026 17.00 hrs.

Online Tender can be submitted upto 17.00 hrs on 12.10.2026.

For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website “www.ireps.gov.in”.

Sd/-

(Alok Kumar Maurya)

Jt.Director/Wagon

For executive Director Sdks. Wagon

RDSO/Lucknow

Ro. No. 27/2026-27/Wagon

BANGALORE ELECTRICITY SUPPLY COMPANY LIMITED

(Wholly owned by Government of Karnataka undertaking)

(CIN-U04010KA2002SGC030438)

EXPRESSION OF INTEREST

BESCOM is inviting Expression of Interest (EOI) from Banks/ Financial Institutions for Sanctioning Rs.500.00 Crores Long term Capex loans for reimbursement of Capex paid out of own funds.

1. INTRODUCTION AND BACKGROUND:
BESCOM is responsible for the distribution of Electricity within the State of Karnataka currently serves around One Crore Consumers throughout Eight Districts (Bangalore Urban, Bangalore Rural, Chikkaballapura, Kolar, Davanagere, Tumkur, Chitradurga and Ramanagara). BESCOM has 9 (Nine) circles, 32 (Thirty-Two) divisions and 147 (One Hundred and Forty-Seven) sub-divisions and 534 section offices.

2. Brief Summary:
BESCOM has undertaken the following Capex works in FY -2025-26 amounting to Rs.552.93 Crores, the details are as given below:

Sl. No.	Particular of the works under Major/ Minor heads.	Provisional Expenditure incurred for FY26.
1	Service connection works	63.09
2	Water Works	2.98
3	11 KV Evacuation line	275.79
4	Providing Additional DTC's /Enhancement of DTCs	113.52
5	Local planning, Safety works, Emergency / Calamity Works	97.55
6	UNIP	3.07
Total		556.00

3. Conditions to participate in the EOI:
The following are the terms and conditions to be followed by Banks and Financial institutions for participation in bidding process:

Sl. No.	Particulars
1	Facility
2	Project Amount
3	Loan amount (90% of Project Cost)
4	Rate of interest
5	Tenure of the loan
6	Repayment of Principal amount
7	Processing Fees
8	Security
9	Pre- Closure charges and Bank/ FI's offered concessional of charges
10	Stamp Duty / Documentation Charges, Any other charges
11	Sanction and Disbursement Timeline

The Interested bidders shall submit their proposals within **19.09.2026, 5:00 PM** in a sealed cover to the office of the Director (Finance), 2nd Floor, Belaku Bhavana, Corporate Office, BESCOM, K.R. Circle, Bangalore. The bids shall be opened on **21.09.2026**. BESCOM reserves the right to reject any or all of the bids without assigning any reasons thereof. BESCOM may terminate the EOI process at any time without assigning any reasons and upon such termination BESCOM shall not be responsible for any direct loss and damage arising out of such a termination.

For further information, contact

General Manager, Finance and Resources -Mobile No- 9449844649

Deputy General Manager, CMS-Mobile No-9449839256

Sd/-

General Manager (F&R)

BESCOM

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER

RURAL WORKS CIRCLE, BARIPADA

E-Mail ID: serwebaripada@gmail.com

Pb-No-06792-261343/261344, Gangraj, Baripada

Office Order No. 4696 Dt. 10.09.2026

1st Corrigendum to National Competitive Bidding e-procurement Notice No.4384/Building works Dt.21.08.2026 (NCB No-429).

Due to unavoidable circumstances the important dates of tendering process for building works are being changed as follows.

Sl No	Item	Time Schedule as per Original NCB	Time Schedule as per Corrigendum Notice
1	Availability of tender On-line for bidding	07.09.2026 at 11.00 A.M to 22.09.2026 up to 05.00 P.M	23.09.2026 at 11.00 A.M to 07.10.2026 up to 05.00 P.M
2	Date & Time of Seeking Tender Clarification if any	21.09.2026 up to 01.00 P.M	06.10.2026 up to 05.00 P.M
3	Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bid	23.09.2026 at 11.00 A.M	08.10.2026 at 11.00 A.M
4	Date & Time of Opening of Financial Bid	Will be intimated later	Will be intimated later

All other terms and conditions remain unchanged.

Sd/ Er. A.K Naik

Chief Construction Engineer

R.W. CIRCLE, BARIPADA

OIPR-25001/25181/1/26-27/0015

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER

PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT,

CIRCLE NO-1 RAIPUR (C.G.)

Tender Notice

(1st Call)

Contractors, Registered appropriate class in Unified Registration System [e- Registration] invited Online tenders for the following works :-

NIT No./ System Tender No.	Name of Work	Probable amount of contract
1	2	3
194/198793	POT Holes Work To Various Roads Under Sub Division No.1, Raipur. (C.G.) 1. Mana Tuta Road 2. Rajiv Smiriti Van Aproch Road 3. Rajendra Nagar Intranal Road 4. Puren Intranal Road 5. Telibhandha Gali NO 7 6. Mana Bansri Road 7. Mana Dharampura Road.	Rs. 42.34 Lakh
195/198794	B.T. Patch Repair And Wmm Patch Repair Work In Various Roads Under Head Quarter Section, Tilda-Neora (1) Kodwa-jangirja-Nakati-Khapari-Bartori-Rajiya-Chhapora-Manpur-Tulsi-arphonga-Alda-Bhatbhera Road 14.00 Km (2) Tarashiv-Chhataud Approach 1.40 Km (3) Kirna-Kundaru Road Km 3.10 Km (4) Road Pachari-Pathrakundi Road 2.50 Km (5) Raikheda-Bhatapara Road 3.00 Km.	Rs. 26.00 Lakh
196/198795	B.T. Patch Repair For Various City Roads Under Sub Division No. 02, Raipur 1) Bhanpuri Approach Road 2) Urkura Main BT Road 3) Bhanpuri To Church Gate 4) Urkura Main Road To Shanidev Temple 5) Daldalseoni Shivajinagar Road & Others Road	Rs. 26.48 Lakh
197/198796	B.T. Patch Repair Work of M.D.R. & Village Road of Arang Section No.-02 Section Under Sub Division No.-4 (Arang) Raipur (1) Samoda Tulsi Sakri Chorbhatti Road (2) Tulsi Rasota Amodi Road (3) Bhaisa Bhandar Telasi Sirpur Road (4) Kodapar Pirda Korasi Road (5) Gullu Samoda Chikhali Road (6) Semariya Parsada Kusumund Road (7) Amsena Kutela (8) Sakri Paraswani (9) Gullu Akoli (10) Bana Guma Paraskol	Rs. 100.00 Lakh
198/198797	B.T. Patch Repair Work of Roads Under Construction Sub Division No.-2 Raipur 1. Professor Colony 2. Mahamaya Ward 3. Changorabhata Ward 4. Raipur Pallari Baloda Bazaar Road 5. Tikrapara Sejbahar Road	Rs. 19.99 Lakh
199/198798	B.T. Patch Repair Work of M.D.R. & Village Road of Kharora Section Under Sub Division No.-4 (Arang), Raipur (C.G.) (1) Kosrangi Chakwe Chorbhatti (2) Kosrangi Farhada Khauli (3) Kosrangi Farhada Khauli (4) Kanki Deortilda Pandaparaswani (5) Kumbhari Jara Alesur (6) Sirri Madadih Road (7) Bhainsa Karma (8) Bhainsa Bhejridih (9) Khorsi Aceholi Road (10) Math Amethi Road	Rs. 89.98 Lakh
200/198929	B.T. Patch Repair Work on Abhanpur -Kolar- Tekari- Khilora Road (MDR), Kendri-Singarbhatha-Chhachhanpary road (MDR) Nawagaon-chhanta-Kathiya road (MDR), Parsulidih-Lamkeni-Dhodra road (MDR), Patewa-Dongitarai-Chipridih-Piproud-Sundarkera road (MDR), Manikchouri-Tokro-Kodapar road (MDR), Bus stand to Ganj Mandi road (ODR), Abhanpur Biroda road (VR), Satpara Approach road (VR), Chhote Urla Approach road (VR), Khilora-Chhachhanpary road (VR), Sonesilli -chhanta road (VR), Lakhana-champaran road (VR), Nawagaon-joundi Road (VR), Urla -Pacheda road (VR), Jhaanki-Baktara- Biroda road (VR), Bendri-Approach road (VR), Jawaibandha-Khola road (VR), Jawaibandha approach road (VR), Jangaon- Khola road (VR), Khilora -Saloni. Road (VR), Tarri- Patewa road (VR), Sonthi-Ghont road (VR), Nawagaon-Parsada Road (VR), Chandi-Belar-Sarbada road (VR), Mohandi-Khursenga road (VR), Khola Thelkabandha-Dadarjhor Road (VR), Chhachhanpary-Julum-Mundara Road (VR), Aamdi-Raweli road (VR old), Under Abhanpur Sub Division for the Year 2026-27	Rs. 89.84 Lakh
201/198930	B.T. Patch Repair Work on Torla-Bhotidih-Tila Champaran Road, Gaurbhath-Bhalera-Tamasivani-Ganaud-Tandul Road Charoda-Khapri-Tamasivani, Bhurka-Pond Road, Birbira-Ugetara-Ghorbhathi Road Torla-Bhurka-Kumbhari Road, Jhaki-Mudpar-Pacheda Road, Kathiya-Tarra-Nawagaon-Ugetara Roadbothidih-Champaran Road and Other Various Roads Under Sub Division No. 3 For The Year 2026-27	Rs. 127.00 Lakh

Last date of tender Download Date up to 28.09.2026 Time 17:30 PM

Note:- All eligible/interested contractors are mandated to get enrolled on the e Procurement portal (<https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in>) in order to download the tender documents and participate in the subsequent bidding process.

Sd/-

Superintending Engineer

Ro. No. 262703228/4

P.W.D. Raipur Circle No-1, Raipur (C.G.)

JHARKHAND STATE SPORTS PROMOTION SOCIETY

(A CCL- State Govt. of Jharkhand Joint Initiative)

C/o Mega Sports Complex, Khelgaon, Hotwar, Ranchi- 835217

Registration under Society Act No.519 Registration under GST No. 20AACAJ6436C1Z9 OUR MISSION- OLYMPIC GOLD

No:- CEO/LMC/JSSPS/K/Civil/2026-27/488 Date : 04.09.2026

निविदा सूचना

Notice Inviting Tender NIT 02 of 2026-27(Housekeeping Works)

1. Tenders are invited on-line under two-part system (Cover I & Cover II) on the website <https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in> from the eligible bidders for the following work:

Description of work	Location	Estimated Cost of Work (Including GST) (In Rs.)	Earnest Money (In Rs.)	Period of Completion (In Days)
AMC for housekeeping works at Mega Sports Complex Khelgaon, Hotwar, Ranchi for two years under JSSPS.	Mega Sports Complex, JSSPS, Khelgaon, Ranchi	8,54,64,130.41	10,68,500.00	730 days

The bid documents will be available on the website(s) <https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in> and www.jharkhandcslsports.in and can be downloaded by the bidder up to the bid download end date. There is no Application Fee.

All documents relating to the Bid shall be in the Hindi/English language. Documents in other language should be accompanied with its notarized Hindi/English translation.

2. For Site visit of location of work, the prospective bidder(s) may contact Sri Vikash Kumar, Sr. Overseer (Civil), JSSPS, Mobile No.:-7004838366

Tender inviting authority	Contact Person(s)/Tender Dealing Officer(s)
CEO,LMC, JSSPS Mob No. 7355532087	Kunal Anand, Member (Civil), JSSPS Mob No. 8092466706

3. Time Schedule of Tender:

Sl. No	Particulars	Date	Time
a.	Tender e-Publication date	15.09.2026	15.00 Hours
b.	Document download start date	15.09.2026	15.00 Hours
c.	Document download end date	01.10.2026	17.00 Hours
d.	Bid Submission start date	16.09.2026	10.00 Hours
e.	Bid submission end date	01.10.2026	17.00 Hours
f.	Start date for seeking Clarification on-line	15.09.2026	15.00 Hours
g.	Last date for seeking Clarification on-line	21.09.2026	17.00 Hours
h.	Date of Pre-bid meeting (if any)	NA	NA
i.	Technical Bid (Cover I) opening date	03.10.2026	11.00 Hours
j.	Price Bid (Cover II) Opening date	To be notified later	-----

Sd/-

CEO,LMC, JSSPS

PR 389528 (Art Culture Sports and Youth Affairs)26-27*D

SALUTE THE SOLDIER

GORKHA RIFLES

NK Padam Bahadur Rai

Indian Army and 11 Gorkha Rifles Salutes its brave heart, No 9403227 Late NK Padam Bahadur Rai of 2/11 GR, who made supreme sacrifice during Mizo Hills on 12 Sep 1967.

L/NK Jaman Singh Rai

Indian Army and 11 Gorkha Rifles Salutes its brave heart, No 9406679 Late L/NK Jaman Singh Rai of 2/11 GR, who made supreme sacrifice during Mizo Hills on 12 Sep 1967.

Colonel 11 GR & Sikkim Scouts and All Ranks

BORDER SECURITY FORCE

CONSTABLE GIAN CHAND 102 BN BSF 23.05.1965 – 12.09.2000

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Gian Chand on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injuries while fighting with armed miscreants on international border in area of Baishnabnagar, Malda (West Bengal) and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.

ASI MIHIR KUMAR MAJUMDAR 152 BN BSF 31.03.1968 – 12.09.2013

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Subordinate officer Assitant Sub Inspector Mihir Kumar Majumdar on his Balidan Diwas. On 26 th June 2013, he sustained fatal injuries while on operational duty in area of BOP Kajjuri, West Bengal and later succumbed to his injuries at Desun hospital, Kolkata on 12 th Sep 2013.

INSPECTOR RISHIKESH 137 BN BSF 11.02.1944 – 12.09.1996

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Subordinate officer Assitant Sub Inspector Rishikesh and Head Constable Hari Singh on their Balidan Diwas. On this day, they sustained fatal injuries in an IED blast, triggered by militants in Pulwama area, J&K and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.

HEAD CONSTABLE HARI SINGH 137 BN BSF 01.10.1954 – 12.09.1996

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Subordinate officer Assitant Sub Inspector Hari Singh on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, they sustained fatal injuries in an IED blast, triggered by militants in Pulwama area, J&K and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.

CENTRAL RESERVE POLICE FORCE

Veer Balidani Constable Vinod Kumar Ram 7 Bn 16-8-1967 To 12-9-1991

IG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Vinod Kumar Ram of 7 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely countering an ambush by terrorists in Punjab on 12 September 1991. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

INDO-TIBETAN BORDER POLICE (ITBP)

Sub- Inspector Jamir Ahmed

ITBP salutes its braveheart Sub-Inspector Jamir Ahmed of 20th Battalion, who laid down his life in the line of duty on this day in Arunachal Pradesh in 2020.

DISTRICT POLICE

HEADQUARTERS SAMBA

LOOK OUT NOTICE

As intimated by DySP Hqrs Samba vide letter No. DySP Hqrs/2026/8487 dated 08.09.2026, that one lady namely Santosh Kumari W/o Sudagar Mal R/o Rajpura Tehsil Rajpura District samba has been missing from home and her missing report has been entered vide DDR No. 17 dated 03.04.2025 of P/S Ghagwal. Her search was conducted but not traced out till date. Through the medium of this LOOK OUT NOTICE, it is informed to all the Police Establishments/General Public that any information related to the missing lady may be communicated on following contacts:-

1. PCR Samba :-01923-246333, 9541649001

2. SSP Samba's email ID :- sspsamba@jkpolice.gov.in

3. SHO PS Ghagwal:- 8825067622

The description roll along with photograph of missing lady is as under:-

Name:	Santosh Kumari
W/O:	Sudagar Mal
Permanent Address:	Rajpura Tehsil Rajpura District Samba
Age:	36 Years
Height:	5 Feet 1 inch
Complexion:	Whitish
Face:	Normal
Body Structure:	Strong
Languages known:	Hindi
Attire:	Salwar Kurta

No. CB/Look/2026/

Sd/-

Dated:- .09.2026

Sr. Superintendent of Police,

DIP/J-10218/26 - DATE 11 SEP 2026

Samba

-EMPANELMENT NOTICE-

GOVERNMENT POLYTECHNIC

DHAMLAWAS (REWARI)

(NH-11, Vill. Dhamlawas, PO- Pithrawas, Distt. Rewari - 123101)

Website: www.gpdhamlawas.edu.in / Email: gp-dhamlawas@techeduhry.gov.in

ADVERTISEMNT FOR EMPANELMENT OF VISITING FACULTY (ON HOURLY BASIS)

Applications are invited from eligible candidates for engagement as Visiting Faculty purely on an hourly basis for the Academic Session 2026-27 (for teaching duration only) in the following departments:

Sr. No.	Department/Branch	Requirement
1.	Applied Science (English)	01 (Re-advertised)
2.	Computer Engg.	02
3.	Electronics and Communication Engg.	01
4.	Medical Lab Technology	02 (Re-advertised)

Application proforma can be obtained from the Institute or downloaded from institute website www.gpdhamlawas.edu.in or through the google link https://drive.google.com/file/d/16rGhn1VX82-RLL_jSK1qhWCzqit3ultO/view?usp=sharing

Last Date for submission of Application 22.09.2026 upto 04:00 PM

Form in person or by post

Date and Time of Interview 25.09.2026 (10:00AM)

Eligibility: The academic qualification or experience if any for aspirants shall be as per Haryana Technical Education Department Norms.

Remuneration/Honorarium: Honorarium @ 600/- per hour for theory class and 300/- per hour for practical class, maximum upto 40,890/- p.m. for visiting faculty or as per Visiting Faculty norms issued by State Government from time to time.

How to Apply: Interested candidates should submit their duly filled application form in the prescribed format along with self-attested copies of educational certificates, experience certificates, and other relevant documents to the office of the Principal in person or by post on or before 22.09.2026.

General Instructions: Engagement of visiting faculty shall be treated strictly as a stop-gap arrangement on need basis till the joining of regular faculty through direct recruitment, transfer or deputation whichever is earlier without any vested legal right for continuation/absorption. Any person shall be engaged only as visiting faculty strictly on the basis of workload availability and on hourly basis and shall not confer any right or claim for regularization. The engaged visiting faculty may be removed any time on the basis of poor performance or bad work & conduct. The Institute reserves the right to increase or decrease the number of vacancies or cancel the recruitment process without assigning any reason. Only eligible candidates will be considered for engagement. No TA/DA will be paid for attending the interview.

Note: If any amendment/corrigendum is issued, subsequently, the same will not be published in any newspaper, rather it will be uploaded on institute official www.gpdhamlawas.edu.in.

Date: 11.09.2026

Place: Dhamlawas (Rewari)

(Sd/-)

Principal

Govt. Polytechnic

Dhamlawas (Rewari)

No. 49203/HR

epaper.indianexpress.com

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I,Imran Mamon,R/o-2253,3rd Floor,Shankar Gali Bazar, SitaRam Delhi,have changed my minor daughter's name,from Sania I. Mamon to Sania Imran Mamon,for all purposes

0040878081-3

I, Shiv Charan Kant Panwar S/o Jyoti Prasad R/o C-121, Radha Garden, Mawana, Meerut, UP- 250001, have changed my name to SHIV CHARAN for all future purposes.

0071060233-1

IKAWAL S/O SHISHRAM R/O C-128 Gali-36 Mahavir Enclave Part-3 West Delhi -110059 have changed my name to KAWAL ANISH BHIMDAA and shall henceforth be known as KAWAL ANISH BHIMDAA. 0050297546-1

I,KEMIKA M RATHORE ALIAS KEMIKA BHATI,D/O-MOOLSINGH RATHORE,W/O SAMEER BHATI R/o,H3/107, Third-Floor, H-Block, Vikas-Puri,West-Delhi, Delhi-110018,have changed my name to KEMIKA BHATI

0040878085-1

It is for general information that I, Tushar Verma, S/O Sadanand, M-39, Sector-12, Noida, Uttar Pradesh-201301, declare that my mother's name has been incorrectly written as Vidhya in my Class-10th and Class-12th educational documents. The actual name of my mother is Vidya, and her full name is Vidya Devi, which may be amended accordingly.

0071060261-1

I, Shivaraj Namdeo Bhor, S/O Namdeo Gangaram Bhor, R/O Block H, Flat No. H-1104, 11th Floor, Antriksh Forest, Sector-77, Noida, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh, 201301 have changed my Son's name from Aमेya Bhor to Aमेya Shivaraj Bhor for all future purpose.

0130069212-1

I,HARSHA DUDHERIA,W/O-AMAN RAJUADA,R/O-C-32/F.F.C-Block, Mahendur Enclave, Azadpur,Delhi-110033,have changed my name to HARSHA D RAJUADA.

0040878080-5

INIVEDITA,W/O,ASHOK KUMAR, R/O,D-1704,Exotica Fresco, Sector-137, Noida, Gautam Budh Nagar UTTAR PRADESH-201305, I have changed my name to NIVEDITA KUMAR

0040878082-1

I, Akhilesh Kumar Dubey, S/o Deenanath Dubey, R/o House No. 19, Shubh City 1, Krishna City 1, Bistrakh, Greater Noida, G.B Nagar, U.P have changed my name from Akhilesh Kumar Dubey to Akhilesh Dubey. Henceforth I would be known by the name of Akhilesh Dubey for all future purposes.

0071060237-1

I, Satinder Singh, S/o Jaswant Singh, R/o B-215, 3rd Floor, Lajpat Nagar-1, New Delhi-110024, have changed my name from Satinder Singh to Satinder Singh Dhir for all future purposes.

0071060313-1

I,Manish Modi,S/O-Kuber Dutt Modi,R/O-H.No.157,Second Floor,Gagan Vihar Main,Delhi-110051, Have Changed The Name Of My Minor Son Nischay Modi Aged 2 Years. And He Shall Hereafter Be Known As Nimish Modi.

0040878079-9

I,Sudhir Kumar Jain S/o Sh. Sadhu Ram Jain R/o J15/2, Gali No. 1, Jai Prakash Nagar, Ghonda, Garhi Mendu, North East Delhi, Delhi-110053 have changed my name to Sudhir Jain for all purposes.

0040877968-1

I, Parkash Virmani S/o Ganga Ram Virmani R/o WZ-83 SECOND FLOOR PLOT NO-67 & 67-A MEENAKSHI GARDEN NEW DELHI 110018 have changed my name to Prakash Virmani for all future purposes.

0071060263-1

I,SAMINA BEGUM,W/O-Iqbal Khan,R/O-A-14, Om Vihar,Phase-5,Uttam Nagar, Delhi-110059, have changed my name to SHAMINA in future for all purposes.

0040878079-2

I,Amit,S/O-Ronak Lal Mehta, R/O-F-6/4,Block F-6,Plot No.4, Krishna Nagar,Delhi 110051, Have Changed Ny Name To Amit Mehta For All Purposes.

0040878079-7

I,Ravindra Sharan Saxena,S/o- Raghavendra Sharan Saxena, R/o-Tower-14,Flat no- 905,Nirala-Estate, Greater Noida-West,UP, have changed my name from RAVINDRA SAXENA to RAVINDRA SHARAN SAXENA, for all future purposes.

0040878080-7

I, Pragati Malik D/o Sh. Naresh Kumar Malik R/o V-12/23, DLF Phase-3, Nathpur, Distt. Gurugram, Haryana- 122002, have changed my name from Pragati Malik Sanan to Pragati Malik, for all purposes in future.

0040877979-1

I Sanika Samartha Patil D/o Devidas Vernekar and W/o Samartha Patil R/o Plot No-1882, Sector No-09, Near Post Office Board, Anjaneya Nagar, M.M Extension, VTC-Belgaum Shivaji Nagar, PO-Belgaum Shivaji Nagar, District-Belagavi, Karnataka -590016, have changed my name to Pooja Devidas Vernekar

0071060340-1

I,PRAGYA SATHYAMURTHY D/O SOUNДАРARAJAN SATHYAMURTHY, R/O FLAT NO.89,VASUNDHARA APARTMENT,SECTOR-9,ROHINI DELHI-110085,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO PRAGYA

0040878079-5

I,NAZMIN PARVIN,W/O-MD MUZIBUL R/O-R/O-H.No.257, PKT-7, Sec-A-10, Purnavars Colony,Narela, Delhi-110040, have changed my name to NAZNI PARVEEN,for all purposes

0040878084-3

I,Balvinder Singh,S/o-Davinder Pal Singh,R/o 126 Hakikat Nagar, GTB Nagar, Delhi-110009 have changed my name to Balvinder Singh Tandon.

0040878080-9

I Mohammad Attaul Rehman S/o Muneer Sah R/o T-383-E/1, Third Floor, Amir Khusró Nagar Basti, Hazrat Nizamuddin, South Delhi, Delhi -110013, have changed my name to Ataul Shah

0071060278-1

I,TRISHA SATHYAMURTHY D/O SOUNДАРARAJAN SATHYAMURTHY, R/O FLAT NO.89,VASUNDHARA APARTMENT, SECTOR-9, ROHINI DELHI-110085,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO TRISHA

0040878079-4

I Sanjeev Kumar S/o Banwari Lal R/o O-88, Krishan Vihar, Delhi-110086 have changed my name From Sanjeev Sharma To Sanjeev Kumar for all purposes.

0040878084-2

I,KIRAN,W/O-Sunil Kumar Mann,R/O-House No.473 Prahlad Pur,Bangur,North West Delhi-110042, have changed my name to KIRAN MANN.

0040878083-2

I, KM POOJA RANI D/o Vikram Singh, R/o Flat No. B-1702, Saya Zenith, Plot No. GH-11, Ahinsa Khand-11, Indirapuram, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201014 have changed my name from KM POOJA RANI to POOJA. Henceforth I would be known by the name of POOJA for all future purposes.

0040877980-1

I,Karuturi Veera Venkata Satya Subrahmanya Seeta Ramakrishna Vara Prasad S/o Satyanarayana Karuturi R/O Flat No.-1302, Block-B, Lansum Eldorado Apartment, Narsingi, Beside Dmart, Narsingi, Narsingi, Po- Narsingi, Dist-K.V.Rangareddy, Telangana -500089, have changed my name to VSSSSRRKV PRASAD KARUTURI

0071060345-1

I,Irshad S/o-Jakriya R/O Village-Ghigraka,Post Office-Hurithal,Palwal (Haryana), have changed my name to Mohd. irshad for All Purposes.

0040878080-2

I,Mohd Asif Khan (Asif Khan),S/o-Mohd Yameen Khan,R/o-H.No-145-2,Street No-7,Jafraabad Seelampur Delhi-53,that my correct name is Mohd Asif Khan,for all purpose

0040878081-2

I, Ajab Chauhan S/o Champat Singh, R/O G.N-7/93, Gali No.-7, Mamura, Sector-66, Noida, Gautam Buddha Nagar, have changed my name from Ajab Chauhan to Ajab Singh Chauhan. Henceforth I would be known by the name of Ajab Singh Chauhan for all future purposes.

0071060231-1

IDHAWAN S/o SHISHRAM R/O C-128 Gali- 36 Mahavir Enclave Part-3 West Delhi-110059 have changed my name to DHRUV ANISH BHIMDAA and shall henceforth be known as DHRUV ANISH BHIMDAA

0050297545-1

I,SHAKUNTLA SACHDEVA alias SHAKUNTALA RANI,W/O-Suresh Sachdeva,R/o-3376, Sector-57,near M3M Atrium V-7,Gurgaon Po,Gurgaon, Haryana-122001,inform that my name SHAKUNTALA SACHDEVA and SHAKUNTALA RANI,both name are same and one person

0040878079-6

I,CHANDER BHAN,S/O-LAXI RAM,R/O-314,SITARAM APARTMENT IP EXTENSION EAST DELHI-110092,have changed my name to CHANDER BHAN GARG.

0040878080-4

I,Deepak Kumar Punj,S/o-Yash Pal Punj,R/O-Tower-9,Flat No-1404,Emaar Imperial Garden,Near DPS School,Sector-102,Gurgaon, Haryana-122505,Have Change my name to Deepak Punj for all Purposes.

0040878081-4

I, Anil Kumar, S/o Mohar Singh, R/o: B-71, Sector-56, Noida, Gautam Buddha Nagar, U.P. - 201301, have changed my name from ANIL KUMAR MOHARIA to ANIL KUMAR. Henceforth, I shall be known and identified by the name ANIL KUMAR for all purposes.

0040878026-1

I,Akshwat Aggarwal alies Akshat Aggarwal,S/O-Rakesh Kumar,R/O-1/11243, First Floor,Main Road Subhash Park,Shahdara Delhi-110032,Declare That,Akshwat Aggarwal And Akshat Aggarwal, Is One And The Same Person.

0040878079-8

I, LIAQAT ALI KHAN S/O ABDUL WAHEED R/O E-537 TOP FLOOR OKHLA VIHAR JAMIA NAGAR NEW FRIENDS COLONY, DELHI 110025, have changed my name to LIYAQAT ALI KHAN Permanently.

0071060226-1

I, Mohini Devi Mangla W/o Ramesh Chand Mangla, have changed my name to "Mohini Mangla" for all official purposes. R/o C-145 Pocket-6, Kendriya Vihar-2, Sector-82, NOIDA-201304(UP).

0071060262-1

I,SANDEEP KUMAR,S/O-Ashok,R/O-Chatta Mohalla,Dhaultana,Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-245301, have changed my minor son's name from AARAV to VEDANT, in future for all purposes.

0040878079-1

I,Summar Chand Nagpal,S/o-Bishan Swaroop,R/o-KH No-137/36-B,House No-19,Shastri Marg,Near Sant Hospital,Sant Nagar,Burari,Delhi-110084, have changed my name to Sumer Chand.

0040878080-3

I, Mamta W/o. Sh. Mahesh Kumar R/o. 526/1, Nai Basti, Kishan Ganj, North Delhi -110007 have changed my name to Mamta Kumari for all future purposes.

0040877972-1

I,SEEMA KUMARI,W/O-VINOD KUMAR,R/O,J-1/328 BLOCK J-1 DDA FLATS KALKAJI NEW DELHI-110019 have changed my name to SEEMA Permanently for all future

0040878080-6

I,SUNIL KUMAR MANA,S/O-Om Prakash Mann,R/o-473, Prahlad Pur Bangur,North West Delhi-110042, have changed my name,to,SUNIL KUMAR MANN.

0040878083-1

I,Davinder Kumar Bhatia S/o Lakshman Das Bhatia R/o-597, Gali-15, Gandhi Colony, Muzaffarnagar have changed my name to Davendra Kumar Bhatia.

0071060244-1

I,Singareppa Juttanavar S/o Chanagoud R/o 570 Maruti Galli, Sampagao, Ballalohang, Sampagao, Belgaum Karnataka -591125, have changed my minor son's name from Achyuth Singareppa Juttanavar Aged 03 Years to Dhruva Singareppa Juttanavar forever

0071060339-1

I,Raghavendra Sharan Saxena, S/o-Raghuveer Sharan Saxena, R/o-Tower-14,Flat no-905 Nirala-Estate, Greater Noida-West,UP, have changed my name from,RAGHVENDRA SHARAN SAXENA to RAGHAVENDRA SHARAN SAXENA, for all future purposes.

0040878080-8

IJC-313573F SUB KANNADASAN J S/O JAYARAMAN V R/O QTR NO. 30 TYPE-4, LAXMI BAL NAGAR, NEW DELHI -110023 do hereby solemnly affirm and say that my wife name is mentioned as LALITHA which is incorrect and her name is LALITHA Kas per her id proof and other documents. I hereby declare that my wife's name is LALITHA and LALITHA K is one and same person.

0040877970-1

I Arnab alias Arnab Mathur S/o Kapil Mathur R/o 3214, 32nd Floor, Eternia, Sector-78, Tower Eternia, Mahagan Mezzaria, Noida, Uttar Pradesh-201301 declare that Arnab and Arnab Mathur both are one and same person and shall henceforth be known as Arnab Mathur for all future purposes.

0040878077-1

I, RAJESH KUMAR SHARMA S/O CHANDER LAL SHARMA R/O 3724/10, NARANG COLONY, TRI NAGAR, DELHI-110035, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO RAJESH SHARMA FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES.

0071060235-1

I, BABY RANI MONICA W/o Sanjiv Kumar Sharma, 379, Ward No-4, Mehrauli, Delhi-30 have changed my name to MONICA SHARMA.

0071060246-1

I, ANUBHAV S/o SUKHBIR RATHI, aged 22 years, residing at 33A STREET-2, VINOBA ENCLAVE, JHARODA KALAN, NEW DELHI -110072, have changed my name from ANUBHAV to ANUBHAV RATHI.

0071060269-1

I,Jessica Kar Khanna@ Jessica Khanna,W/o.Gautam Kar R/o,M-27, Greater Kailash, Part-II, Delhi-110048, India, changed my name to Jessica Kar PERMANENTLY.

0040878079-3

I,Nitish Kumar, S/o Shri Shiv Kumar, resident of Sehlang (9), Mahendragarh, Haryana-123027, have changed the name of my minor son Rudransh Bhardwal, aged 4 years and he shall hereafter be known as RAGHAV BHARDWAJ. It is verified that I have complied with other requirements in this connection.

0040878084-1

I, Kavita Singh W/o Varun Shah R/o Flat No.1929, Verona Tower, Mahagun Mascot, Crossing Republik, Ghaziabad, UP-201016 have changed my name from Kavita Sahni to Kavita Singh for all future purposes.

0040877976-1

I, VIPIN TIWARI S/O RAGHUNANDAN PRASAD, R/o Villa No.106, Lotus Villa, Greater Noida, Jalpura Sector-1, Surajpur, GBN, UP-201306 Have changed my name vipin kumar to vipin tiwari for all future purposes

0071060343-1

I,Sumanlata Rawat,W/o-Sanjay Singh Rawat,R/o-H.No.14-15,Pocket -15, Sector -24, Near Sovereign Public School,Rohini Delhi-110085,have changed my name to Suman Rawat for all Purposes.

0040878080-1

I,Shamshul Khaliq,R/o-Villa No-E-37,Paramount Golf Forest,Sector-Zeta, Surajpur, Greater Noida, Gautam Buddha Nagar,UP-201306,have changed my minor daughter,s name from Meher Siddiqui to Meher Khaliq,for all purposes.

0040878081-1

I,KARAMVIR S/O RAI SINGH R/O HOUSE NO-D-1/294, GALI NO-5, MAHAVIR ENCLAVE-1, PALAM VILAGE SO-5, DELHI -110045 have changed my name to KARAMVIR SINGH.

0071060230-1

I, Shamsuddin, S/o Mohd Umerdin, R/o FA-31, Abul Fazal Enclave, Jamia Nagar, New Delhi-110025, have changed my name to Mohamed Shamsuddin.

040877068-10

I, Laxman Prasad, S/o pancham lal, R/o Village chatur khera Gondwa, dhikunni, hardoi Uttar Pradesh-241203, hereby declare that my name was earlier written in Hindi as "लक्ष्मन प्रसाद", which has now been corrected to "लक्ष्मण प्रसाद". The correct English spelling of his name is "Laxman Prasad".

50297543

LOST & FOUND

It is notified for the information that I, Shukla Hazra, D/O-Gobinda Chandra Hazra, H.No.44, GULMOHAR ENCLAVE, ANDREWSGANJ, S/O South Delhi, Delhi 110049, have lost my original GPA, dated-18.12.1989, reg-no.31346, register at, SRO Noida executed by Anil Gujral in favour of K.I. Lal Seghal of property in respect of flat-no 44/Gul Mohar Enclave new Delhi has been lost During photocopy Property Papers. Finder please contact above the address.

0040878079-10

It is Notified to all that I,Rajni Goel,W/o-H P Goel, have lost my original allotment letter of 163,Saty Niketan Moti Bagh-II, New Delhi-1100021, if anyone finds it, then Please Contact:+91 9013820266

0040878079-11

LOST MY REGISTRATION DOCUMENT DELHI DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY CONTRACTOR'S REGISTRATION BOARD OFFICE ORDER NO.159/2024(B&R).Finder contact: SUSHIL CHANDRA SAXENA,S/O SH. KANTA PRASAD SAXENA,R/O 181-A,POCKET-1, PHASE-1, MAYUR VIHAR,EAST DELHI-110091.

0040878084-4

PUBLIC NOTICE

I, Deepshikha Dangwal D/o Shri Subhash Chandra Dangwal, resident of F-11, Alaknanda Apartment, Rampuri, Surya Nagar, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh - 201011, to hereby inform the general public that in my CBSE Class 10th Marksheet and Aadhaar Card, my father's name has been erroneously printed as Subhash Chander Dangwal instead of his correct name Subhash Chandra Dangwal. Both names Subhash Chander Dangwal and Subhash Chandra Dangwal refer to one and the same person i.e. my father. This may be noted for all future purposes.

0040877970-1

HEREBY, IT IS INFORMED TO THE GENERAL PUBLIC AT LARGE THAT MY CLIENT ASHOK OBEROI S/O. SANJAY OBEROI R/O D-82, ASHOK VIHAR, PH-1, DELHI-110025, IS THE ABSOLUTE OWNER & LAWFUL POSSESSOR OF RESIDENTIAL, BUILT UP, SHALABAGH, PROPERTY BEARING NO. 62, AREANUMBERING 125 SO. YDS. IN BLOCK-D, SITUATED IN THE LANDLOT PLAN OF WARDHUR RESIDENTIAL SCHEME, ASHOK VIHAR, PHASE-1, NEW DELHI-110025, IN VIRTUE OF CONVEYANCE DEED DATED 26.12.2011 REGD. WITH THE SUB REGISTRAR, DELHI.

HEREBY IT IS INFORMED THAT ALL THE LEGAL HEIRS OF DECEASED FATHER Late SH SANJAY OBEROI S/O. SANJAY OBEROI R/O D-82, ASHOK VIHAR, PH-1, DELHI-110025, HAVE SHARED IN FAVOR OF ASHOK OBEROI S/O SH. SANJAY OBEROI BY VIRTUE OF CONVEYANCE DEED DATED 26.12.2011 REGD. WITH THE SUB REGISTRAR DELHI, AND NOTHING REMAINS WITH ANYBODY ELSE WITH RESPECT TO THE ABOVE SAID PROPERTY.

HERBY IT IS INFORMED TO THE PUBLIC THAT THE ABOVE NAMED OWNER OF THE ABOVE SAID PROPERTY CREATED EQUIPABLE MORTGAGE OF HIS ABOVE SAID PROPERTY WITH PUNJAB NATIONAL BANK, MCD, ASHOK VIHAR, DELHI, AGAINST THE CREDIT FACILITY AVAILABLE IN THE LOAN AC OF OBEROI CONSTRUCTION CO.

FOR MOST IF ANY PERSON (BUT NOT HERELI CLAIMANTS), OR ANY OTHER PARTY HAVING ANY RIGHT, TITLE, INTEREST, CLAIM, OR INTEREST IN RESPECT OF THE ABOVE MENTIONED PROPERTY BY WAY OF INHERITANCE, SALE, MORTGAGE, LEND, GIFT, POSSESSION, OR OTHERWISE, HOWSOEVER AND OF WHATSOEVER NATURE, IT HEREBY REQUIRED TO CONTACT TO THE UNDER SIGNED, IN WRITING, WITH SUPPORTING DOCUMENTS THERE OF WITHIN SEVEN DAYS FROM THE DATE OF PUBLICATION OF THIS PUBLIC NOTICE, OR ELSE ANY SUCH OBJECTED CLAIM SHALL NOT BE CONSIDERED AND SHALL BE DEEMED TO HAVE BEEN WAIVED AND/OR ABANDONED, AND NO LITIGATION SHALL BE ENTERTAINED THEREAFTER AND THE TRANSACTION SHALL BE COMPLETE WITHOUT ANY FURTHER REQUIREMENT.

Anil Kumar Goel, Advocate, Ch. No.319, Lawyers Chamber Block, Rohini District Court, Delhi-110085, E-mail: anilgoel2004@gmail.com, Mob. No.: 9854315397

WHOMSOEVER IT MAY CONCERN SUBJECT: PUBLIC NOTICE REGARDING PROPERTY BEARING NO. P-54, MEASURING 160 SQ. YARDS, OUT OF KHARAKA NO. 30, VILLAGE SITTAT, NEAR VILLAGE KHAYALIA (ABADI OF P-BLOCK), VISHNU GARDEN, NEW DELHI-110018.

Notice is hereby given to the general public that Sh. Dhanraj Singh (residing at First Floor, Property No. P-54, Village Khayalia, Vishnu Garden, New Delhi - 110018) and Sh. Jasbir Singh (residing at Ground Floor, Property No. P-54, Village Khayalia, Vishnu Garden, New Delhi - 110018), sons of Late Shri Swarn Singh and Late Smt. Tej Kaur, are co-owners holding a combined 2/3rd undivided equal share in the aforesaid Subject Property.

TAKE NOTICE THAT:

1. The Subject Property was self-acquired property of Late Smt. Tej Kaur purchased via registered Sale Deed dated 14.01.1972 (Registration No. 554, Add. Book No. 1, Vol. No. 1602, Pages 121-122, Sub-Register Office, Kashinagar, Delhi).

2. The registered Will dated 08.08.2017 previously executed in favour of Sh. Satnam Singh (S/o Late Shri Swarn Singh, R/o 2541, Gali No. 13, Rajneet Nagar, Near Kauri Basti School, Patel Nagar, New Delhi - 110015) was formally revoked, cancelled, and declared null & void by Late Smt. Tej Kaur during her lifetime, as the same was obtained through fraud, misrepresentation, coercion, and undue influence.

3. Further, as per the notarized Last Will and Testament dated 05.04.2018 of Late Smt. Tej Kaur (who passed away in 12th May 2025), the Subject Property devolves equally (1/3rd share each) among her three sons, namely Sh. Dhanraj Singh, Sh. Jasbir Singh, and Sh. Satnam Singh.

4. A Legal Notice dated 08.08.2025 has already been served upon Sh. Satnam Singh calling upon him to refrain from creating third-party rights, mortgage solely in the name of Sh. Satnam Singh, and to execute a formal Deed of Partition.

The general public, buyers, builders, financial institutions, and property dealers are hereby CAUTIONED AND WARNED not to enter into any transaction, agreement to sell, mortgage, lease, alienation, creation of third-party rights, or mutation solely in the name of Sh. Satnam Singh or on the basis of the revocable dated 19.07.2017.

Any person dealing with Sh. Satnam Singh in respect of the Subject Property or the 2/3rd share belonging to Sh. Dhanraj Singh and Sh. Jasbir Singh shall do so at their own risk, cost, and legal consequences. Our clients shall not be bound by any such illegal transactions and will initiate strict civil and criminal court proceedings against all concerned parties issued under instructions from and on behalf of our clients:

**• Sh. Dhanraj Singh
• Sh. Jasbir Singh**

**USHA SINGH & ASSOCIATES
Off: 41-A, DDA Flat, Masjid Moth, New Delhi**

PUBLIC NOTICE
Be it known to all concerned that my clients, namely Mrs. Sheela Devi W/o Sh. Anil Singh and Sh. Anil Singh S/o Sh. Mahabhar Singh, R/o H.No. A-210, Dooli Extension, Delhi, South Delhi, New Delhi-110022, hereby declare that they have severed all their relations and association with their daughter, namely Ms. Anvi, due to strained relations and personal differences. My clients further declare that they have disowned Ms. Anvi and shall not be responsible for any act, omission, transaction, representation, commitment, liability, or dealing undertaken by her in her individual capacity or by representing herself as acting for or on behalf of my clients. My clients have declared that Ms. Anvi shall have no right, title, interest or claim whatsoever over any movable or immovable properties/assets of my clients. It is further notified to the general public that Ms. Anvi has no authority, consent or authorisation from my clients to represent them or to enter into any transaction, agreement, commitment or arrangement on their behalf, and any person dealing with her on such representation shall do so at his/her own risk, cost and consequences. This public notice is issued for information of the general public and all concerned.

**KESHAV ROY (ADVOCATE)
Ch.No.747, Dwarka Court, Delhi-110075**



फुरसुंगी-उरुली देवाची नगरपालिका फुरसुंगी,
ता. हवेली, जि. पुणे-४१२३०८

ई-मेल: fursungi.urulidevachinp2024@gmail.com



जा.क्र.फु.ऊ.दे.न.पा./आ.वि./१६५३/२०२६-२७

दि. ०९/०९/२०२६

E-TENDER NOTICE (Invitation for Bids)

Fursungi-Uriuli Devachi Municipal Council invites online Bids from Eligible, experienced and qualified agencies for the following work, Name of Work: **Tender for Comprehensive Street Sweeping, Public Area Cleaning, Door-to-Door Segregated Municipal Solid Waste Collection and Transportation to Processing Facilities Using Mechanized Vehicles for a Period of Three (03) Years. Online Bid Submission Period: From 12/09/2026 to 26/09/2026** Interested bidders are requested to submit their online bids through the Government of Maharashtra e-Tender Portal within the above-mentioned period.e-Tender Portal: <http://www.mahatenders.gov.in> The detailed tender document, eligibility criteria, scope of work, terms & conditions, bid schedule and other information are available on the Government of Maharashtra e-Tender Portal., Interested bidders shall submit their online bids only through the e-Tender portal within the prescribed time schedule mentioned in the detailed tender notice.

STAMP

Sursungi Uriuli Devachi Municipal Council

Sd/-

Chief Officer

20 SATURDAY,SEPTEMBER 12, 2026

THE INDIAN EXPRESS



DISTRICT POLICE

HEADQUARTERS SAMBA

LOOK OUT NOTICE

As intimated by DySP Hqrs Samba vide letter No. DySP Hqrs/2026/8487 dated 08.09.2026, that one lady namely Sonia Devi W/o Pawan Kumar R/o Odh (Surara) Tehsil Ghagwal District Samba has been missing from home and her missing report has been entered vide DDR No. 15 dated 21.07.2025 of P/S Ghagwal. Her search was conducted but not traced out till date. Through the medium of this LOOK OUT NOTICE, it is informed to all the Police Establishments/General Public that any information related to the missing lady may be communicated on following contacts:-

1. PCR Samba :-01923-246333, 9541649001

2. SSP Samba's email ID :- ssp-samba@jkpolice.gov.in

3. SHO PS Ghagwal:- 8825067622

The description roll along with photograph of missing lady is as under:-

Name:	Sonia Devi	
W/O:	Pawan Kumar	
Permanent Address:	Odh (Surara) Tehsil Ghagwal District Samba	
Age:	26 Years	
Height:	5 Feet 1 inch	
Complexion:	Fair	
Face:	Long	
Body Structure:	Normal	
Languages known:	Hindi	
Attire:	Salwar Kurta	

No. CB/Look/2026/

Dated: -09.2026

DIP/J-10208/26 - DATE 11 SEP 2026

Sd/-

Sr. Superintendent of Police,

Samba



DISTRICT POLICE

HEADQUARTERS SAMBA

LOOK OUT NOTICE

As intimated by DySP Hqrs Samba vide letter No. DySP Hqrs/2026/8487 dated 08.09.2026, that one lady namely Sema Devi W/o Kunal Sharma R/o Paloono Tehsil Rajpura District Samba has been missing from home and her missing report has been entered vide DDR No. 11 dated 12.05.2025 of P/S Ghagwal. Her search was conducted but not traced out till date. Through the medium of this LOOK OUT NOTICE, it is informed to all the Police Establishments/General Public that any information related to the missing lady may be communicated on following contacts:-

1. PCR Samba :-01923-246333, 9541649001

2. SSP Samba's email ID :- ssp-samba@jkpolice.gov.in

3. SHO PS Ghagwal:- 8825067622

The description roll along with photograph of missing lady is as under:-

Name:	Sema Devi	
W/O:	Kunal Sharma	
Permanent Address:	Paloono Tehsil Rajpura District Samba	
Age:	22 Years	
Height:	5 Feet 1 inch	
Complexion:	Fair	
Face:	Normal	
Body Structure:	Normal	
Languages known:	Hindi	
Attire:	Salwar Kurta	

No. CB/Look/2026/

Dated: -09.2026

DIP/J-10211/26 - DATE 11 SEP 2026

Sd/-

Sr. Superintendent of Police,

Samba



SAVITRIBAI PHULE PUNE UNIVERSITY

(Formerly University of Pune)

Online Applications are invited for **Associate Professor (01 post)** from University Fund for five years in Ahilyanagar Sub Center, Savitribai Phule Pune University from 15.09.2026 to 30.09.2026. For qualifications, experience, specialization, reservation and other details, please log on to University website: admin.unipune.ac.in/recruitment

Advt. No.: 22

Prof. Dr. Prafulla Pawar

Date: 12-09-2026

Offg. Registrar



SOUTH EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

Sr. Divisional Engineer (Co) / S.E.C.Railway, Nagpur invites E-Tender for execution of following works:-

Sl. No.	Name of the work	Tender Notice No.	Approx. Tender Value in ₹	Bid Security (₹)
1.	Miscellaneous P- Way work such as de-stressing of track, Tie-Temping work, lifting and packing of track etc. in between Nagbhir-Chandafort (BG) Section under the jurisdiction of SSE (P.Way)/CAF under ADEN/NAB.	S-21-NAG-2026-2027	1,13,39,465.70	2,26,800/-
2.	Miscellaneous P- Way work such as de-stressing of track, Tie-Temping work, lifting and packing of track etc. in between Gondia - Nagbhir (BG) Section under the jurisdiction of SSE (P.Way)/NAB under ADEN/NAB.	S/22/NAG/2026-2027	1,41,03,483.62	2,82,100/-

For all the above tenders Bidders will be able to submit their original/revised bids up to 15.00 hrs of 01.10.2026 only. Manual offers are not allowed. Details are available on our website: www.ireps.gov.in

PAM/45/115 Divl. Engineer (South)/S.E.C.Railway/Nagpur

f South East Central Railway @secrail



UJVN LIMITED

(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprise)

H. O. "UJJARALI" MAHARAJ BAGH, ONE ROAD, DEHRADUN, Uttarakhand, PIN No. 248001, UTTARAKHAND, INDIA. Tel. : 0135-2763506, 2763888, Fax: 0135-2763507, website: www.ujvnl.com

Tender No.802 Date : 11.09.2026

TENDER NOTICE

Office of the Executive Engineer, (M&G) Mohammadpur Power House, Gurukul Narsan, Haridwar invites sealed tenders from experienced firms for following works/supply for Mohammadpur Power House:-

1. Tender No 13/EE(M&G)/MPH/2026-27- Procurement of 11 kV spares along with Maintenance of electrical panels & Installation work at Mohammadpur Power House.

2. Tender No 14/EE(M&G)/MPH/2026-27- Repair and Overhauling work of 05 Nos. Bye pass gates and 1- no. side channel gate at Mohammadpur Power House.

Estimated Cost: ₹15,78,006 (GST extra), ₹12,59,240 (GST extra) respectively

Date of availability of bid document on website: 12.09.2026

Last date for submission of tender: 03.10.2026, up to 11.00 Hrs.

For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website "www.ujvnl.com"

EXECUTIVE ENGINEER (M&G)

"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"

HIMACHAL PRADESH

PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT

e-Procurement Notice

INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB)

The Executive Engineer, Division Kasumpti HPPWD, Shimla-3, H.P on behalf of Governor of H.P invites the Percentage rate bids, in electronic tendering system from the eligible class of contractors registered with HPPWD for the works as detailed in the table.

Sr. No.	Name of Work	Estimated Cost.	Form Cost	Starting date for downloading Bid	Earnest Money	Deadline for submission of Bid	Time Allowed
1	Up-gradation of link road from lohar Kainchi to Rihad Km 0/000 to 1/100. (SH- Providing and Laying Prime coat tack-along with 25mm thick bituminous concrete in Km 0/000 to 0/605). (Under SCA Head). (Balance Work).	1052946	500	11-09-2026	21100	19-09-2026	30 days
2	Up gradation of link road from Doran(Cheeg) to Khadli Km 0/000 to 1/600. (SH- Providing and Laying Prime coat tack-along with 25mm thick bituminous concrete in Km 0/000 to 0/500). (Under SCA Head). (Balance Work).	899915	350	11-09-2026	18000	19-09-2026	30 days
3	Upgradation of link road from Dhanain to Panjog Km 0/000 to 2/645. (SH- Providing and Laying Prime coat tack-along with 25mm thick bituminous concrete in Km 0/810 to 1/235).(Under SCA Head). (Balance Work).	764988	350	11-09-2026	15300	19-09-2026	30 days
4	Upgradation of link road from Lohar Kainchi to Rihad Km 0/000 to 1/100. (SH- Providing and Laying Prime coat tack-along with 25mm thick bituminous concrete in Km 0/00 to 0/605). (Under SCA Head). (Balance Work).	1088963	500	11-09-2026	21800	19-09-2026	30 days
5	Upgradation of link road from Shohawal to Drabla Km 0/000 to 2/500. (SH- Providing and Laying Prime coat tack-along with 25mm thick bituminous concrete in Km 1/495 to 2/070).(Under SCA Head). (Balance Work).	1034875	500	11-09-2026	20700	19-09-2026	30 days
6	Upgradation of link road from Poudhallhar to Rawani Mal Dhala Km 0/000 to 1/500. (SH- Providing and Laying Prime coat tack-along with 25mm thick bituminous concrete in Km 0/000 to 0/775). (Under SCA Head). (Balance Work).	1394848	500	11-09-2026	27900	19-09-2026	30 days
7	Upgradation of road from Patgar to village Dhar Dutt road Km.0/00 to 1/500 (SH- Providing and Laying Metalling Tarring at Rd. 0/00 to 0/490). (Excluding GST)	897437	350	11-09-2026	18000	19-09-2026	30 days
8	Upgradation of road from Bhoat to Kavi road Km.0/00 to 0/500 (SH- Providing and Laying Metalling Tarring at Rd. 0/00 to 0/345) (Excluding GST)	636276	350/-	11-09-2026	12800	19-09-2026	30 days
9	Periodic Renewal & Periodic Maintenance of Mashobra to Bhaikally road Km 0/000 to 18/300. (SH- Providing and Laying renewal coat bituminous concrete 25mm thick between Rd./000 to 3/000) Under AMP 2026-27(MDR)(Without GST)	3883404	2000	11-09-2026	78000	19-09-2026	60 days
10	Upgradation of link road from Poudhallhar to Rawani Mal Dhala Km 0/000 to 1/500. (SH- Providing and Laying Prime coat tack-along with 25mm thick bituminous concrete in Km 0/000 to 0/775). (Under SCA Head). (Balance Work).	5620044	2000	11-09-2026	112400	19-09-2026	60 days
11	Periodic Renewal and periodic Maintenance of Shimla to Mandi road km. 6/00 to 12/000 (SH- Providing and laying Tack coat, 25mm thick Bituminous Concrete in Km. 6/000 to 10/500). (UNDER AMP 2026-27) (MDR) (without GST)	10234928	5000	11-09-2026	204700	19-09-2026	60 days
12	A/R & M/O to Tikkar to Aramah Velly Gate road Km 0/000 to 1/300. (SH- Providing and Laying Patch work with bituminous Concrete in various RDs) (Excluding GST)	423381	350	11-09-2026	8500	19-09-2026	30 days
13	A/R & M/O to Mashobra to Sipur road Km 0/000 to 2/720 (SH- Providing & Laying Tack Coat & 25 mm thick Bituminous Concrete in Km 0/000 to 1/00).(Excluding GST).	1735492	500	11-09-2026	35000	19-09-2026	30 days

The bidders are advised to note other details of tenders from the department website www.hptender.gov.in

The executive Engineer reserves the right to accept/reject any tender/application or all tenders without assigning any reason.

No. 3283/HP



GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA

TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/ CORP./ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./ AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HPGCL	RESTORATION/UPGRADATION AND REUTILIZATION OF CLUMPS MAKE DIESEL GENERATOR SETS 750 KVA FOR EMERGENCY POWER SUPPLY FOR UNIT-6 AND 7 AND 8 PTGS. PARPAT	08.09.2026 16.09.2026	RS. 1,13,03,400/- & EMD RS. 2,26,000/-	www.hpgcl.org.in & https://tenders.hry.nic.in	01802546215 venmrksh@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 49193/HRY



UTTARAKHAND SAHAKARI CHINI MILLS SANGH LTD.

Near Railway Crossing, Badripur Road, Jogiwala, Dehradun-248001 (Uttarakhand)

Telephone No. :- 0135-2974413, E-mail: uksugars@gmail.com, Website:- www.uttarakhandsugars.com, GST No. 05AABFU7713KZ21

Letter No. 865/PUR/01/E-Tender/2026-27 Date: 11 September, 2026

E-Tender Notice for Rate Contract Items

Online E-Tender are invited from **Manufactures or through their authorized representative /Authorized distributors / Authorized dealer / Channel Partner / Traders (as per details given in the e-tender documents) for Caustic Soda, Nickel Screen, Lime, HDPE/PP Bags (50 kg.), A & C Type Jute Bags (50 kg.), Zincalume / Galvalume color coated profile sheets and ridge caps (plain) items and PSU / Associate Co of any PSU for Lubricant (as per details given in the e-tender documents) to our Co-operative and Corporation sugar mills season 2026-27.**

The details for submission of the E-Bids is available on the E-tender portals as per Table No. 01 www.uktenders.gov.in & www.uttarakhandsugars.com. The bidders will have to deposit Per Tender fees (Non Refundable) of Rs. 2,360/- (GST Inclusive) & earnest money in the form of Demand Draft /RTGS / NEFT in favor of **Uttaranchal Co-operative Sugar Factories Federation Limited, Payable at Dehradun**. Tenders without Tender Fees & Earnest money will not be accepted. The bank details are available inside the tender document.

The Federation reserves the right to cancel any or all bids/annual e-bidding process, without assigning and reason to & decision of Federation will be final & binding.

TABLE No. 01

Sl. No.	Name of Item	Starting date of loading of E-Tender Portal at 06:00 PM	Last Date & Time for Submission of e-bids	Technical bid opening at 10:30 AM	E.M.D. (in Rs.)
1	2	3	4	5	6
RATE CONTRACT FOR THE SUPPLY OF DIFFERENT ITEMS TO OUR SUGAR FACTORIES IN UTTARAKHAND STATE					
1.	Caustic Soda	11-09-2026	05-10-2026	06-10-2026	60,000.00
2.	Nickel Screen	11-09-2026	05-10-2026	06-10-2026	60,000.00
3.	Lubricant	11-09-2026	05-10-2026	06-10-2026	2,50,000.00 (PSU are exempted from EMD)
4.	Lime	11-09-2026	05-10-2026	06-10-2026	3,00,000.00
5.	HDPE/PP Bags (50 kg.)	11-09-2026	05-10-2026	06-10-2026	8,00,000.00
6.	A & C Type Jute Bags (50 kg.)	11-09-2026	05-10-2026	06-10-2026	8,00,000.00
7.	Zincalume / Galvalume color coated profile sheets and ridge caps (plain)	11-09-2026	05-10-2026	06-10-2026	1,20,000.00

इस निविदा के सम्बन्ध में सभी सरोचना, स्फ़्टीकरण, शुद्धिपत्र, परिशिष्ट, समय वृद्धि आदि को केवल www.uktenders.gov.in & www.uttarakhandsugars.com पर ही दिया जायेगा। निविदादाता अद्यतन जानकारी के लिए नियमित रूप से इन वेबसाइटों को पढ़ते रहें।

GENERAL MANAGER



GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA

TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/ CORP./ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./ AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF IT MACHINE ON 2 YEARS RATE CONTRACT AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT	10.09.2026 24.09.2026	17,50,000/-	www.hmscd.org.in	8929299829 equipmentsgm2020@gmail.com
2	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF NEONATAL VENTILATOR ON 2 YEARS RATE CONTRACT AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT	10.09.2026 24.09.2026	3,63,76,330/-	www.hmscd.org.in	8929299829 equipmentsgm2020@gmail.com
3	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	ONLINE TENDER FOR THE RATE CONTRACT FOR THE SUPPLY OF MEDICINES TO VARIOUS HOSPITALS OF GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA FOR A PERIOD OF TWO YEARS FOR GROUP B MEDICINES (47 ITEMS)	10.09.2026 01.10.2026	17,75,00,000 /-	www.hmscd.org.in	0172-479822 hmscdtenders@gmail.com
4	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	ONLINE TENDER FOR THE RATE CONTRACT FOR THE SUPPLY OF MEDICINES TO VARIOUS HOSPITALS OF GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA FOR A PERIOD OF TWO YEARS FOR GROUP B MEDICINES (21ITEMS)	10.09.2026 01.10.2026	27,85,00,000/-	www.hmscd.org.in	0172-479822 hmscdtenders@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 49165/HRY



GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA

TENDER NOTICE

SR NO	NAME OF DEPARTMENT	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE DEPARTMENT	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	PWD B&R, HISAR	SPECIAL REPAIR OF ROAD FROM NEOLI KALAN TO NEOLI KHURD ROAD RD 0.00 TO 3.900 (ROAD ID 4905) IN HISAR DISTT. (NALWA CONSTITUENCY OF WORK PROGRAMME 2026-27) (GROUP NO. 9)	CLOSING DATE 17.09.2026	114.68 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9878384499 pwd-eept1-hissar@hry.nic.in
2	AGRICULTURE & FARMERS WELFARE, CHARKHI DADRI	RAMP INLET WORKS AT PONDS OF VILLAGE HANSAWAS KALAN ,BLOCK BADHRA, CHARKHI DADRI	07.09.2026 14.09.2026	7.24 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9466627716 ascodadri@gmail.com
3	AGRICULTURE & FARMERS WELFARE, CHARKHI DADRI	EXTENSION AND BEAUTIFICATION OF PERCOLATION POND, UNN, RENOVATION OF POND AND C.C. PITCHING, JHOJHU KALAN	07.09.2026 14.09.2026	36.35 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9466627716 ascodadri@gmail.com
4	AGRICULTURE & FARMERS WELFARE, CHARKHI DADRI	PERCOLATION POND IN VILLAGE ASAWARI AND MEHRA, BLOCK JHOJHU KALAN	07.09.2026 14.09.2026	40 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9466627716 ascodadri@gmail.com
5	KALPANA CHAWLA GOVT MEDICAL COLLEGE KARNAL	E-TENDER FOR MEDICAL EQUIPMENT/INSTRUMENT (PORTABLE ILLUMINATION UNIT WITH HEAD BAND, FIBER OPTIC CABLE, NASAL BONE FRACTURE REDUCTION SET ETC.) AT KCGMC, KARNAL	14.09.2026 24.09.2026	EMD 10000/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9992132471 director.kgchc-hry@gov.in
6	CIVIL SURGEON, FATEHABAD.	REGARDING NQAS ITEM E TENDER 2026-27 FOR DISTRICT FATEHABAD	12.09.2026 22.09.2026	EMD 50000	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9996913229 cds.ftb1@gmail.com
7	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, CHARKHI DADRI	REQUIREMENT OF VARIOUS ITEMS UNDER JURISDICTION OF LWS (M) SUB DIVISION NO. 2, CHARKHI DADRI AND 3 MORE WORKS	CLOSING DATE 17.09.2026	4.81 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01250-220058 xenlwsmech@gmail.com
8	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, PANCHKULA	SUPPLY OF BEARINGS PERTAINING TO HISAR W.S. (MECH.) DIVISION, HISAR + 3 OTHER WORKS	11.09.2026 24.09.2026	24.28 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	0172-2582542 xenproc@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT www.etenders.hry.nic.in

No. 49187/HRY



बैंक ऑफ बरौदा

Bank of Baroda

Stressed Assets Management Vertical, Bank of Baroda, Baroda Corporate Center, C-26, G-Block, Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra East, Mumbai - 400051. Email : wfd.bco@bankofbaroda.co.in BOB:SAWV:118:1511 to 1516 Date : 03-09-2026

SHOW CAUSE NOTICE (SCN)

M/s. i-Lifestyle and Textiles Pvt. Limited, Registered Office : Plot No. 321.1st Floor, Peenya Industrial Area, 8th Cross, 4th Phase, Bengaluru - 560058, Karnataka. Factory / Godown : F-205, Keerthi Harmony, Apartment, Raghvendra Circle, Ramamurthy Nagar, Bengaluru - 560016, Karnataka. Mr. Tarun Jain & Mrs Shivani Jain, A/28 Rana Pratap Bagh, II Floor, New Delhi, PIN - 110007. F-13/3, UGF Model Town II, New Delhi, PIN - 110009

Dear Sir,

The Identification Committee on Wilful Defaulters of our Bank has instructed to issue SCN to you for classification as Wilful Defaulter on the following grounds :-

1. The borrower has the capacity to honor the Bank's obligation but not honoring it.

2. Remittance of Rs. 3.15 Crs and Rs. 4.26 Crs was made to unrelated business entities.

3. Remittance of Rs. 0.45 Crs to M/s Elcan Lifestyle Limited wherein Mr. Tarun Jain is also Director.

4. Disposal of assets was done without informing the bank and the proceeds were not routed through the Bank account.

5. No Infusion of equity by Promoter as per the agreed, sanctioned terms and conditions.

Your acts of omission and commission fall within the purview of RBI Wilful Defaulters Guidelines under Clause 3 (1) (xviii) (A) (a), (b), (c), (d) & (e) - Capacity, Diversion of funds, Siphoning off funds, Disposal of assets, No infusion of equity.

The SCN sent to above addresses on **04-09-2026** returned undelivered, thus being published in newspaper.

You are called upon to submit your written representation within -21- days at the address given in this SCN for consideration by the Identification Committee as to why you should not be classified as Wilful Defaulter. In case of non-receipt of the same within -21- days, the Identification Committee shall proceed further as per RBI guidelines in classification of you as Wilful Defaulter.

Sd/- (General Manager)



DISTRICT POLICE

HEADQUARTERS SAMBA

LOOK OUT NOTICE

As intimated by SDPO Vijaypur vide letter No. SDPO/V-26/5375 dated 08.09.2026, that one person namely Kanhaiya Sharma S/o Uttam Chand @ Bittu R/o Kamala Tehsil Ramgarh District Samba has been missing from Kamala and his missing report has been entered vide DDR No.03 dated 19.07.2025 of P/S Ramgarh. His search was conducted but not traced out till date. Through the medium of this LOOK OUT NOTICE, it is informed to all the Police Establishments/General Public that any information related to the missing person may be communicated on following contacts:-

1. PCR Samba :-01923-246333, 9541649001

2. SSP Samba's email ID :- ssp-samba@jkpolice.gov.in

3. SHO PS Ramgarh:- 9797455270

The description roll along with photograph of missing person is as under:-

Name:	Kanhaiya Sharma	
Parentage	Sh. Uttam Chand @ Bittu	
Permanent Address:	Kamala Tehsil Ramgarh District Samba	
Age:	21 Years	
Height:	5'-02" inch	
Complexion:	Fair	
Face:	Normal	
Body Structure:	Normal	
Languages known:	Hindi and Dogri	
Attire:	Shirt (Maroon Colour) and Pent Jena (Straight Fit)	

No. CB/Look/2026/

Dated: -09.2026

DIP/J-10150/26 - DATE 11 SEP 2026

Sd/-

Sr. Superintendent of Police,

Samba



DISTRICT POLICE

HEADQUARTERS SAMBA

LOOK OUT NOTICE

As intimated by DySP Hqrs Samba vide letter No. DySP Hqrs/2026/8487 dated 08.09.2026, that one girl namely Pinka Sharma D/o Sham Lal R/o Sandhi Tehsil Ghagwal District Samba has been missing from home and her missing report has been entered vide DDR No. 40 dated 06.09.2024 of P/S Ghagwal. Her search was conducted but not traced out till date. Through the medium of this LOOK OUT NOTICE, it is informed to all the Police Establishments/General Public that any information related to the missing girl may be communicated on following contacts:-

1. PCR Samba :-01923-246333, 9541649001

2. SSP Samba's email ID :- ssp-samba@jkpolice.gov.in

3. SHO PS Ghagwal: 8825067622

The description roll along with photograph of missing girl is as under:-

Name:	Pinka Sharma	
D/O:	Sham Lal (Father)	
Permanent Address:	Sandhi Tehsil Ghagwal District Samba	
Age:	25 Years	
Height:	5 Feet 2 inch	
Complexion:	Whitish	
Face:	Normal	
Body Structure:		

ASIAN GAMES | AICHI-NAGOYA | SEPTEMBER 19 TO OCTOBER 4

Paraphernalia, Protagonist, Podium: It takes three elements to complete sport. *The Indian Express* presents the stories about the personality, the equipment and the opponent who will bring the slash of strokes and dash of colour to the Asian Games

M&M's look to serve up a medal

Paddlers Manav Thakkar & Manush Shah are making their left-right combination count as they look forward to taking on the best pairs of Asia

Bhuvan Gupta
New Delhi, September 11

MANAV THAKKAR and Manush Shah joined hands in 2023, on a lark.

They had been friends for a decade; partnering formally in doubles was natural. They reached the semi-finals in their first senior tournament together — WTT Contender Tunis — and nearly brought home an Asian Games medal in the second.

Three years on, Manav-Manush are world No.3 and India's best shot at a table tennis podium in Aichi-Nagoya.

The bespectacled Gujaratis have a lot going for them. They are the country's top two men's singles paddlers. They are a complementary right-hander, left-hander combination. Manush is aggressive, Manav is cast in a counter-attacking mould. But what really makes them tick is a deep, enduring bond starting 2013.

Vadodara's Manush, a year younger than Surat's Manav, joined him in the national under-16 team. They travelled and stayed together in Delhi for the South Asian Junior Championships. They've been roommates on tour ever since.

The chemistry was evident from the outset. They won an Asian Junior Championships 2018 doubles bronze medal in Myanmar. They also won a number of junior pro tour titles between 2017 and 2019. Then they involuntarily stopped.

Manav grew to the U-21 category, where there was no doubles. Then he took the seniors plunge and started teaming up on and off with Anthony Amalraj and Harmeet Desai. COVID struck in between and Manush only entered the sen-

iors fray in 2022.

Manav was competitive alongside Amalraj and Harmeet too, but they were both righties. The return of leftie Manush unlocked a new dimension.

"As a junior I didn't have the awareness (about the benefits of a right-left pair). But now I find it difficult to combine with a righty even in mixed doubles," Manav tells *The Indian Express*.

He is referring to the jostling that can happen mid-rally for two right-handers. Most doubles players have a dominant forehand.

When both are righties, they lack room to manoeuvre to the forehand for their respective shots. A right-left combination solves that problem.

Both partners can play to their strengths, which is more doable in doubles than singles because of the time allowed by alternating shots. The magic happens when a pair can mask each other's weaknesses too. Manush says, "Till one year back we were solid but made a lot of errors. Now we are levelling up each other's game. He is making fewer mistakes and I am taking more risks."

Explained in TT terms, Manush hits the ball harder than Manav, which makes opponents move forward and backward a lot. "In the rest of the left-right pairs, the quality of the ball and the game is almost the same. There is hardly any difference. But in our case, one guy's returns are lower and the others' balls are deeper. By the time opponents understand this, we try to end the match," Manav says.

Spending so much time with each other sharpens their complementary instincts,



MANAV-MANUSH
TT MEN'S DOUBLES

India's Manav Thakkar (R) and Manush Shah, who lost in the quarterfinals at the 2023 Asian Games, are the current World No.3 men's doubles pair. EXPRESS

which Manav believes has led to the duo's rise. But he is quick to add that this is a common trait among Asian pairs, as many of them grow up and train together.

Gujarati twist

What distinguishes the Indians is their mode of communication during matches. Unlike most teams, Manav and Manush don't rely on hand signs for services, receives and returns. They verbalize in Gujarati.

For a backspin, no-spin serve, one will say "*dheeli* (loose)" to the other. For a cut service, they'll call out, "*kaapi*

• Friends and partners

YEARS TOGETHER ON THE CIRCUIT: 13

CURRENT WORLD RANKING: No.3 (career-best No.2)

SEEDING AT ASIAN GAMES: No.2

EARLY SUCCESS: 2018 Asian Junior Championships bronze

RECENT ACHIEVEMENT: WTT Contender Lagos title, semifinals at 2026 Singapore Grand Smash.

CONVERSATIONS DURING MATCHES: Gujarati

ne (cut it)". To step around from forehand to backhand or vice versa, "*fari ja* (change your stance)" is used.

The instructions help open up the other player's favourable shot. "I'll often be like, 'I think the opponent will do this. So what should I do? What is good for you?'" Manav says. These things cannot really be signalled under the table. "Sometimes, it's important what my partner wants, not what I want to do. Because he has to play the next ball, not me."

Such empathetic understanding has fuelled their strong run over the past 12 months. Manav-Manush made

a historic semis appearance at the 2026 Singapore Grand Smash and quarters at the Smash's United States and Sweden legs. They also won the WTT Contender Lagos title en route to achieving a career-best world No. 2 ranking.

The Indian pair will be seeded second at the Asiad. Besides the top-billed Chinese team of Lin Shidong and Huang Youzheng, they could face a strong challenge from South Korea's Lim Jong-hoon and Oh Jun-sung.

Manav recognises Jong-hoon as the best doubles player in the world; whoever partners him surges to a top-5 spot, be it

in the men's or mixed category. Him and Manush have taken the South Korean on several times and lost each time. This includes the Asian Games 2023 quarterfinal, where Jong-hoon was joined by Jang Woo-jin and ranked No. 1. The Indians, having led in the deciding fifth game, fell agonisingly short of victory and a medal.

At the coming edition, though, they would not meet Jong-hoon before the semis, by when a podium finish is assured. Manav-Manush are more wary of possible banana-peel opponents in the prior rounds. "There are many dangerous pairs. Take the North Koreans

In the rest of the left-right pairs, the quality of the ball and the game is almost the same. But in our case, one guy's returns are lower and the others' balls are deeper. By the time opponents understand this, we try to end the match."

MANAV THAKKAR,
ON COMBINATION WITH MANUSH

Till one year back we were solid but made a lot of errors. Now we are levelling up each other's game. He is making fewer mistakes and I am taking more risks."

MANUSH SHAH,
ON HOW THE PAIR HAS IMPROVED

for instance. Nobody knows them. They are unseeded. At the Olympics, they came in and won a silver medal in mixed doubles (Ri Jong-sik and Kim Kum-yong)," Manav warns.

Nevertheless, Manush is bullish about their chances in Japan. "We are gelling well and competing at a high level, where we make ourselves a strong contender for winning medals at the bigger events like Asian Games."

Manav agrees. "Yes, there would be a little bit of pressure. But this is the dream, to have this sort of pressure and deliver. If this is not there, then there is no fun."

SPORT LAB

Pellet: The smallest item that makes the biggest difference in shooting

Shooters hit a target the size of a pin from 50 metres and need complete harmony between barrel and bullet

Shashank Nair
New Delhi, September 11

AISHWARY PRATAP Singh Tomar is circumspect at first and then passes judgement: "Getting my choice of bullets is the difference between scoring a 587 in qualification or a 595," he admits.

One score barely gets him into the final of his event, the other launches him into world record territory. Shooting and its difference of decimals means it isn't just about the rifle or its wielder, but the relationship of the barrel with the pellet — one that's built on a balancing scale of rigorous testing, followed by availability.

"What has happened now is that there is decimal scoring. To put it in perspective, the 10 ring at 10 metres is like 0.5 millimeters, which is literally a pin size. Even in this, there is a decimal, that is, the diameter of your pellet is 4.5 millimeters. If it just touches, you get 10, and as it comes into the circle, 10.1, 10.2, 10.3, till a 10.9. Accuracy is very important. If you see the accuracy equation of the gun and this system, the two most important things are the gun's barrel and the projectile, which is the pellet," says YP Shirsat, di-



Shooters in Europe get priority from brands so they get new ammo and the chance to test combinations regularly. We are able to test

regularly only now as ammunition was not available readily earlier because of the war in Ukraine."

AISHWARY PRATAP SINGH, 50M 3-POSITION SHOOTER

• The ammunition

NATURE OF CARTRIDGE: Cartridge for 50m events uses gunpowder as propellant, as opposed to air rifles, where air or CO2 is what propels the pellet. Cartridge size is .22LR (5.6mm).

NATURE OF THE PELLET: The pellet is primarily lead-made, and ISSF regulations ask for the pellet to be sized .177 caliber (4.5mm).



rector of Preciholes Sports, an Indian manufacturer of air rifles and pellets.

The 10m pistol and rifle events use a lead pellet, while the 50m events use a .22 cartridge. Both require intensive testing — most Indian Olympic shooters will make a trip to manufacturers in Germany or other European countries at least once a year to ensure that their barrel and pellets are in harmony. That relationship often ends up influencing their results.

"Any manufacturer who is making the pellets, his one batch might be best for your barrel. Typically, shooters will try to test different batches and

once they find a batch that suits their barrel, they will try to buy as much of it as possible. That is the general way it is done. When you are looking for that elusive gold on the international stage, you save your best pellets for the matches and use the other ones for practice," says Shirsat.

Practice makes perfect

Aishwary, one of India's most consistent 50m 3P shooters, said that he has a meticulous bullet-testing process. Part of it is to go through multiple lots of bullets, test which one synchronises best with his barrel, and then buy

the 'best fitting' lot.

"Usually, if we go to a brand like Lapua, we get 30 lots of bullets," says Aishwary. "We test bullets from each lot and see which bullets work best with our barrel. Different shooters have different rifles, so the lot that works for you might not do so for another shooter. All the ammunition is good, but it's a matter of what suits your barrel."

For a while, getting their hands on pellets and bullets had become tough for Indian shooters. The Russia-Ukraine war meant top suppliers had to redirect their wares elsewhere. Indians and their sport shooting needs took a backseat. "Shooters in Europe get priority from brands so they get new ammo and the chance to test combinations regularly. We are able to test regularly only now as ammunition was not available readily earlier because of the war in Ukraine. If you want to score in the mid 590s, your ammunition has to be tested. Otherwise scores drop into the 580s," said Aishwary.

The Indian 50m 3P mainstay said that he had been using bullets that he had saved over the last two years. Those bullets were with him for the Asian Championships and multiple World Cups. The situation is starting to improve only now.

"We have received ammo only a month back. The ammunition I had been using prior to this is stuff that I had saved over the last two years. All my major tournaments in the last couple of years were played with the ammo I had saved," added Aishwary.

PATH TO GOLD: WOMEN'S HOCKEY

China no longer the Great Wall

The 2-2 draw at the World Cup has given India belief as they pursue direct qualification for 2028 Olympics

Prithish Raj
New Delhi, September 11

THE FIFTH-PLACE finish and impressive performances against top teams at the Women's Hockey World Cup has brought a feel-good factor in India, apart from being the best finish in more than half a century. Significantly, it removed the mental block, to a large extent, against China — India's strongest opponents on the path to Asian Games gold and a direct berth at the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics.

India played an entertaining 2-2 draw against the 2024 Olympics silver medallist in the World Cup group stage and finished ahead of them as the reigning Asian Games champion finished eighth.

"The China match was important for us. Drawing or winning that game was crucial because the young players mostly remember the 4-0 drubbing China gave us at the last Asian Games," Savita Punia told *The Indian Express*. "This draw serves as a reminder for us that we played good hockey against them and will do the same at the Asian Games."

Since 2023, China is the team India has found most difficult to win against at the continental level. At the 2023 Asian Games in Hangzhou, China squashed India's hopes of a his-



The team needs to improve its finishing, says coach Marijne.

The China match was important for us. Drawing or winning that game was crucial because the young players mostly remember the 4-0 drubbing China gave us at the last Asian Games."

SAVITA PUNIA,
INDIAN TEAM GOALKEEPER

toric gold and an Olympics berth in the semifinal with a 4-0 thrashing. India got the better of them twice later in the year at the Asian Champions Trophy but it was a much weaker Chinese squad with most of the top players resting after coming home with a historic silver medal from the Paris Olympics.

In the 2023 and 2024 Pro League, India lost four times to China before suffering yet

another defeat in the final of the 2025 Women's Asia Cup.

Coached by Aussie Alyson Annan, the Chinese women's hockey team plays like a battle-hardened army with rigid tactical formations which makes it difficult for opponents to break through. However, in the World Cup clash against India, China was forced on the back foot by an early field goal from Navneet Kaur, breaking their tactical rigidity. "More than the draw, the way we played was great. We were not just defending. We attacked and created more opportunities than they did," Savita quipped.

With the overall performance at the World Cup, India has also given China something to think about in their pursuit of a direct Olympic berth. "China knows India is performing well and now they have to do their homework. They can't rely on past results now knowing how much India has improved," the veteran goalkeeper said.

One of the highlights for India at the World Cup was the unity in the dressing room,

which seemed to have been somewhat lost during the tenure of previous head coach Harendra Singh. The return of Sjoerd Marijne, who coached India to a historic fourth-place finish at the Tokyo Olympics, has also brought energy back to the squad.

"Every player is happy that coach Marijne has returned. He and his team bring incredible energy and introduce so many meaningful concepts. Our coach gave us a unity band. For an overseas coach to be so deeply invested in taking Indian hockey to the top is motivating in itself," Savita said.

Just a draw, not a win

While the draw against China can be seen as a positive result, coach Sjoerd Marijne doesn't want to get carried away. "I know the expectations are higher but we need to realise that it was just a draw against China. We didn't defeat them," the Dutchman said.

India need to improve their finishing, be it from penalty corners or in open play. "We need to score more PCs but that is something which depends on how the opponent defends. So, overall, we have to improve our finishing."

India defeated Germany in the fifth-place playoff at the World Cup and Marijne wants to build on that. "Before we reach the gold medal match, there are some other matches we need to win. So, I would want the girls to focus on that one match and not worry too much about China," he said. "It's better than losing." Navneet, India's top scorer at the World Cup, had said after China's draw. She, and India, would want to set the bar higher at Aichi-Nagoya.

Bhuvan Gupta
New Delhi, September 11

ALL WASN'T well with Aryna Sabalenka before she reached New York last month. Early exits at Wimbledon, Toronto and Cincinnati preceded her three-peat bid. She said it "wasn't the best period" and that she's "been dealing with several things". A fortnight later, things appear dealt with.

Her 7-5, 6-2 semifinal dismantling of home favourite Jessica Pegula bore proof. Sabalenka was flawless in the second set, leaving Pegula with no breathing room. The ousted third seed assessed it succinctly: "I do think she probably would have beaten 99% of people... Probably the best match she's played this year."

Come Saturday, even Sabalenka's best could face a stern test. Her opponent Elena Rybakina is out to set her US Open record straight.

She'd not gone beyond the fourth round at Flushing Meadows in seven previous campaigns. This time, she was in a race against time, having suffered a left ankle injury in Cincinnati. Not only did the Kazakh recover, she made the final and wrested the world No.1 crown from Sabalenka.

Rybakina ended her 99-week reign with a comeback win over Qinwen Zheng. She rallied again to send No.4 Coco Gauff packing. The revitalized Belarussian, playing her fourth successive US Open final, now awaits. Expect fireworks.

Big serving

Rybakina is known for her massive serve. She has sent down 357 aces this year, as compared to Sabalenka's 236. When on song, this weapon gives her service games an extra solidity.

Sabalenka, serve, though not as big as Rybakina's, has improved over the years. It used to be a weak aspect of her game until 2023, when she worked with a biomechanics specialist to remodel her motion and toss. She has won 71 per cent of her first-serve points in 2026 versus Rybakina's 73.4 per cent.

The return of serve thus be-

US OPEN

A baseline battle awaits

While Rybakina has the edge in aces, Sabalenka's shotmaking is superior



Elena Rybakina (left) trails Aryna Sabalenka 7-10 in their head-to-head record, though the Kazakh won at Australian Open 2026. AP/REUTERS

comes pivotal. Sabalenka has the upper hand in this metric. She has won 44.6 per cent of her return points this year, while Rybakina has garnered 42.3 per cent. Nevertheless, the soon-to-be world No.1's booming serves could dictate terms in the final.

If Sabalenka can't break her for an extended period, frustration could creep in, as it did during their Australian Open meet this January. Rybakina had won 6-4, 4-6, 6-4 then.

Both players recognise the importance of the Rybakina serve. Sabalenka acknowledged after her semifinal that the title fight would be tough, given how

big a server Rybakina is. The Russia-born Kazakh, on the other hand, said she would have serve better than she did against Gauff if she is to challenge the top seed.

"I will need to come with all the energy I will have, bring my best serve against Aryna and, yeah, make the right decisions in the right moment, because most of the times it's tight, tight score. This is where the decision makes a difference," Rybakina added.

Groundstrokes key

Then there are the groundstrokes. Sabalenka has the advantage in this facet, on paper at least. Her clean, all-power shot-

making from the baseline is second to none on hardcourts. It has been at the heart of her deep runs in Melbourne and New York, where she has won all four of her Major titles.

Rybakina, too is dangerous from the baseline. Her groundstrokes are not as powerful as Sabalenka but tend to be flatter, heavier. This gives her a tactical edge on grass, the fastest surface on tour. But when it comes to hardcourts, she knows the 28-year-old has the edge.

And so we might witness a mental battle, as much as a physical one. Rybakina would be desperate to land her returns

outside Sabalenka's hitting zone, especially on forehand. The latter, meanwhile, would try to shorten the rallies, relying on her explosive ball-striking and placement. As the rallies lengthen, Rybakina would be able to match Sabalenka more evenly from the baseline.

"We push each other when we play these matches, and you can see on what you need to work more. I think that's great that you play against someone who pushes you until the limits," Rybakina said on her intriguing duel with Sabalenka.

The defending champion agreed in spirit. "She (Rybakina) has really improved over the years on the baseline game, so it's going to be a physically and mentally tough match," Sabalenka said.

"As I said, I'm ready for the fight. I'm ready to do everything to get the win."

US Open women's singles final: 1:30 am (Sunday), live on Star Sports Network and JioHotstar.

How Iyer & Co deal with Rashid could prove crucial

Shankar Narayan
Mumbai, September 11

POWERPLAYS IN T20 cricket often shape a batting innings. Blazing starts give the middle order the freedom to maintain the pace. With Abhishek Sharma, Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, Sanju Samson and Ishan Kishan, India have enough options to make the first six overs count.

In the three-match series against Afghanistan, starting Sunday, however, the next phase could be as important. India's middle order, including Shreyas Iyer, Tilak Varma and Shivam Dube, will face the hosts' quality spin attack that can trouble the best on their day.

Among them, Rashid Khan will hold the key. The wrist-spinner has 28 wickets in 22 innings since July 2024 at an economy rate of 5.82. The mystery around him may have faded, but he remains a threat that India can ill afford to take lightly.

India's middle order has strong numbers against spin in the same period. But that record will be tested in a series where Rashid can come on as soon as the powerplay ends, particularly if Afghanistan strike early.

Iyer has scored 148 runs at a strike rate of 152.58 against spin between overs 7-16 since July 2024. He often uses his feet against spin, but doing that against Rashid could be riskier since he can change his length and vary his pace without a noticeable change in action. Rotating strike and waiting for him to miss his length could, therefore, be more prudent than trying to force the boundary. That could be even more important if Iyer walks in after the powerplay.

Among the Indian trio, Tilak has been the most prolific against spinners in the seven-to-16-over phase since July 2024. His 396 runs have come at a strike rate of 131.56, with 18 sixes. The left-hander has faced the likes of Wanindu Hasaranga, Adil Rashid and Abrar Ahmed,



Wrist-spinner Rashid Khan. AP

Kishan suffers injury in practice

ISHAN KISHAN sustained what appeared to be a lower back injury during India's training session at the Arun Jaitley Stadium on Friday, ahead of the three-match T20I series against Afghanistan. Ducking awkwardly to evade a steep bounce from net bowler Navdeep Saini, Kishan felt discomfort and had to abandon the nets. The southpaw, who recently led East Zone to their first Duleep Trophy title in 13 years, spent the remainder of the session under the physio's observation. While the extent of the injury is not known, Saini told this newspaper after the session, "I spoke with him after that incident. He told me he was alright." **ENS**

but Rashid will pose a different challenge. He bowls quicker through the air and his ability to mask variations make him hard to attack. Tilak has often used the sweep and his feet against spin, but picking Rashid's variations early will be key. Walking in at No.5 or No.6, he may have little time to settle, making strike rotation and his ability to find the boundary crucial.

Dube offers something different. His numbers against spin

are exceptional - 252 runs at a strike rate of 180 between overs seven and 16 since July 2024 - and much of his value comes from his ability to clear the fence. He has struck 21 sixes against spin during this period.

Change of pace

But Rashid could make that harder. He gives batsmen little time to reach the pitch of the ball and so, rather than trying to overpower him, Dube may have to pick the variation and be prepared to take singles.

Much will also depend on when each of the three faces Rashid. Iyer may have to absorb pressure after an early wicket, while Tilak may walk in with a platform in place and Dube may have to attack immediately. Their numbers against spin, then, tell only part of the story.

If one of Samson, Abhishek, Kishan or Sooryavanshi can bat beyond the powerplay, India could already have momentum before Iyer, Tilak or Dube are required to take on Rashid.

Rashid's overall economy rate (6.04) means while India can afford to be cautious, they cannot allow him to bowl in a way that forces them to take risks at the other end. Afghanistan also have Noor Ahmad, Mujeeb Ur Rahman and Mohammad Nabi, making it harder for India simply to play Rashid out and attack from the other end.

If Afghanistan strike in the first six overs, it would give Rashid a chance to bowl to a new batsman, improving his chances of controlling the middle overs. That makes India's approach from overs seven to 16 an interesting aspect of the series. India have batsmen who have scored heavily against spin, and in Rashid, Afghanistan have someone who can control this phase.

India's challenge will be to ensure the top order's platform is not lost once the field spreads and Rashid enters the contest.

(With stats inputs from Lalith Kalidas)

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